

Sources for the Study of Ancient History of Bihar

The main sources for understanding the ancient history of Bihar are as follows—

1. Archaeological Sources
2. Literary Sources
3. Accounts of Foreign Travellers

Archaeological Sources

These are considered the most reliable sources—

Inscriptions

The pillar inscriptions of Ashoka have been discovered at Lauriya Nandangarh, Lauriya Areraj (East Champaran), and Rampurva (West Champaran), which provide valuable information about the **Mauryan Period**. In addition, the Minor Rock Edicts of Ashoka have been found at Sasaram.

Coins

Punch-marked coins have been discovered from various parts of Bihar, which serve as authentic sources for reconstructing the history of Bihar.

Pottery

The **Northern Black Polished Ware (NBPW)** provides evidence of the **Mauryan civilisation of Magadha**. Besides this, copper-stone tools and pottery have been excavated from Munger, Chirand (Saran), Chechar (Vaishali), Maner (Patna), and Sonpur (Saran).

Monuments and Buildings

The remains of a huge hall supported by **80 pillars** belonging to the **Mauryan royal palace** have been discovered at Kumhrar (Patna). Apart from this, remains of monuments and ancient structures have also been found at Barabar Caves, Rajgir, Nalanda, Pataliputra, and Vikramshila.

Literary Sources

Information about ancient Bihar is obtained from various religious and secular texts.

Religious Literature

Category	Major Texts	Special Information
Vedic Literature	Shatapatha Brahmana	The first reference to Bihar (Videha region) is found in this text.
Puranas	Vishnu Purana, Vayu Purana	- The Vishnu Purana provides information related to the Maurya Dynasty. - The Vayu Purana provides information related to the Gupta Dynasty.
Buddhist Literature	Anguttara Nikaya, Vinaya Pitaka	These texts provide the list of the 16 Mahajanapadas and descriptions of Buddhist monasteries (Viharas).
Jain Literature	Bhagavati Sutra	It contains details about the 16 Mahajanapadas and the spread of Jainism.
Epics	Ramayana and Mahabharata	References are found regarding Buxar (Siddhashrama) and Jarasandha, the ruler of Magadha.

Non-Religious Texts / Literature

Literature	Author	Subject Matter
Arthashastra	Kautilya	Describes state management, system of governance, administration, and politics.
Indica	Megasthenes	Provides a detailed account of Mauryan Indian society, politics, geography, and administration.
Milindapanho	Nagasena	Contains the dialogue between the Buddhist monk Nagasena and the Greek ruler Menander.
Buddhacharita	Ashvaghosha	An epic description of the life of Gautama Buddha and Buddhism.
Prajnaparamita	Nagarjuna	Explains the doctrine of Shunyavada (Theory of Emptiness/Void).
Si-Yu-Ki	Xuanzang	- Provides a detailed account of his travels in India. - The meaning of Si-Yu-Ki is "Records of the Western Countries."
Lalitavistara (related to the Mahayana branch of Buddhism)	(Compiled Text)	Describes the divine acts and life events of Gautama Buddha.
	Mahanama Thera	

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Mahavamsa (<i>related to the Theravada branch of Buddhism</i>)		- Describes the history of the kings of Sri Lanka and Buddhism. - Dipavamsa and Mahavamsa are historical Buddhist texts related to Sri Lanka (ancient name: Ceylon) and were composed in the Pali language.
Jataka Tales	(<i>By Buddhist followers</i>)	Describe stories of the previous births of Gautama Buddha.

Accounts of Foreign Travellers

Foreign travellers have provided vivid descriptions of the contemporary social and political conditions of Bihar:

Megasthenes: Megasthenes, the Greek ambassador who visited the court of Chandragupta Maurya, wrote the book **Indica**. It provides a detailed account of the **municipal administration of Pataliputra**.

Faxian: Faxian was a Chinese Buddhist monk and traveller who came to India during the reign of Chandragupta II, the most famous ruler of the **Gupta Period** (around **399–414 CE**).

Xuanzang: Xuanzang came to India during the reign of Harshavardhana. In his book **Si-Yu-Ki**, he gave a detailed description of Nalanda University.

Yijing/Itsing: The Chinese traveller Yijing, who visited India in the **7th century CE**, described Nalanda University and Vikramashila in his accounts.

Stone Age

The **Stone Age** refers to the period in human history when humans used **stone tools**.

Several evidences of the Stone Age have been discovered in Bihar, indicating that this region was an important centre of ancient human civilisation.

This age is mainly divided into the following phases:

1. Paleolithic Age
2. Mesolithic Age
3. Neolithic Age
4. Chalcolithic Age

Paleolithic Age

This was the earliest phase of human history. Humans of this period were **hunters and food gatherers**.

Remains of the Paleolithic Age have been found in southern Bihar at Bhimbandh(Munger), Jethian(Nalanda) and Gaya.

Stone tools such as **axes, knives, and scrapers** have been discovered among the remains of this period.

Particularly, the **Bhimbandh region** of Munger is considered the most important site of the **Early Stone Age** in Bihar.

Mesolithic Age

During this period, stone tools became **smaller and sharper**. Hence, this phase is also known as the **Microlithic Age**.

Humans of this period were **hunters, food gatherers, and pastoralists**.

Remains of the Mesolithic Age have been discovered in Munger district of southern Bihar.

Small-sized stone tools have been found from Munger district.

Neolithic Age

This period is considered the most important phase in the history of Bihar because it provides evidence of the **Agricultural Revolution** and **permanent settlement**. During this period, humans became **food producers**.

The most famous Neolithic site of Bihar is Chirand. A large number of bone-made tools have been discovered here, especially tools made from **deer antlers**. In addition, evidence of the cultivation of **wheat, rice, and barley** has also been found here.

Besides this, stone and bone tools have also been discovered from Chechar(Vaishali), Senuwar(Rohtas) and Maner(Patna).

Chalcolithic Age

During this period, the use of **copper tools** began along with stone tools.

Remains of the Chalcolithic Age have been found at Chirand, Chechar, Sonpur, Maner, Taradih, and Senuwar.

Black and Red Ware pottery is the main characteristic feature of this period.

Important Exam-Oriented Points

Period	Important Sites	Main Remains / Features
Paleolithic Age	Munger, Nalanda, Gaya	Axes, knives, scrapers, and large stone tools have been discovered.
Mesolithic Age	Munger	Small stone tools (Microliths) have been discovered.
Neolithic Age	Chirand, Chechar, Senuwar	Stone and bone-made tools have been discovered. During this period, humans became food producers .

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Chalcolithic Age	Maner, Sonpur, Taradih(Gaya), Chechar, Senuwar	Discovery of copper tools and Black and Red Ware pottery .
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Rigvedic and Later Vedic Period

In the ancient history of Bihar, the Vedic Period can be understood in two major phases. While Bihar finds mention during the **Rigvedic Period**, the region emerged as an important centre of **Aryan culture** during the **Later Vedic Period**.

Rigvedic Period (1500–1000 BCE)

During the Rigvedic Period, the Aryans mainly inhabited the **Sapta-Sindhu region** (the region of the Indus River and its tributaries). Bihar remained outside the cultural influence of the Aryans.

In this period, Magadha (referred to as **Kikata**) was considered an impure or untouchable region because the people here did not follow Vedic sacrifices (**Yajnas**).

In the Rigveda, the term '**Kikata**' was used for the Bihar region. The inhabitants of this region were called '**Vratyas**' (people living outside the Aryan religious order).

The **Varaha Purana** also describes Kikata as an impure region.

The Rigveda mentions a powerful ruler of Kikata named **Pramaganda**.

Later Vedic Period (1000–600 BCE)

During this period, the use of **iron** helped the Aryans clear dense forests and expand eastward towards Bihar.

The most important information regarding the spread of Aryans in Bihar is obtained from the **Shatapatha Brahmana**.

According to the story of Videgha Madhava in the **Shatapatha Brahmana** of the Shukla Yajurveda, **Videgha Madhava**, along with his teacher Gautama Rahugana, moved eastward from the Sarasvati River following the **Vaishvanara Agni**. They stopped on the banks of the Gandak River, also known as **Sadanira**. From here, Aryan culture expanded into the **Mithila–Tirhut region (Videha)**.

At that time, the **Gandak River (Sadanira)** was considered the boundary between the kingdoms of Kosala and Videha.

The Atharvaveda mentions Magadha and Anga for the first time among the Mahajanapadas. Magadha was still referred to as a '**Vratya**' region during this period, but gradually the influence of Vedic culture began to increase there.

Comparative Study in the Special Context of Bihar

Feature	Rigvedic Period	Later Vedic Period
Name of Bihar	Kikata	Videha, Magadha, and Anga
Position of Aryans	No Aryan expansion into Bihar	Complete Aryan expansion up to Bihar
Main Sources of Information	Rigveda (Third Mandala)	Shatapatha Brahmana and Atharvaveda
Important River	Sarasvati River (major river)	The eastern limit of Aryan expansion extended up to the Gandak River (Sadanira)
Cultural Status	Considered an impure / inauspicious region	Became a centre of education and philosophy (Videha)

Mahajanapada Period

In the **6th century BCE (600 BCE)**, the process of the **Second Urbanisation** began in Indian history. During this period, the extensive use of **iron** transformed the social and political structure, leading to the rise of large states known as **Mahajanapadas**.

According to the Buddhist text **Anguttara Nikaya** and the Jain text **Bhagavati Sutra**, there were a total of **16 Mahajanapadas**, out of which **3 Mahajanapadas** were located in the region of present-day Bihar.

This period came after the **Later Vedic Period** and before the **Mauryan Period**.

S. No.	Mahajanapada	Capital	Present-Day Region
1	Magadha	Girivraja / Rajagriha	● Patna, Gaya, Nalanda (Bihar)
2	Anga	Champa	● Bhagalpur, Munger (Bihar)
3	Vajji	Vaishali	● Muzaffarpur, Vaishali (Bihar)
4	Kashi	Varanasi	● Varanasi (Uttar Pradesh)
5	Kosala	Shravasti / Kushavati	● Faizabad, Awadh (Uttar Pradesh)
6	Malla	Kushinara / Pava	● Deoria, Gorakhpur (Uttar Pradesh)
7	Vatsa	Kaushambi	● Prayagraj (Uttar Pradesh)
8	Kuru	Indraprastha	● Modern Delhi, Meerut, Haryana
9	Panchala	Ahichchhatra / Kampilya	● Rohilkhand (Uttar Pradesh)

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10	Chedi	Shuktimati	● Bundelkhand (Uttar Pradesh and Gwalior region of Madhya Pradesh)
11	Surasena	Mathura	● Mathura (Uttar Pradesh)
12	Ashmaka	Potana / Potali	● Between the Narmada River and Godavari River (Maharashtra)
13	Avanti	Ujjaini / Mahishmati	● Malwa (Madhya Pradesh)
14	Matsya	Viratnagar	● Jaipur (Rajasthan)
15	Kamboja	Hatak / Rajapura	● Rajouri and Hazara (Pakistan)
16	Gandhara	Taxila	● Rawalpindi, Peshawar (Pakistan)

Three Mahajanapadas Located in the Region of Modern Bihar

Magadha Mahajanapada

Magadha emerged as the most powerful among the **16 Mahajanapadas**. Its early expansion mainly covered the regions of **present-day Patna and Gaya districts** of Bihar.

It was surrounded by the Ganges in the north, the Son River in the west, and the Vindhya Range (Kaimur Hills) in the south, which provided it with natural security.

The early capital of Magadha was **Rajgir (Rajagriha)**, which was then known as **Girivraja**. It was a strategically important city surrounded by five hills.

The five hills surrounding Rajgir (Rajagriha) are: **Ratnagiri, Vipulanchal (Vipula), Vaibharagiri (Vaibhava), Sonagiri (Swarnagiri)** and **Udayagiri**.

During the reign of Bimbisara, Magadha conquered Anga and annexed it into its kingdom.

Anga Mahajanapada (Bhagalpur and Munger Region)

The capital of Anga Mahajanapada was **Champa**. The ancient name of Champa was **Malini**. Since it was established by Mahagovinda, it was also known as **Mahagovindapura**.

During the period of the Mahabharata, Karna was the ruler of Anga.

Champa was a famous **port and trade centre** of that period.

Bimbisara, the ruler of Magadha, defeated **Brahmadatta**, the last king of Anga, and merged Anga into Magadha.

Vajji Confederacy

The Vajji Confederacy was a union of **8 states (clans)**, among which the most prominent were; the **Lichchhavis** of Vaishali, **Videhas** of Mithila and **Jnatikas** of Kundagrama.

The capital of the Lichchhavis was Vaishali (present-day Basarh), which is considered the **birthplace of the world's first republic**. This capital was founded by **King Vishal**.

Note: Anga and Magadha Mahajanapadas are mentioned in the Atharvaveda.

Magadha Empire

The rise of the **Magadha Empire** mainly took place during the **6th century BCE**. Several geographical and strategic factors were responsible for Magadha becoming the most powerful empire of its time:

Natural Security: Its capital, **Rajgir (Rajagriha)**, was a well-protected area surrounded by **five hills**.

Network of Rivers: Rivers such as the **Ganges, Son River**, and **Gandak River** provided excellent facilities for irrigation, transportation, and trade.

Fertile Land: Due to the availability of **alluvial soil**, agriculture was highly developed in this region. In addition, trade and commerce also flourished here.

Resources: Mineral resources, especially **iron** from the Chotanagpur Plateau region, timber from forests, and powerful elephants for the army were easily available.

Major Dynasties**Brihadratha Dynasty**

Brihadratha founded Magadha, and the most famous ruler of this dynasty was **Jarasandha**.

The last ruler of the Brihadratha dynasty was **Ripunjaya**.

Ripunjaya was killed by his minister **Pulika**, who was later killed by **Bhattiya**. Afterwards, Bhattiya placed his son **Bimbisara** on the throne of Magadha.

Major Dynasties of the Magadha Empire

1. Haryanka Dynasty
2. Shishunaga Dynasty
3. Nanda Dynasty

Haryanka Dynasty (544–412 BCE)**Bimbisara (544–492 BCE)**

Bimbisara is regarded as the founder of the **Haryanka Dynasty** and the real founder of Magadha.

Bimbisara assumed power in **544 BCE** at the age of **15 years**.

For the expansion of his empire, Bimbisara adopted both **warfare and diplomacy (marital alliances)**.

The name of Bimbisara's first wife was **Kosala Devi**, the princess of Kosala. After this marriage, he received the region of Kashi as dowry/gift.

Bimbisara's second wife was **Chellana**, daughter of Chetaka, the king of the Lichchavis.

His third wife was **Kshema**, a princess of Madra in Punjab.

He established friendly relations with Chanda Pradyota, the ruler of Avanti. When Chanda Pradyota fell ill, Bimbisara sent his **royal physician Jivaka** for his treatment.

Bimbisara met Gautama Buddha soon after Buddha attained enlightenment. Thereafter, Bimbisara embraced **Buddhism** at Rajgir, especially at **Gridhakuta Hill (Vulture Peak)**. He also donated the **Veluvana Vihara** to the Buddhist Sangha at Rajgir.

Bimbisara defeated Brahmadatta, the ruler of Anga, and brought Anga under Magadha's control. After this conquest, he appointed his son Ajatashatru (also known as **Kunika**) as the governor of Anga.

Bimbisara was killed in **492 BCE** by his own son Ajatashatru, after which Ajatashatru (492–460 BCE) became the ruler of Magadha.

In Jain texts, Bimbisara is referred to as '**Shrenika**'. He ruled Magadha for **52 years** and was a contemporary of both Gautama Buddha and Mahavira.

Ajatashatru (492–460 BCE)

The name "**Ajatashatru**" means — "*one whose enemy is not yet born.*"

Ajatashatru was an ambitious warrior. Soon after becoming the ruler, he fought a war against **Prasenajit**, the ruler of Kosala, in which Prasenajit was defeated. Eventually, Prasenajit married his daughter **Vajira** to Ajatashatru and gave **Kashi as dowry to Magadha**.

Ajatashatru's chief friend and associate was his trusted minister **Vassakara**.

With the help of Vassakara, Ajatashatru conquered Vaishali (the Vajji Confederacy) and annexed it to Magadha. During this **16-year war**, he used two newly developed destructive weapons called **Rathamusala** and **Mahashilakantaka**. He also defeated the Malla republic.

According to Jain traditions, Ajatashatru attacked the Vajji Confederacy because he wanted to seize the precious jewel ornaments and the elephant named **Sechanaka** from his stepbrothers Halla and Vihalla. However, Halla and Vihalla fled to the Lichchavis under the protection of their maternal grandfather Chetaka.

Fearing an attack from the king of Avanti, Ajatashatru **fortified the city of Rajgir** (Rajagriha).

Initially, Ajatashatru was a follower of **Jainism**, but later he embraced **Buddhism**.

Gautama Buddha passed away in the **8th year of Ajatashatru's reign**.

Immediately after the **Mahaparinirvana (death)** of Buddha, the **First Buddhist Council** was held in **483 BCE** at the **Saptaparni Cave in Rajagriha** under the patronage of Ajatashatru.

Udayin (460–444 BCE)

According to Sri Lankan traditions, Udayin killed his father Ajatashatru in **460 BCE**.

Udayin shifted his capital from **Rajgir to Pataliputra**, located at the confluence of the Ganges, Son River, and Gandak River rivers.

According to Buddhist texts, Udayin had three sons — Aniruddha, Mundaka and Nagadashaka.

Nagadashaka was the last ruler of the **Haryanka Dynasty**.

Note:

- The **Haryanka dynasty** is also called the "**Patricidal dynasty**" because most rulers of this dynasty gained power by killing their fathers.

Shishunaga Dynasty (412–344 BCE)

The last ruler of the **Haryanka Dynasty**, Nagadashaka, was dethroned by his own **Amatya (minister) Shishunaga**, after which Shishunaga established this new dynasty in Magadha.

Before ascending the throne, he was the **governor of Varanasi**.

Shishunaga's greatest achievement was defeating **Avantivardhana**, the ruler of Avanti, and **annexing Avanti** into Magadha. Besides this, he also incorporated Vatsa and Kaushambi into Magadha.

He shifted his capital from Rajgir (Rajagriha) to **Vaishali**.

After the death of Shishunaga, his son Kalashoka became king. In the Puranas, he is referred to as '**Kakavarna**'.

Kalashoka permanently shifted the capital back from **Vaishali to Pataliputra**. From this period onward, Pataliputra remained the main centre of Magadha's power.

About **100 years after the death of Gautama Buddha (383 BCE)**, the **Second Buddhist Council** was held at Vaishali during the reign of Kalashoka.

According to Banabhatta's Harshacharita, Kalashoka was assassinated by an unknown person (possibly Mahapadma Nanda) while roaming in Pataliputra.

The last ruler of the Shishunaga Dynasty was Mahanandin (or Nandivardhana), after whose murder Mahapadma Nanda established the **Nanda Dynasty** in Magadha.

Nanda Dynasty (344–321 BCE)

The **Nanda Dynasty** was the first **non-Kshatriya dynasty** of Magadha. Its founder was Mahapadma Nanda.

Mahapadma Nanda is regarded as the most powerful and greatest ruler of this dynasty.

He assumed titles such as '*Ekarat*', '*Sarvakshatrantaka*' (*destroyer of the Kshatriyas*), and '*Aproparashurama*' (*Second Parashurama*).

According to the Puranas and Buddhist texts, the first ruler of the Nanda Dynasty, Mahapadma Nanda, was also called '*Ugrasena*'.

The **great grammarian Panini** was a contemporary of Mahapadma Nanda.

He conquered Kalinga (Odisha) and brought the idol of '*Jina*' from there to Magadha. His conquest of Kalinga is mentioned in the **Hathigumpha Inscription** of Kharavela.

Apart from this, Mahapadma Nanda defeated the states of Panchala, Ikshvaku, Kashi, Ashmaka, and Mithila, thereby expanding the Magadha Empire.

The **greatest territorial expansion of Magadha** took place during the reign of Mahapadma Nanda.

Mahapadma Nanda also **constructed canals in Kalinga** for irrigation, evidence of which is found in the Hathigumpha Inscription.

He was the first ruler to bring most parts of **Northern India** under a single administration.

Dhanananda

Dhana Nanda was the last ruler of the **Nanda Dynasty**. He was one of the eight sons of Mahapadma Nanda.

Dhanananda was highly unpopular because of the heavy taxes imposed on his subjects.

According to Greek writers, Dhanananda possessed an army consisting of **200,000 infantry soldiers, 20,000 cavalry, 2,000 chariots, and nearly 3,000 elephants**.

When the Greek conqueror, Alexander the Great invaded India in **326 BCE**, Dhanananda was ruling Magadha. It was due to the fear of Dhanananda's massive army that Alexander's soldiers refused to cross the Beas River.

In Greek sources, the Indian ruler contemporary to Alexander, Dhanananda, is referred to as '*Agrammes*' or '*Xandrames*'.

Dhanananda insulted **Chanakya (Kautilya)** in his royal court.

To avenge this insult, Chanakya, through his diplomacy and with the help of his disciple Chandragupta Maurya, defeated Dhanananda in battle and laid the foundation of the **Maurya Empire** in Magadha.

Buddhism

Buddhism holds an extremely important place in the history of the Magadha Empire because the rulers of Magadha (such as Ajatashatru, Kalashoka, and later Ashoka) played a major role in its spread.

This religion emerged in the **6th century BCE** in opposition to **Brahmanism**. It was founded by Gautama Buddha. Edwin Arnold described Gautama Buddha as the "**Light of Asia**."

After witnessing the **Four Sights**, Buddha decided to renounce worldly life. These four sights were—an old man, a sick person, a corpse and a monk.

At the age of **29 years**, he renounced his home and adopted ascetic life. This event is known in Buddhism as the **Mahabhinishkramana (Great Renunciation)**.

During his ascetic life, he received teachings from his first teacher **Alara Kalama** (a scholar of Sankhya philosophy) at Vaishali and from his second teacher **Uddaka Ramaputta** (a Yoga teacher) at Rajgir.

After **six years of penance**, at the age of **35 years**, on the occasion of **Vaishakha Purnima**, he attained enlightenment under the **Peepal tree** on the banks of the Phalgu River (Niranjana River) at Bodh Gaya. Thereafter, he came to be known as **Tathagata** and **Buddha**.

Gautama Buddha: Life Introduction

Event	Description	Facts
Birth	563 BCE	Lumbini (Kapilavastu region), Nepal
Father's Name	Suddhodana	Suddhodana was the king of the Shakya dynasty.
Mother's Name	Mahamaya	She was a princess of the Koliya dynasty.
Childhood Name	Siddhartha	His childhood name was Siddhartha Gautama.
Upbringing of Buddha	Mahaprajapati Gautami (<i>stepmother/aunt</i>)	Buddha's mother, Queen Mahamaya (Mayadevi), died seven days after his birth. Thereafter, Buddha was raised by Mahaprajapati Gautami.
Wife	Yashodhara	She was the daughter of the king of the Koliya dynasty.
Son	Rahula	According to the Pali tradition, Rahula was born on the very day Prince Siddhartha renounced worldly life. Therefore, he was

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		named Rahula, meaning “a bond on the path to enlightenment.”
Name of Buddha's Favourite Horse	Kanthaka	The beloved white horse of Prince Siddhartha.
Name of Buddha's Charioteer	Channa	He helped Siddhartha in renouncing his home.
Renunciation of Home	‘Mahabhinishkramana’	Buddha renounced worldly life at the age of 29 years.
Attainment of Enlightenment	‘Nirvana’	Buddha attained enlightenment at Bodh Gaya on the banks of the Phalgu River (Niranjana River).
First Sermon	‘Dharmachakra Pravartana’	Buddha delivered his first sermon at Sarnath (Rishipattan) to five monks in the Mrigadava (Deer Park).
Name of Buddha's Stepbrother	Devadatta	In Buddhist traditions, he is considered the chief opponent of Buddha.
Language of Buddha's Teachings	Pali Language	It was the simplest language and the language of the common people.
Place Where Buddha Delivered the Maximum Sermons	Shravasti (<i>capital of Kosala</i>)	Buddha spent the maximum number of rainy seasons (Varshavasa) here.
Mahaparinirvana	Death (483 BCE)	According to tradition, after consuming food (called ‘Sukara-Maddava’), served by a blacksmith named Cunda at Pava, Buddha became seriously ill. Thereafter, he attained Parinirvana at Kushinagar in the Malla Mahajanapada.

Note:

Gautama Buddha passed away (**Mahaparinirvana**) in **483 BCE** at Kushinagar. After his death, his bodily relics were divided into **eight parts**, and stupas were constructed over them.

Principles of Buddhism**Four Noble Truths**

1. **Dukkha** (Suffering) — “The world is full of suffering.”
2. **Dukkha Samudaya** (Cause of Suffering) — “The cause of suffering is craving or desire.”
3. **Dukkha Nirodha** (Cessation of Suffering) — “The end of suffering is possible through the renunciation of craving or desire.”
4. **Dukkha Nirodha Gamini Pratipada** — To end suffering, Buddha prescribed the ‘**Eightfold Path**’, which is also known as the ‘**Middle Path**’ (Madhyama Pratipada).

Ashtangika Marg (Eightfold Path)

Right View	Right Intention
Right Speech	Right Action
Right Livelihood	Right Effort
Right Mindfulness	Right Concentration

Triratna (Three Jewels)

Buddha, Dhamma (Dharma) and Sangha

Main Principles of Buddhist Philosophy

Principle	Meaning	Description
Kshanikavada	Impermanence	Every object in the world is changeable. Nothing is permanent.
Anatmavada	Absence of Soul	According to Buddha, there is no such thing as a permanent soul in living beings. A person is merely a combination of five aggregates (<i>Skandhas</i>).

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Duhkhavada	Universality of Suffering	There is suffering in the world, but this is not pessimism because there is also a path to liberation (<i>Nirvana</i>).
Pratityasamutpada	Theory of Cause and Effect	The existence of one thing leads to the origin of another.
Shunyavada	Lack of Independent Existence	Its propounder was Nagarjuna. According to this doctrine, all objects in the world are inherently empty (<i>devoid of independent existence</i>) because they are interdependent on one another.

Major Buddhist Councils

Council	Time	Place	President	Ruler (Magadha)	Special Feature
First	483 BCE	Rajgir	Mahakassapa	Ajatashatru	Compilation of the Sutta Pitaka and Vinaya Pitaka.
Second	383 BCE	Vaishali	Sabbakami	Kalashoka	The Buddhist Sangha was divided for the first time into two sects — Sthavira (Theravada) and Mahasanghika.
Third	250 BCE	Pataliputra	Moggaliputta Tissa	Ashoka	The Abhidhamma Pitaka was compiled in this council.
Fourth	1st Century CE	Kundalvana	Vasumitra	Kanishka	Buddhism was clearly divided into two sects — Hinayana and Mahayana. The use of Sanskrit language for Buddhist texts also began during this council.

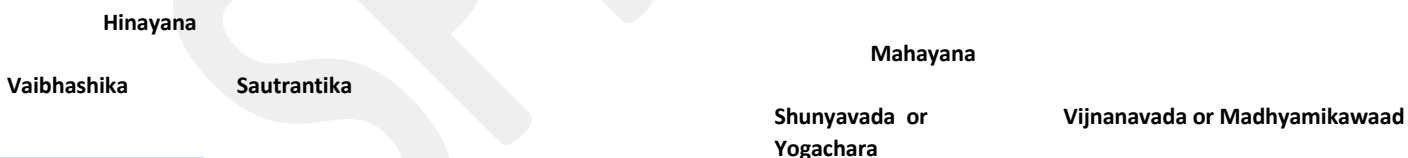
Buddhist Literature

Tripitaka (in Pali Language)

- Sutta Pitaka:** It is the **largest and most important text** among the **Tripitaka** of Buddhism. It contains a collection of the religious teachings and dialogues of Gautama Buddha. It is also known as the **"Scripture of Buddhism."** It was compiled by **Ananda**.
- Vinaya Pitaka:** It is a collection of the rules and disciplinary codes prescribed for monks and nuns of the Buddhist Sangha. It may also be regarded as the **"Constitution of the Buddhist Sangha."** It was compiled by Buddha's disciple **Upali** during the **First Buddhist Council (483 BCE)**. The Vinaya Pitaka is mainly divided into three parts: *Sutta Vibhanga (Explanation of the 'Patimokkha')*, *Kandhaka* and *Parivara*.
- Abhidhamma Pitaka:** It is the **third and final part** of the Tripitaka. It contains the **philosophical and psychological interpretation** of Buddha's teachings. It was compiled by **Moggaliputta Tissa** during the **Third Buddhist Council**.

Major Sects of Buddhism

Buddhist Sects



Feature	Hinayana	Mahayana
Nature of Buddha	Buddha is regarded as a great human being/pathfinder.	Buddha is worshipped as a God/Deity.
Goal	To attain the status of an Arhat (<i>personal liberation/Nirvana</i>).	To become a Bodhisattva (<i>helping others attain liberation</i>).
Language	Their texts are written in Pali language.	Their texts are mainly written in Sanskrit language.
Approach	Conservative and opposed to changes.	Liberal and adaptable according to time.

Symbolic Signs of Buddhism

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Event	Symbol
Birth	● Lotus and Bull
Renunciation of Home	● Horse
Enlightenment / Nirvana	● Bodhi Tree (Peepal Tree)
Dharmachakra Pravartana	● Wheel with Eight Spokes
Death	● Stupa

Views on God and the Vedas

Atheism (Anishvaravada): Buddhist philosophy does not accept the existence of God. It believes that the creation and functioning of the world are governed by **natural laws (Dhamma)**.

Authenticity of the Vedas: Gautama Buddha rejected the **divine authority of the Vedas** as well as ritualistic sacrifices and ceremonies.

Varna System: Buddha opposed the **caste-based Varna system**.

Other Important Facts

After severe penance at Bodh Gaya, Siddhartha (Buddha) had become physically weak. At that time, **Sujata** of Bakraur offered him **Kheer (rice pudding)** in a golden bowl. This event inspired Buddha to abandon extreme austerity and adopt the **Middle Path**.

On the repeated request of his beloved disciple Ananda, Buddha **permitted women** to enter the Sangha. This historic decision was taken at Vaishali. Women were required to follow eight special rules known as **Garudhammas** for admission into the Sangha.

The first woman to be initiated into Buddhism was **Mahaprajapati Gautami**. After receiving initiation directly from Buddha, she established the **Bhikkhuni Sangha (Order of Nuns)**.

In Buddhism, the term **'Theri'** refers to senior or respected nuns. The collection of their experiences and hymns is known as the **Therigatha**.

Jainism

Parallel to Buddhism, **Jainism** emerged in the **6th century BCE**. The word **'Jain'** is derived from the Sanskrit word **'Jina'**, meaning *"Victor"* — one who has conquered his senses.

Jain Tirthankaras

There were a total of **24 Tirthankaras** in Jainism. The term **'Tirthankara'** refers to a person who has built a **'Tirtha' (bridge/path)** to help others cross the ocean of worldly existence.

Important Jain Tirthankaras and Their Symbols

No.	Name of Tirthankara	Symbol	Special Facts
1	Rishabhanatha (Adinatha)	Bull	● Founder of Jainism. ● He is also mentioned in the Rigveda.
2	Ajitanatha	Elephant	● Second Tirthankara.
19	Mallinatha	Kalasha (Pitcher)	● The Shvetambara sect considers Mallinatha a female, whereas the Digambara sect considers Mallinatha male.
21	Naminatha	Blue Lotus	● He is believed to have been the ruler of Mithila.
22	Neminatha (Arishtanemi)	Conch Shell	● He is considered a close relative of Krishna. ● 'Arishtanemi' is mentioned four times in the Rigveda.
23	Parshvanatha	Serpent	● He prescribed the 'Chaturyama' (Four Vows). He was born in Varanasi (Kashi).
24	Mahavira	Lion	● The real founder of Jainism. ● He added the fifth vow — Brahmacharya (celibacy).

Mahavira (540 BCE – 468 BCE)

- **Birth:** Kundagrama (near Vaishali)
- **Childhood name:** Vardhamana
- **Father:** Siddhartha (head of the Jñatrika Kshatriya clan)
- **Mother:** Trishala (a Lichchhavi princess)
- **Wife:** Yashoda (a Kshatriya girl of the Kondinya gotra)
- **Daughter:** Priyadarshana (also known as Anojja or Anavadya)
- **Son-in-law:** Prince Jamali (who later became his disciple)
- **Renunciation (Griha Tyag):** He renounced worldly life at the age of 30 years.
- **Attainment of Knowledge (Kevalya / Enlightenment):** After 12 years of intense penance, he attained **Kevalya** (omniscience) at the age of 42 years at Jrimbhikagrama, on the banks of the Rijuvalika River, under a Shala tree.

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- **Nirvana (Death):** He attained Nirvana at the age of 72 years in Pavapuri (Bihar).

Note: The first sermon (**Divyadhvani**) of Mahavira was delivered after attaining **Kevalya gyan** at Rajgir on the **Vipulachala hills**. The main essence of his first sermon was **"Ahimsa Parmo Dharma"** (*Non-violence is the supreme religion*). He delivered his teachings in the **Prakrit language** (**Ardhamagadhi**).

- According to Jain traditions, **66 days after attaining Kevala Jnana**, Mahavira delivered his first sermon to his first eleven disciples, known as the **Gandharas**, under the leadership of Indrabhuti Gautama. This important event took place at the Vipulachala hills (Rajgir), in a specially constructed divine preaching hall known as the **Samavasarana**.
- In Jainism, **Diwali** is celebrated as the sacred day of Mahavira's **Nirvana (liberation)**, which took place at midnight on **Kartik Amavasya** at Pavapuri in Bihar. According to Jain traditions and the Uttaradhyayana Sutra, Mahavira began delivering his final sermon on **Dhanteras**. It is believed that he preached continuously for **48 hours**. At the end of these 48 hours, on the midnight of Diwali, he attained Nirvana.
- The next morning, his chief disciple Gautama Swami attained **Kevalya gyan (Supreme Knowledge)**, transforming the darkness of Mahavira's death into a festival of light. In Jain scriptures, this is known as **Deepalikaya** (*"the abandonment of bodily light"*).
- Jains celebrate this festival by lighting lamps, observing fasts, meditating, and reciting the Uttaradhyayana Sutra, which contains Mahavira's final teachings.

Principles of Jainism**Panch Mahavratas (Five Great Vows)**

Mahavira added the **fifth vow (Brahmacharya)** to the four vows of Parshvanatha.

1. **Ahimsa** — Non-violence (*most important in Jainism*)
2. **Satya** — Truthfulness; not telling lies
3. **Asteya** — Non-stealing
4. **Aparigraha** — Non-possession; not accumulating property
5. **Brahmacharya** — Control over senses/celebrity (*added by Mahavira*)

Note: In Jainism, **Mahavrata** and **Anuvrata** are the two major codes of conduct.

- **Mahavratas** are the complete observance of **Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Brahmacharya, and Aparigraha** by monks (ascetics).
- **Anuvratas** are the partial or limited observance of these same five vows by householders (common people).

Triratna (Three Jewels)

Jainism prescribes three paths for attaining **Moksha (liberation)**:

1. **Samyak Darshana** — Right Faith / Belief in Truth.
2. **Samyak Jnana (Gyan)** — Right Knowledge.
3. **Samyak Charitra** — Right Conduct; maintaining equanimity in happiness and sorrow and control over the senses.

Jain Councils

Council	Time	Place	President	Result
First	300 BCE	Pataliputra	Sthulabhadra	Jainism was divided into two sects — Shvetambara and Digambara . The 12 Angas were compiled.
Second	512 CE	Vallabhi	Devardhi Kshamashramana	Jain scriptures were finally compiled and written down in an organized form.

Mahavira had **11 chief Gandharas (principal disciples)**. After receiving initiation in the **Samavasarana**, these disciples were known for compiling his teachings in the form of the **Dwadashanga (12 Angas)**.

Sects of Jainism

Feature	Shvetambara	Digambara
Literal Meaning	'Shveta' + 'Ambara' = <i>Wearers of white clothes</i>	'Dik' + 'Ambara' = <i>Those for whom directions themselves are clothing (nude ascetics)</i>
Leadership	Sthulabhadra	Bhadrabahu
Clothing	They wear white clothes .	They practice complete nudity ; clothing is prohibited.
Moksha and Women	Women can attain Moksha .	Women cannot attain Moksha .
Marriage of Mahavira	They believe that Mahavira was married and had a daughter.	They believe that Mahavira remained unmarried.

Philosophical Concepts

Syadvada / Anekantavada : It is also known as the '**Saptabhangi Naya**'. According to this doctrine, truth may have multiple aspects, and human knowledge is always relative and conditional.

Sallekhana / Santhara: It is the religious practice of voluntarily giving up the body through fasting. Chandragupta Maurya is believed to have given up his life through this method.

Theory of Karma and Moksha: According to Jain philosophy, **Karma** attaches itself to the soul in the form of a subtle material substance. The accumulation of karmas is the cause of rebirth and suffering. Through penance and spiritual practices, old karmas can be destroyed (**Nirjara**), which ultimately leads to **Moksha (liberation)**.

Nirgrantha: A person who has become free from all worldly bonds and attachments.

Ananta Chatushtaya: After attaining Moksha, the soul acquires four infinite qualities: Infinite Knowledge, Infinite Perception, Infinite Energy/Power (Virya) and Infinite Bliss.

Note:

- Jainism does not believe in God, but it does believe in the *soul* and *rebirth*. Here, such strong emphasis is placed on *non-violence (Ahimsa)* that even agriculture and warfare were considered forbidden. Mahavira did not oppose the caste system.
- According to Jainism, the *soul exists in every particle of the universe*, not only in humans. The soul is present in humans, animals, birds, insects, water, fire, air, earth, and all substances.
- The sacred texts of Jainism are mainly divided into the *Agamas* (12 Angas, 12 Upangas) and other authentic texts (like Tatvartha Sutra) of that period.

Maurya Dynasty**Chandragupta Maurya (321–298 BCE)**

Chandragupta Maurya defeated the last Nanda ruler Dhana Nanda in **321 BCE** with the assistance of his teacher Chanakya and laid the foundation of the **Maurya Dynasty**.

Justin and Strabo referred to Chandragupta Maurya as "**Sandrokottos**", which was later confirmed by William Jones. Plutarch and Arrian called him "**Androcottus**."

In **305 BCE**, Chandragupta Maurya defeated the Greek ruler Seleucus Nicator. After this victory, a treaty was concluded between the two rulers. Under this treaty, Seleucus handed over the regions of **Herat, Kandahar, Kabul, and Makran** to Chandragupta Maurya. In return, Chandragupta presented **500 elephants** to Seleucus.

After the war, Chandragupta Maurya married Seleucus' daughter, Princess **Helen (Cornelia)**.

The **Sudarshana Lake**, located at Junagadh in Gujarat, is an ancient artificial reservoir constructed during the 3rd century BCE under Chandragupta Maurya. It was built by his local governor **Pushyagupta Vaishya** to provide irrigation and water supply to the Saurashtra region.

Seleucus sent his ambassador Megasthenes to Chandragupta's court. Megasthenes wrote the famous book '**Indica**'.

In the final phase of his life, Chandragupta Maurya embraced **Jainism** and went to **Shravanabelagola** along with Bhadrabahu, where he gave up his life through the practice of **Sallekhana**.

Bindusara (298–272 BCE)

Bindusara was known by the title '**Amitraghata**' (*Destroyer of Enemies*). In Jain texts such as '**Rajavalikatha**', he is referred to as **Simhasena**, while the Vayu Purana calls him **Bhadrasara**.

Bindusara was a follower of the **Ajivika sect**. The founder of the Ajivika sect was **Makkhali Gosala**, who was a contemporary of both Gautama Buddha and Mahavira.

The Syrian king Antiochus I Soter sent an ambassador named **Deimachus** to Bindusara's court.

Mauryan emperor Bindusara requested three things from the Seleucid ruler Antiochus I Soter of Syria: **sweet wine, dried figs, and a sophist (philosopher)**. Antiochus sent the wine and figs but replied that Greek law did not permit the sale or trade of philosophers.

The Egyptian ruler Ptolemy II Philadelphus sent an ambassador named **Dionysius** to Bindusara's court.

Bindusara sent his son Ashoka to suppress the revolt at Taxila. At that time, Ashoka was the governor of **Ujjain**.

Bindusara conquered most parts of India except **Kalinga** and the southern Tamil states of **Chola, Chera, and Pandya**.

According to the Tibetan historian Taranatha, Bindusara conquered **16 states**, making him the ruler of the land between the **Arabian Sea** and the **Bay of Bengal**.

Ashoka (269–232 BCE)

There was a gap of nearly **four years** between the death of emperor Bindusara and the formal coronation of his son Ashoka. During this period, a brutal war of succession took place among Bindusara's sons.

According to Sri Lankan Buddhist traditions, Ashoka killed **99 of his brothers** to secure the throne, although this claim is not confirmed by other sources.

In the inscriptions of Maski, Gujarra, Nittur, and Udegolam, the name '**Ashoka**' is mentioned directly. In the **Bhabru Edict**, Emperor Ashoka is referred to as "**Piyadasi Raja Magadhe**" (*Priyadarshi, King of Magadha*).

The Puranas refer to Ashoka as **Ashokavardhana**.

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In the Kanaganahalli inscription of Karnataka, Ashoka's name appears as **"Ranyo Ashoka."**

In the **8th year of his coronation**, Ashoka attacked Kalinga in **261 BCE**. Witnessing the massive bloodshed in this war transformed Ashoka's heart, after which he abandoned the policy of warfare and adopted the policy of **Dhamma**. Ashoka's **13th Rock Edict** describes the Kalinga War and the declaration of **Dhamma Vijaya** (*conquest through righteousness*).

According to the Divyavadana, Emperor Ashoka received initiation into Buddhism from the monk **Upagupta** and organized the **Third Buddhist Council**. Before embracing Buddhism, Ashoka followed **Shaivism**.

Ashoka was the **first Indian ruler** to address the public through inscriptions. The language of Ashoka's inscriptions was mainly **Prakrit**, and the script used was **Brahmi**.

The inscriptions of northwestern India were written in **Kharosthi** and **Aramaic** scripts. Among them, the inscriptions at Mansehra and Shahbazgarhi are in **Kharosthi script**, while the famous Kandahar inscription of Ashoka was engraved in **two languages — Greek and Aramaic**.

In **1837**, British archaeologist James Prinsep successfully deciphered the ancient **Brahmi script** used in the inscriptions of Emperor Ashoka.

Chronology After the Coronation of Ashoka

Year (After Coronation)	Important Event / Activity
8th Year (261 BCE)	Ashoka invaded Kalinga in 261 BCE. Witnessing the massive bloodshed in this war transformed his heart, and he abandoned 'Bheri Ghosha' (<i>the sound of war drums</i>) and adopted the policy of 'Dhamma Ghosha' (<i>the proclamation of Dhamma</i>).
9th Year	Developed an inclination towards Buddhism and received initiation from Upagupta.
10th Year	Undertook a pilgrimage to Bodh Gaya.
12th Year	Appointed officials known as Pradeshikas, Rajukas, and Yuktas, who were required to go on tours every five years for the propagation of Dhamma.
13th Year	Dhamma Mahamatras were appointed.
14th Year	Began engraving inscriptions (edicts) so that the public could read and understand his messages.
18th Year	Organized the Third Buddhist Council at Pataliputra under the presidency of Moggaliputta Tissa.
20th Year	Visited Lumbini (<i>Rummindei</i>), the birthplace of Gautama Buddha, and reduced the tax there to 1/8th.

Other Measures Taken by Ashoka for the Propagation of Dhamma

He sent his son Mahendra and daughter Sanghamitra to Sri Lanka for the spread of Buddhism.

Ashoka derived the definition of **Dhamma** from the '**Rahulovada Sutta**', according to which Dhamma meant — **less sin, greater welfare, compassion, charity, truthfulness, and purity**.

The number of Ashoka's **Major Rock Edicts** is **14**, which reflect his policy of **Dhamma**, public welfare, and principles of governance. Besides these, there are **7 Major Pillar Edicts** and several **Minor Rock Edicts**.

Kalsi in Uttarakhand is the only place in North India where Emperor Ashoka had the complete collection of the **Fourteen Rock Edicts** engraved.

The principal royal symbol of the Mauryan Empire was the **Peacock**.

Mauryan Administration and Economy

The Mauryan administration was a **centralized, well-organized, and bureaucratic system**, based on the **Saptanga Theory** propounded by Chanakya.

According to this theory, the state consists of **seven essential elements**: **Swami** (King), **Amatya** (Ministers), **Janapada** (Territory/People), **Durg** (Fort), **Kosha** (Treasury), **Danda** (Army) and **Mitra** (Allies/Friends). This represented the concept of an ideal state.

The king was the central figure of Mauryan administration. He was the head of the **executive, legislature, and judiciary**. According to Chanakya, the king should consider the happiness of his subjects as his own happiness.

The Mauryan Empire was administratively divided as follows: **Province (Chakra) → Mandala → Vishaya/Ahara → Sthaniya → Dronamukha → Kharvatika → Sangrahana → Village**

The provinces were further divided into **Vishayas**. The head of a Vishaya was known as the **Vishayapati** or **Pradeshika**.

The final administrative division was the **village**. The head of the village was called the **Gramika**. The head of a group of ten villages was known as the **Gopa**. The Gopa maintained accounts and supervised the administration of the group of villages.

Urban administration was carried out through **six committees**. According to Megasthenes, each committee consisted of **five members**. Thus, the city administration was managed by a total of **30 members**.

- **Central Administration:** The king was the center of power, assisted by a Council of Ministers (*Mantriparishad*). The administration was divided into 18 departments, which were known as '**Tirthas**'.

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Major Tirthas (Officials) and Their Functions

Tirtha (Official)	Department / Function
Purohita	Head of the department of religion and charity.
Samaharta	Highest officer of the revenue department.
Sannidhata	Royal treasurer and custodian of the state treasury.
Senapati	Supreme officer of the military department.
Pradeshta	Judge of the criminal court.
Vyavaharika	Chief judge of the civil court.
Antapala	Protector of frontier forts and border regions.

Major Adhyakshas (Superintendents)

Below the Tirthas, there were heads of various departments known as **Adhyakshas**. According to the Arthashastra, their number was **26**.

Panyadhyaksha	Superintendent of commerce and trade.
Sitadhyaksha	Superintendent of royal agricultural lands.
Lakshanadhyaksha	Head of the mint department.
Akshapataladhyaksha	Chief accountant / Auditor General.
Ganikadhyaksha	Inspector of courtesans and prostitutes.
Vivitaadhyaksha	Officer responsible for the supervision of pastures.
Rupadarshaka	Inspector responsible for checking the purity of coins.
Sansthadhyaksha	Superintendent of trade routes and markets.

Espionage (Spy) System

During the Mauryan period, spies were known as '**Gudha Purusha**' (*secret agents*). The chief officer of the spy department was called the **Sarpamahamatya**. Spies were of two types:

1. **Sanstha** – Spies who worked while staying at a fixed place.
2. **Sanchara** – Mobile spies who travelled from place to place to gather information.

Military Organization

The Mauryan army consisted of four divisions:

1. **Infantry**
2. **Elephant Corps**
3. **Cavalry**
4. **Chariot Corps**

Agriculture and Economy

The main basis of the economy was **agriculture**. Royal land was called '**Sita**'.

Generally, peasants had to pay **1/6th to 1/4th** of their total produce as tax.

Taxes were collected both in: **Cash** (*Hiranya*) and **Grain** (*Meya*)

The currency system of the Mauryan period consisted of Punch-Marked (Ahat) coins.

The main currency in circulation was the **silver Karshapana (or Pana)** coins.

- **Suvarna / Nishka**: Gold coins
- **Karshapana**: Silver coins (main currency)
- **Mashaka**: Copper coins
- **Kakini**: Low-value copper coins

In the Mauryan Empire, **Tamralipti** was the most important and largest port on the eastern coast for maritime trade. Trade was conducted from here with Southeast Asian countries such as Sri Lanka, Suvarnavdipa, Java, and Sumatra.

Besides this, **Bhrigukachchha (Bharuch)** was an important port on the western coast. From here, silk, spices, and muslin were exported to Rome and Arab countries.

Judicial Administration

In the Mauryan administration, the **Supreme Court** was located in Pataliputra. The Chief Justice was known as the **Dharmadhipari** or **Dharmadhyaksha**.

He served as the highest appellate authority in both civil and criminal matters. Although the king was the head of the judiciary, the **Dharmadhipari** was the chief authority responsible for law and justice.

Courts were of two types:

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1. **Dharmasthiya** – For civil cases.
2. **Kantakashodhana** – For criminal cases.

The punishment for tax evasion could extend to the **death penalty**.

Social System

According to Chanakya, **Mauryan society** was divided into four varnas: Brahmins, Kshatriyas, Vaishyas and Shudras.

According to Megasthenes, Mauryan society was divided into **seven classes**: Philosophers, Farmers, Hunters, Artisans, Soldiers, Inspectors and Councillors.

According to Chanakya, **slavery** existed during the Mauryan period, whereas Megasthenes stated that slavery did not exist in Mauryan society.

The status of women in Mauryan society was generally good, though evidence of prostitution has also been found. Women engaged independently in prostitution were known as **Rupajivas**.

Women belonging to aristocratic households were called **Anishkasini**.

Provinces of the Mauryan Empire

The Mauryan Empire was so vast that, for administrative convenience, it was divided into several provinces. During the reign of Ashoka, the number of provinces was **five**. These provinces were known as '**Chakras**', and they were generally governed by princes known as **Aryaputras**.

Province	Capital	Present Region / Importance
Prachi (Madhya Desha)	Pataliputra	● Center of Magadha and Northern India. (Main Capital)
Uttarapatha	Taxila	● North-Western India (present-day Pakistan and Afghanistan region)
Dakshinapatha	Suvarnagiri	● Southern India
Avanti Rashtra	Ujjayini	● Western India (present-day Madhya Pradesh / Malwa region)
Kalinga	Tosali	● Eastern coast (region conquered by Ashoka in 261 BCE)

Decline of the Mauryan Dynasty

The successors after Ashoka (such as **Kunala** and **Dasharatha**) were weak rulers. The last ruler of the Mauryan dynasty was Brihadratha, who was assassinated in **185 BCE** by his commander-in-chief Pushyamitra Shunga, who then established the **Shunga Dynasty**.

The Mauryan dynasty ruled for approximately **137 years**, from **322 BCE to 185 BCE**.

Mauryan Remains Found in Bihar

Remains	Location	Importance
80-pillared Hall	Kumhrar, Patna	● Evidence of the Mauryan royal palace.
Statue of Yakshini	Didarganj, Patna	● Excellent example of Mauryan sculpture.
Barabar and Nagarjuni Hills	Jehanabad district	● Caves were carved into the hills by Emperor Ashoka and his grandson Dasharatha.
Lomas Rishi Cave	Jehanabad district	● Oldest rock-cut cave in India.
Lauriya Nandangarh	West Champaran	● The pillar here is the best preserved and has a lion capital on top.
Lauriya Areraj	East Champaran	● Another Ashokan pillar is located here.
Rampurva	West Champaran	● Two pillars were discovered here — one topped with a bull and the other with a lion.
Lohanipur Statues	Patna	● Two nude statues of Jain Tirthankaras were discovered from Lohanipur in Patna.
Bulandibagh	Patna	● Remains of the wooden palisades of the royal palace and terracotta figures (<i>such as the smiling boy's head</i>) were discovered here.

Kautilya

Kautilya, also known as **Chanakya** or **Vishnugupta**, was an ancient Indian political advisor and strategist who helped Chandragupta Maurya establish the Mauryan Empire.

He authored the **Arthashastra**, which is a foundational text on **state administration, economic policy, and military strategy**.

Due to his **realistic and power-centered approach to governance (Realpolitik)**, he is often called the "**Indian Machiavelli**." However, his work covered a much broader scope of administration and public welfare compared to Niccolo Machiavelli's famous work '**The Prince**'.

Post-Mauryan Dynasties**Shunga Dynasty**

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The **Shunga Dynasty** (c. 185–73 BCE) emerged on the soil of Magadha after the decline of the Mauryan Empire. The Shunga period is regarded as an age of “**Vedic Revival**” in Indian history because the Shungas once again provided royal patronage to **Hindu (Brahmanical) religion** and the **Sanskrit language** after the Mauryas. This dynasty ruled for approximately **112 years**.

- Pushyamitra Shunga was the founder of the Shunga dynasty. He was the commander-in-chief of the last Mauryan emperor Brihadratha. In **185 BCE**, he **assassinated Brihadratha** and seized the throne of Magadha.
- Pushyamitra retained Pataliputra (*modern Patna*) as his principal capital, but also established **Vidisha (Madhya Pradesh)** as the second capital of administration.
- Pushyamitra Shunga performed the **Ashvamedha Yajna** twice at Pataliputra. These sacrifices were conducted by the famous **grammarian Patanjali**, who served as Pushyamitra's royal priest.
- During the Shunga period, Pataliputra continued to remain a major center of art and literature. It was during this period that the present form of the Manusmriti and **Patanjali's Mahabhashya** were composed.
- The **Ayodhya Inscription** of Pushyamitra's governor Dhanadeva is an important source of information regarding the Shunga victories and sacrifices.
- Some texts such as Divyavadana describe Pushyamitra as an opponent of Buddhism. However, historical evidence also shows that during the Shunga period the **Bharhut Stupa** was developed and the stone railing of the Sanchi Stupa was constructed.
- A major part of the ancient stone railing surrounding the **Mahabodhi Temple at Bodh Gaya** is also believed to have been built during the Shunga period. The name of Queen **Kurangi** is inscribed on it.
- The last ruler of the Shunga dynasty was Devabhuti, who was extremely pleasure-loving. In **73 BCE**, he was assassinated by his minister **Vasudeva Kanva**, after which the **Kanva Dynasty** was established in Magadha.

Important Facts

1. **Main Language:** Sanskrit (*received official patronage*).
2. **Major Scholar:** Patanjali.
3. **Foreign Invasion:** During the Shunga period, the Greek (Yavana) invader Demetrius I attacked Pataliputra, but the invasion was defeated by Pushyamitra's grandson Vasumitra.
4. **Heliodorus Pillar:** The Heliodorus Pillar, also known as the **Garuda Dhvaja**, is an ancient stone pillar erected around **113 BCE** at Besnagar near Vidisha. It was built by Heliodorus, an **Indo-Greek ambassador from Taxila** who came to the court of the **Shunga king Bhagabhadra**. It symbolizes early Indo-Greek diplomacy and religious syncretism.
5. **Patanjali:** The famous ancient Indian grammarian Patanjali was a contemporary of Pushyamitra Shunga. He is believed to have served as a priest or advisor in rituals performed by Pushyamitra, including the Ashvamedha sacrifice. He composed the **Mahabhashya**.

Kanva Dynasty

The **Kanva Dynasty** (c. 73–28 BCE) was a short-lived **Brahmin dynasty** that ruled Magadha after overthrowing the Shunga Dynasty from **Pataliputra** (modern Bihar).

Their rule remained mainly confined to Magadha, as the Magadhan Empire had greatly declined in size compared to the period of the Mauryas and the early Shunga rulers.

Founded by **Vasudeva Kanva**, this dynasty ruled a weakened empire for about **45 years**, which was later conquered by the **Satavahanas**.

Kushan Dynasty

The **Kushan Dynasty** was a branch of the **Yuezhi tribes** from Central Asia, who entered India around the beginning of the **1st century CE**. In Indian history, they hold a unique position in the fields of **art, religion, and trade**.

Kujula Kadphises founded the Kushan Dynasty in the **1st century CE**. He mainly conquered the regions of **Kabul** and **Kandahar**.

Vima Kadphises expanded the empire into the north-western parts of India. He was the first ruler in India to issue **gold coins on a large scale**.

Kanishka was the most powerful and famous ruler of the Kushan Dynasty. His coronation is believed to have taken place around **78 CE**, and the beginning of the **Shaka Era** is also associated with this year.

Kanishka

The reign of **Kanishka** is regarded as the **Golden Age of the Kushan Empire**. His first capital was **Purushapura** (modern Peshawar) and the second capital was **Mathura**.

Kanishka patronized **Buddhism**. During his reign, the **Fourth Buddhist Council** was held at **Kundalvana in Kashmir**.

His court included famous scholars such as: **Ashvaghosha** (author of *Buddhacharita*), **Vasumitra**, **Nagarjuna**, and **Charaka** (the great physician). The greatest economic achievement of Kanishka was his control over the **Silk Route**.

During the **Kushana period**, two major schools of sculpture developed:

1. **Gandhara Style:** It shows a strong **Greek (Hellenistic) influence**. In this style, Buddha images were represented in a form similar to **Greek gods**, with realistic human features and drapery.
 2. **Mathura Style:** It was a completely **indigenous Indian style**. In this style, statues of **Buddha and other deities** were made using **red sandstone**.
- The Kushan Empire gradually weakened during the reigns of Kanishka's successors such as **Huvishka** and **Vasudeva**.

Special Fact: The Kushan rulers adopted the title “Devaputra”, meaning “Son of God”.

Gupta Empire

The **Gupta Empire** is regarded as a “Golden Age” in Indian history. During this period, unprecedented progress was made in the fields of **art, science, literature, and politics**.

- **Sri Gupta (240 CE – 280 CE):** He founded the **Gupta Dynasty** around **275 CE**.
- The 7th-century Chinese traveller **I-tsing (Yijing)** credited Sri Gupta with donating land and resources for Chinese Buddhist monks.
- According to Yijing’s accounts, “**King Che-li-ki-to**” (identified as Sri Gupta) constructed a temple near **Mrigashikhavana (Deer Park)** close to Magadha, especially for Chinese Buddhist pilgrims. This temple became famous as the “**Temple of China**.”
- The king granted the revenue of **24 villages** (according to some sources, 40 villages) for the maintenance of the temple and the support of the monks residing there.
- **Ghatotkacha Gupta (280 CE – 320 CE):** He was the successor of Sri Gupta. He was the first ruler to assume the title “**Maharaja**.”

Major Rulers

Chandragupta I (320 CE – 335 CE)

- **Chandragupta I** is considered the first influential ruler of the Gupta Empire and is regarded as the **real founder of the Gupta Empire**.
- He started the **Gupta Era (Gupta Samvat)** in **320 CE**.
- He married the **Lichchhavi princess Kumaradevi**, which greatly increased the power and prestige of the empire.
- Chandragupta issued “**King-Queen type**” **gold coins**, featuring the images of Chandragupta and Kumaradevi on one side and the word “**Lichchhavayah**” (the Lichchhavis) on the other. Another side depicts a goddess (**Ambika/Lakshmi**) seated on a lion.
- He was the first Gupta ruler to adopt the grand imperial title “**Maharajadhiraja**.”

Samudragupta (335 CE – 375 CE)

- **Samudragupta** occupies a special place in history because of his remarkable military conquests.
- Historian **V. A. Smith** called Samudragupta the “**Napoleon of India**.”
- The Buddhist king of Sri Lanka, **Meghavarmman**, sent an envoy to Samudragupta seeking permission to build a monastery and temple at **Bodhi Gaya** for Buddhist pilgrims. Samudragupta accepted the request and permitted the construction of a grand monastery.
- Details of Samudragupta’s campaigns are found in the “**Prayag Prashasti**” composed by **Harishena**, according to which he defeated **9 kings of Aryavarta (Northern India)** and **12 kings of Dakshinapatha (Southern India)**.
- Samudragupta is depicted playing the **veena** on his coins and was also known as “**Kaviraja**” (King among Poets).
- He followed **Vaishnavism** and also performed the **Ashvamedha Yajna**.
- He adopted several grand titles to display his power and prestige, such as: **Kaviraja** (King of Poets), **Ashvamedha Parakrama Vikramanka** and **Apratiratha**.
- In the Prayag Prashasti, Samudragupta is referred to as “**Lichchhavi Dauhitra**” (grandson of the Lichchhavis).
- The title “**Parama Bhagavata**” of Samudragupta is mentioned in the Nalanda Copper Plate Inscription, Gaya Copper Plate Inscription, and the Allahabad Inscription.

Chandragupta II (375 CE – 415 CE)

- **Chandragupta II**, also known as “**Vikramaditya**,” was one of the most powerful and glorious emperors of the Gupta Dynasty. He was the son of Samudragupta, and his reign is considered the peak of the **Golden Age of Indian history**.
- After Samudragupta, **Ramagupta** became ruler, but Chandragupta II killed him and declared himself king.
- After defeating the Shaka ruler **Rudrasimha III** in **389 CE**, he adopted the title “**Vikramaditya**.”
- After conquering the **Western Kshatrapas (Shakas)**, he assumed the title “**Shakari**” (“Destroyer of the Shakas”).
- The son of Chandragupta II (Vikramaditya) was **Kumaragupta I**, who founded **Nalanda University**. His daughter **Prabhavati Gupta** was married to the Vakataka ruler **Rudrasena II**.
- His court had a group of **nine scholars**, known as the “**Navaratnas**.” The most famous among them was the great poet **Kalidasa**. Other notable scholars included **Varahamihira** (astronomer) and **Dhanvantari** (physician).
- The Chinese traveller **Fa-Hien** visited India during his reign and stayed for **14 years**. His famous work is “**Fo-Kwo-Ki**” or *Record of Buddhist Kingdoms*.
- The **Mehrauli Iron Pillar** inscription of Delhi, mentioning a king named “**Chandra**,” is generally associated with Chandragupta II.

Kumaragupta I (415 CE – 455 CE)

- **Kumaragupta I** was the son and successor of **Chandragupta II Vikramaditya**.
- He was also known as “**Mahendraditya**.”
- The greatest achievement of Kumaragupta I’s reign is considered to be the establishment of **Nalanda University**.

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- During the Gupta period, this university became a major center of learning, especially for **Buddhist education**.
- Kumaragupta I was a devoted worshipper of **Kartikeya**, the son of Lord Shiva. He issued coins depicting **Kartikeya seated on a peacock**.

Skandagupta (455 CE – 467 CE)

- During the reign of **Skandagupta**, the **Hunas**, a barbarian tribe from Central Asia, invaded India. Skandagupta defeated them and drove them out of India. This event is mentioned in the **Junagadh Inscription**.
- In the Junagadh Inscription, the Hunas are referred to as **"Mlechchhas."**
- Skandagupta also restored the **Sudarshana Lake**, which had originally been constructed by **Chandragupta Maurya**. According to the Junagadh Inscription, **Chakrapalita**, the son of the governor of Junagadh, **Parnadatta**, rebuilt the embankment of the lake.
- The last ruler of the Gupta Dynasty was **Vishnugupta**. With the decline of the Gupta Empire, the supremacy of **Magadha** also came to an end.

Gupta Administration**Central Administration**

- The center of administration was the **Emperor himself**. He possessed extensive powers and assumed grand titles such as **"Paramabhattacharaka"** and **"Maharajadhiraja."**
- During the Gupta period, the king enjoyed divine authority, but unlike the Mauryan period, the administration was not completely centralized. However, the king still exercised administrative, military, and judicial powers.
- The Gupta Empire extensively used a **feudal system** for administration.
- The Guptas began granting large areas of land to **Brahmins, temples, and secular officials** instead of paying salaries in cash.
- Due to the decline in foreign trade, the economy became increasingly **agrarian**, strengthening the position of landed intermediaries.
- This system led to the rise of a special class of **landlords**, often at the expense of local peasants.
- To assist the king, there was a **Council of Ministers (Mantriparishad)**.

Major Officials

- **Kumaramatyaya**: The most important officials (similar to modern IAS officers), serving at both provincial and central levels.
- **Mahadandanayaka**: Chief Justice.
- **Sandhivigrahaika**: Minister of War and Peace (Foreign Minister).
- **Mahabaladhikrita**: Supreme military commander.

Provincial Administration

For administrative convenience, the empire was divided into several units:

Desha / Rashtra → Bhukti (Province) → Vishaya (District) → Vithi (Sub-division/Tahsil) → Grama (Village)

The head of the country/kingdom (Desha/Rashtra) was the **Gopta**. The head of a Bhukti (province) was the **Uparika**. The head of a Vishaya (district) was the **Vishayapati**, and the head of a village was the **Gramika**.

Local and Urban Administration

One of the most significant features of the Gupta period was its relatively **democratic local administration**.

At the district level (**Vishaya**), administration was carried out through a **Vishaya Parishad (District Council)**, which included representatives from different sections of society:

- **Nagar Shreshthi**: Chief merchant of the city.
- **Sarthavaha**: Leader of merchant caravans.
- **Kulika**: Chief artisan.
- **Kayastha**: Chief scribe or secretary.

Revenue and Finance

The main source of state income was **land revenue**.

- Generally, **1/4th to 1/6th** of the agricultural produce was collected as tax.
- Other important taxes included: **Bhaga** – share of agricultural produce, **Bhoga** – gifts and offerings presented to the king ; and **Shulka** – customs duty/toll tax.

Judicial System

The judicial system during the Gupta period was comparatively **lenient and humane**.

According to the Chinese traveller **Fa-Hien**, criminals were not given very harsh punishments, and the death penalty was extremely rare.

For the first time in Indian history, **civil and criminal laws were clearly distinguished** during this period.

Military System

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The Gupta rulers maintained a large and organized army consisting of four major divisions: **Padati** – Infantry, **Ashvarohi** – Cavalry, **Ratha** – Chariots and **Gaja Sena** – Elephant corps.

Social System

During the Gupta period, the **Varna system** became more rigid and evolved into a complex **caste system**. For example, the **Kayastha caste** is mentioned for the first time during this period.

- Evidence of **untouchability** is also found during this age. Untouchable communities were forced to live outside villages.
- The status of women declined considerably compared to earlier periods.
- The first evidence of the **Sati system** is found in the **Eran Inscription of Bhanugupta (510 CE)**. It mentions a brave general named **Goparaja**, who died fighting the Hunas alongside Bhanugupta, after which his wife committed **Sati**.

Ports of the Gupta Period

Ports on the Eastern Coast- Tamralipti (located in the present-day Midnapore district of West Bengal), **Ghantashala** and **Kadura** (located in the Andhra region).

- The ports on the eastern coast were mainly used for trade with **South-East Asian countries** such as **Sri Lanka, Java, Sumatra, Malaya, and Cambodia**, as well as with **China**.

Ports on the Western Coast- Bhargukachchha / Broach (Bharuch) – present-day Gujarat, **Cambay** – present-day Gujarat.

- Through the western coastal ports, trade was carried out with **Rome, Arabia, Egypt**, and the countries of the **Persian Gulf**.

Coins of the Gupta Period

During the Gupta period, **gold coins** were known as “**Dinaras**.”

During the Gupta period, **silver coins** were called “**Rupakas**.” These were first introduced by **Chandragupta II**.

The first Gupta ruler to issue **gold coins (Dinaras)** was **Chandragupta I**.

Chandragupta II was the first Gupta ruler to issue **silver coins (Rupakas)**.

A noticeable decline in the purity of gold coins began during the reign of **Skandagupta**.

Nalanda University**Foundation and Patronage**

Nalanda University was established in the **5th century CE** by the Gupta ruler **Kumaragupta I (Mahendraditya)**.

After the Gupta rulers, Harshavardhana and the rulers of the **Pala Dynasty** also patronized the university.

Education System and Curriculum

Nalanda was not confined only to religious education. Various subjects were taught here, including: Buddhism (Mahayana), Vedas, Logic, Grammar, Medical Science, Mathematics and Astronomy

Admission to Nalanda was extremely difficult. The gatekeepers conducted rigorous examinations, and only **20–30%** of students could qualify.

“Dharmaganja” – The Great Library

Nalanda’s library was world-famous and was known as “**Dharmaganja**.” It was housed in three massive buildings: Ratnasagara, Ratnodadhi and Ratnaranjaka

International Fame

Nalanda became so famous that students from countries such as **China, Korea, Japan, Tibet, Sumatra, and Java** came here for education.

The famous Chinese traveller Xuanzang visited Nalanda during the reign of Harshavardhana. He spent time there both as a student and as a teacher.

Yijing was another Chinese traveller who described the strict discipline and lifestyle of Nalanda.

Decline of the University

Nalanda retained its glory for nearly **800 years**, but at the end of the 12th century, the Turkish invader Bakhtiyar Khalji destroyed it.

He set fire to the university and massacred the monks residing there, causing an irreparable loss to Indian knowledge and learning.

Important Facts

- Education, food, and accommodation at Nalanda were completely free of cost. The expenses were met through revenue collected from more than **100 villages**.
- In **2014**, the Government of India revived Nalanda University near Rajgir (Bihar) as an international university.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the new campus of Nalanda University at Rajgir, Bihar, on **19 June 2024**. The campus is noted for its architecture and **net-zero carbon footprint**.

Note: Historian V. A. Smith described the Gupta period as the “**Golden Age**” because of its remarkable cultural achievements.

Gupta Art

During the Gupta period, remarkable progress took place in **architecture, painting, sculpture, and literature**. Under architecture, the construction of temples (Nagara style), caves, and viharas (monasteries) became prominent during the Gupta age.

A beautiful idol of **Kartikkeya** belonging to the Gupta period has been discovered from **Shahabad district**.

In the field of cave architecture, the famous **Ajanta Caves** (Maharashtra) and **Bagh Caves** (Madhya Pradesh) were developed during the Gupta period itself. Paintings related to both **Buddhism** and **Hinduism** have been found in these caves.

During the Gupta period (5th–6th century CE), the **Mahabodhi Temple** at Bodh Gaya was reconstructed as a massive brick structure.

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Literature During the Gupta Period

Author	Works
Kalidasa	Abhijnanashakuntalam, Malavikagnimitram, Raghuvamsham, Kumarasambhavam, Meghaduta, Ritusamhara, Vikramorvashiyam
Shudraka	Mrichchhakatikam
Aryabhata	Aryabhattachiyam, Surya Siddhanta, Dashagitika
Brahmagupta ("Newton of India")	Brahma Siddhanta
Vishnu Sharma	Panchatantra
Vatsyayana	Kamasutra
Kamandaka	Nitisara
Amarasimha	Amarakosha

Other Dynasties

Pala Dynasty

The **Pala Dynasty** (c. 750–1174 CE) is considered a period of "**Renaissance**" for Bihar and Bengal. After the decline of the Gupta Empire and the resulting condition of anarchy (**Matsyanyaya** – "law of the fishes," where the strong oppressed the weak), the Pala rulers once again transformed Bihar into a major center of knowledge, art, and political power.

The founder of the Pala dynasty was **Gopala**. He established **Odantapuri University** near Bihar Sharif (Nalanda).

Dharmapala was the greatest ruler of this dynasty. He founded Vikramashila University in the Bhagalpur district. He revived Nalanda University and donated 200 villages for its maintenance. He participated in the famous **Tripartite Struggle** and, after achieving success in the conflict, held his royal court at Pataliputra.

During the Tripartite Struggle for the control of Kannauj, the Pala king Dharmapala emerged as a major contender against the **Gurjara-Pratiharas** and the **Rashtrakutas**. After defeating the then ruler **Indrayudha**, Dharmapala did not directly annex Kannauj into his empire. Instead, he installed **Chakrayudha** (often considered the brother of Indrayudha) on the throne as his feudatory or puppet ruler.

To strengthen this arrangement, Dharmapala organized a grand royal assembly at Kannauj, attended by various feudatories of Northern India. As a result, he earned the title "**Uttarapathasvamin**" (Lord of the North).

The 11th-century poet **Sodhala** referred to Dharmapala as "**Uttarapathasvamin**" (Lord of Northern India). Being a follower of Buddhism, he also adopted the title "**Paramasaugata**."

After Dharmapala, **Devapala** became the ruler. He made **Munger (Bihar)** his capital. During his reign, the Pala Empire reached the peak of its territorial expansion.

The Arab traveller Sulaiman visited India during the reign of Devapala in the 9th century.

Note: The Pala rulers were great patrons of **Buddhism**, especially the **Vajrayana sect**. During their rule, Bihar became a global center of education.

Pala Art

During the Pala period in Bihar, a distinct style of art developed, known as the "**Pala Style**."

Bronze Sculptures: Dhiman and Vitapala were the chief artists of this style. A large number of bronze images of Buddha have been discovered from Gaya and Nalanda.

Pala Terracotta Art: Beautiful terracotta artworks have been found from Vikramashila and Bhagalpur.

Manuscript Painting: The art of painting on palm leaves developed during this period. A famous example is the manuscript "**Ashtasahasrika Prajnaparamita**."

Medieval Bihar

- ✓ Bihar during Turkish Rule
- ✓ Delhi Sultanate and Bihar
- ✓ Local Rulers of Bihar

- ✓ Afghan Period and Bihar
- ✓ Bihar under the Mughals
- ✓ Sikhism in Bihar

Bihar During Turkish Rule

The arrival of Turkish rule in Bihar at the end of the 12th century completely transformed the history of the region. The beginning of Turkish rule in Bihar is mainly associated with the invasions of **Bakhtiyar Khalji**.

Ikhtiyar-ud-din Muhammad bin Bakhtiyar Khalji is regarded as the real founder of Turkish power in Bihar. He was a military commander and slave of **Qutb-ud-din Aibak**.

He first conquered **Odantapuri (Bihar Sharif)** in **1198 CE**. After this, he captured most parts of Magadha.

Bakhtiyar Khalji also destroyed the world-famous universities of **Nalanda** and **Vikramashila** and set fire to their renowned libraries. The library of ancient Nalanda University, known as **Dharmaganja ("Mountain of Truth")**, consisted of three massive multi-storeyed buildings—**Ratnasagara**, **Ratnodadhi**, and **Ratnaranjaka**—which contained lakhs of manuscripts.

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He made **Bihar Sharif** his main administrative center.

Around **1203–1204 CE**, Bakhtiyar Khalji suddenly attacked and conquered **Nadia (Nabadwip)**, the capital of **Lakshman Sena**, the ruler of the Sena dynasty of Bengal. After this victory, Bakhtiyar made **Lakhnauti (Gaur)** his capital.

After the disastrous failure of the Tibet expedition, Bakhtiyar Khalji became physically ill and mentally distressed. Subsequently, in **August 1206 CE**, he was assassinated by **Ali Mardan Khalji**.

Bakhtiyar Khalji was buried at **Imadpur in Bihar Sharif**.

Exam-Oriented Facts

During the invasions of Bihar and Bengal by **Bakhtiyar Khalji** around **1203–1204 CE**, **Narasimha Deva** of the **Karnata dynasty** was ruling over **Mithila (Bihar)**.

He cooperated with the Turkish invaders (**Bakhtiyar Khalji**).

Delhi Sultanate and Bihar**Slave Dynasty (Mamluk Dynasty)**

After **Bakhtiyar Khalji**, a continuous struggle took place between the Sultans of Delhi and the rulers of Bengal for control over Bihar.

Iltutmish was the first Sultan of the Delhi Sultanate who launched a campaign in Bihar in **1225 CE**. He defeated **Hisamuddin Iwaz** and established the supremacy of Delhi over Bihar.

Iltutmish appointed **Malik Alauddin Jani** as the first representative (**Subedar/Governor**) of Bihar. In **1229–30 CE**, Iltutmish separated **Bengal and Bihar** administratively.

During the reign of **Ghiyasuddin Balban (1266–1287 CE)**, **Tatar Khan** was the governor of Bihar. When Balban ascended the throne of Delhi, Tatar Khan presented him with **63 elephants** as a royal gift.

Khilji Dynasty

After assuming power in **1296 CE**, **Alauddin Khilji** sent **Shaikh Muhammad Ismail** to conquer **Darbhangha (Mithila)**.

The local **Karnata dynasty** ruler **Raja Shakti Singh** initially defeated the Delhi army, but later a treaty was concluded between the two sides.

Tughlaq Period: The Golden Age of Bihar

The Tughlaq period witnessed the greatest stability and administrative reforms in Bihar. During this period, the decisive dominance of the Delhi Sultans over Bihar was firmly established.

Origin of the Name "Bihar": It was during the Tughlaq period that this region came to be known as "**Bihar**." The name was mentioned for the first time in **Minhaj-us-Siraj's** book *Tabaqat-i-Nasiri*.

Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq

In **1324–25 CE**, he defeated **Harisingh Deva**, the ruler of the Karnata dynasty of North Bihar, and annexed the **Tirhut region** into the Delhi Sultanate.

Muhammad bin Tughlaq

- Although **Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq** defeated Harisingh Deva, but complete control over the Tirhut region was established during the reign of **Muhammad bin Tughlaq**.
- He renamed the Tirhut region (**Mithila/Darbhangha**) as "**Tughlaqpur**."
- Under the Delhi Sultanate, **Darbhangha** functioned as a mint center and was specifically identified during Muhammad bin Tughlaq's reign as "**Iqlim Tughlaqpur alias Tirhut**" (Province of Tughlaqpur/Tirhut).
- An **Arabic inscription dated 1326 CE** on the **Jama Masjid of Darbhanga** confirms this status and reflects the incorporation of the region into the Sultanate's administrative and monetary system.
- The establishment of this mint marked the consolidation of Tughlaq rule in the Tirhut region.
- This mint was established at the same time when Muhammad bin Tughlaq introduced **token currency**, issuing coins made of **copper and brass**.
- **Malik Ibrahim (Malik Baya)**: He was an outstanding administrator of Bihar during the reign of Muhammad bin Tughlaq.

Firoz Shah Tughlaq

- In **1359–60 CE**, **Firoz Shah Tughlaq** launched military campaigns against the Bengal ruler **Shamsuddin Ilyas Shah** (and later his son **Sikandar Shah**). While marching toward Bengal, he passed through Bihar. During this campaign, he conquered several regions of Bihar and brought them under the Delhi Sultanate.
- Firoz Shah Tughlaq deeply respected the great Sufi saint of Bihar, **Makhdum Sharafuddin Yahya Maneri**. According to historians, Firoz Shah personally visited Bihar to meet him.
- During the reign of Firoz Shah Tughlaq, the tomb of his general and then governor of Bihar, **Malik Ibrahim Baya**, was constructed at **Bihar Sharif (Badi Pahari)**. It is considered an excellent example of **Tughlaq architecture**.
- Inscriptions found in the Jain temples of **Rajgir** provide evidence of grants made by Firoz Shah Tughlaq.

Political and Cultural Impact of the Tughlaq Period in Bihar

- **Capital:** During the Tughlaq period, the capital of Bihar was **Bihar Sharif** (it was shifted to Patna during the Mughal period).
- **Sufi Saints:** During this period, **Sufism** spread widely in Bihar. **Maner** and **Bihar Sharif** became major centers of Sufi saints such as **Hazrat Makhdum Sharafuddin Yahya Maneri**.
- **Decline of Buddhism:** Due to Turkish invasions, Buddhist monks migrated toward **Tibet and Nepal**, leading to the near disappearance of Buddhism in Bihar.

Sayyid Dynasty

- During this period, most parts of Bihar came under the control of the **Sharqi dynasty of Jaunpur**.
- The Sharqi Sultan **Ibrahim Shah Sharqi (1402–1440 CE)** established control over a large part of Bihar.
- Due to the weakness of the last Sayyid ruler, **Alauddin Alam Shah**, the power of Afghan chiefs increased in Bihar and nearby regions. This later paved the way for the rise of the **Lodi dynasty** and subsequently the **Nuhani dynasty**.

Lodi Dynasty

After defeating the Sharqi ruler of Jaunpur, **Husain Shah Sharqi**, **Sikandar Lodi** appointed **Dariya Khan Nuhani** as the administrator/governor (**Subedar**) of Bihar.

Local Rulers of Bihar**Karnata Dynasty of Mithila**

During the decline of the Pala dynasty, the **Karnata dynasty** emerged in the **Tirhut–Mithila** region. The Karnata dynasty of Tirhut-Mithila (**1097 CE – 1324 CE**) represents a glorious chapter in the history of Bihar. The rule of this dynasty is regarded as the **“Golden Age of Mithila”** because during this period, **Maithili culture, music, and scholarly traditions** witnessed unprecedented growth.

Nanyadeva

The dynasty was founded by **Nanyadeva** in **1097 CE**. He originally belonged to **South India (Karnataka)** and came to North India along with the **Chalukya army**.

Nanyadeva made **Simraongarh** (presently near the Nepal border) his capital.

He assumed the title **“Karnatakul Bhushan.”**

The Sena ruler **Vijaya Sena** defeated Nanyadeva, which is mentioned in the **Devapara Prashasti**.

Narasimha Deva

During the Bihar campaign of **Bakhtiyar Khalji**, the Karnata ruler **Narasimha Deva** cooperated with him by offering tribute/gifts, because the Karnata dynasty was in constant conflict with the **Sena dynasty**.

Around **1244 CE**, the Turkish commander **Tughril Tughan** invaded the Karnata kingdom. At that time, Mithila (Tirhut) was ruled by **King Narasimha Deva** of the Karnata dynasty. This event has been mentioned by the Tibetan traveler **Dharmasvamin (Dharmaswami)**.

Shaktisingh Deva (Shakr Dev)

After coming to power in **1296 CE**, **Alauddin Khilji** sent **Shaikh Muhammad Ismail** to conquer **Darbhangha (Mithila)**. However, initially **King Shakr Singh** defeated Shaikh Muhammad Ismail.

Harisimha Deva

Harisimha Deva was the last ruler of this dynasty. He introduced the **“Panji System”** (genealogical record system) for the **Brahmins and Kayasthas of Mithila**.

His court was home to great philosophers and scholars. His minister **Chandeshwar Thakur** composed the famous work **“Rajniti Ratnakar.”**

In **1324 CE**, while returning from the Bengal campaign, the Delhi Sultan **Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq** invaded Mithila.

King Harisimha Deva was defeated in battle and took refuge in the hills of Nepal.

With this, the direct rule of the Karnata dynasty in Mithila came to an end. Later, the Tughlaqs handed over power to the **Vainwar/Oinwar dynasty (Kameshwar Thakur)**.

Exam-Oriented Facts

- **Maithili Language:** During this period, the **Maithili language** received royal patronage. The development of Maithili language took place during the rule of the Karnata dynasty.
- **Art and Music:** **Jyotirishwar Thakur** composed **“Varna Ratnakar”** during this period, which is considered the **first prose work in Maithili literature**.
- **Religious Development:** During this period, **Smriti** and **Nyaya Shastra** developed significantly in Mithila.

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Oinwar Dynasty in Tirhut (Mithila)

- During his Bengal campaign, Firoz Shah Tughlaq completely ended the influence of the last rulers of the Karnata dynasty of Tirhut (after the decline of Harisimha Deva and the resulting instability), and he selected **Kameshwar Thakur** to administer the region.
- Kameshwar Thakur was a learned Brahmin. The descendants of Kameshwar Thakur used the title "Thakur" and later adopted the title "Singh."
- The initial capital of this dynasty was **Oini (Samastipur)**, which was later shifted to **Sugouna (Devkuli, Gajarathpur, Visali, Padma)** and other places.
- This dynasty is regarded as a great patron of art and literature. The famous poet **Vidyapati** was the court poet and close friend of **King Shiv Singh** of this dynasty.

Exam-Oriented Facts

- King Shiv Singh donated the village **Bisfi** to Vidyapati in recognition of his poetic talent.
- Vidyapati addressed Shiv Singh with the title "**Rupnarayan**."

Social and Cultural Condition of Bihar During the Oinwar Period

Synthesis of Sanskrit and Maithili: During this period, along with Sanskrit, the regional language **Maithili** also developed greatly. Vidyapati elevated the language through his famous works such as "**Kirtilata**" and "**Kirtipataka**."

Panji System: At the social level, the "**Panji System**" (genealogical record system) among Brahmins and Kayasthas became more organized and systematic during this period.

Rise of Darbhanga Raj and Decline of the Oinwar Dynasty

By the end of the 15th century and the beginning of the 16th century, the Oinwar dynasty had become completely weak. Finally, during the reign of the Mughal Emperor **Akbar**, the responsibility of this region was entrusted to **Mahesh Thakur**. This led to the rise of the **Khandwala Dynasty (Darbhanga Raj)** and marked the end of the Oinwar dynasty.

Exam-Oriented Facts

Vidyapati is known as the "**Maithil Kokil**" and "**Abhinava Jayadeva**." He composed literary works in **three languages**:

Language	Major Works	Description
Maithili	Padavali	It contains devotional songs on the love of Radha-Krishna and hymns dedicated to Lord Shiva (Nachari songs). This is considered his most popular work.
Avahatta	Kirtilata, Kirtipataka	In <i>Kirtilata</i> , Vidyapati vividly described the bravery of King Kirtisingha and the contemporary society and culture of Jaunpur.
Sanskrit	Purusha Pariksha, Likhanavali, Shaivasarvasvasara	<i>Purusha Pariksha</i> is an extraordinary work that imparts moral teachings through stories and narratives.

Khandavala Dynasty (Darbhanga Raj)

The **Khandavala Dynasty**, popularly known as **Darbhangha Raj**, was founded by **Mahesh Thakur**.

The ruler **Maharaja Lakshman Singh** gave a permanent administrative structure and stability to the Darbhanga Raj.

During the **Revolt of 1857**, the Darbhanga ruler **Maharaja Maheshwar Singh** supported the British government.

The **Tirhut Railway (Tirhut State Railway)** was established in **1874** by **Maharaja Lakshmeshwar Singh** of Darbhanga Raj. It is often regarded as **India's first private railway service**. It was mainly constructed as a "**Famine Line**" to transport food grains and relief materials to the drought-affected regions of North Bihar.

The initial **55-mile railway track** from **Bajitpur (near Barauni) to Darbhanga** was completed in just **62 days**. The railway network had a unique arrangement of **three separate stations** for different purposes:

- Harahi Station** (present-day Darbhanga Junction): Used for the movement of the general public.
- Laheriasarai Station**: Used for British officials and administrative activities.
- Nargauna Terminal**: It was the Maharaja's private station, directly connected to the Nargauna (Chatra Niwas) Palace Complex.

The last ruler of this dynasty was **Maharaja Kameshwar Singh**, who also participated in the Constituent Assembly of India.

Exam-Oriented Facts

- During **1919–1922**, a major peasant movement took place under the leadership of **Swami Vidyanand** during the reign of **Maharaja Rameshwar Singh** of Darbhanga.
- The **Bakasht Peasant Movement (1937–38)** occurred during the reign of the last Darbhanga ruler **Maharaja Kameshwar Singh**. This movement was led by **Swami Sahajanand Saraswati**, one of the greatest peasant leaders of modern Bihar.

Chero Dynasty

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The Chero Dynasty emerged after the decline of the Pala Dynasty in the 12th century.

The influence of this dynasty was mainly spread across the regions of Palamu, Shahabad (Bhojpur), Saran, Muzaffarpur, and Champaran.

The headquarters of the Bhojpur branch of the Chero Dynasty was located at **Bihiya (Bhojpur)**.

The most prominent ruler of this dynasty was **Medini Rai (1658–1674)**. During his reign, the people were considered highly prosperous and content. A famous saying became popular during his rule: “Raja Medini Rai, Ghar-Ghar Baje Mathaniya” (meaning every household was prosperous enough to churn curd and dairy products).

Gradually, the dynasty declined under the growing influence of the Mughal rulers.

The Chero rulers were well known for their martial character and their powerful “**Barah-Hazari**” army consisting of approximately **12,000 soldiers**.

Exam-Oriented Facts**Conflict of the Chero Dynasty with the Mughals**

During Akbar’s Reign: The Mughal general **Raja Man Singh** attacked the Cheros in **1591 CE**.

During Shah Jahan and Aurangzeb: During the reign of **Shah Jahan**, **Shaista Khan** launched campaigns against Palamu. During the reign of **Aurangzeb**, **Daud Khan** attacked Palamu. In **1660 CE**, Daud Khan captured the **Palamu Fort**, after which the power of the Cheros gradually weakened.

Conflict of the Chero Dynasty with the British

By the beginning of the 19th century, the power of the Chero Dynasty had largely disintegrated. The British used diplomatic and financial strategies to trap the Chero rulers in debt, and eventually the Palamu Zamindari was auctioned around 1813–14. This led to the Chero Revolt (1800–1802 CE), which was led by Bhushan Singh.

Afghan Period and Bihar

The Afghan Period in Bihar (approximately 1490–1576 CE) occupies a highly significant place in the history of Bihar. During this period, Bihar emerged not merely as a province but as a major political center of North India.

Sikandar Lodi and Bihar

The reign of Sikandar Lodi (1489–1517 CE) marked a turning point in the history of Bihar. During this period, Bihar was clearly divided between the Delhi Sultanate and Bengal, and the direct control of the Lodi Dynasty was firmly established in the region.

Sikandar Lodi’s Bihar Campaign (1495–96 CE)

Before Sikandar Lodi, Bihar was under the influence of the **Sharqi Sultans of Jaunpur**. After Sikandar Lodi defeated **Husain Shah Sharqi**, the ruler of Jaunpur, the latter fled to Bihar near Patna.

Sikandar Lodi pursued him and completely defeated him near **Bihar Sharif** in **1495 CE**. With this victory, Bihar came under the control of the Lodis. After establishing authority over Bihar, Sikandar Lodi came into conflict with the powerful Bengal ruler **Alauddin Husain Shah**. However, instead of war, both rulers entered into a **non-aggression treaty**. As a result of this treaty **Barh (Barh town)** was accepted as the boundary between the two kingdoms. The region of Munger and eastward territories remained under Bengal. Western Bihar came under the Delhi Sultanate.

Nuhani Dynasty (Independent Afghan State of Bihar)

Sikandar Lodi appointed **Dariya Khan Nuhani** as the governor (**Subedar**) of Bihar.

After the death of Dariya Khan Nuhani in **1523 CE**, his son **Bahar Khan Nuhani** came to power.

When **Ibrahim Lodi** ascended the throne of Delhi, conflicts increased between him and the Afghan nobles. After the **First Battle of Panipat (1526 CE)**, Bahar Khan Nuhani declared himself “**Sultan Muhammad Shah**” and laid the foundation of an independent Afghan state in Bihar.

It was in the court of **Bahar Khan Nuhani** that **Farid Khan (Sher Shah Suri)** received the title “**Sher Khan**.”

Rise of Sher Shah Suri

The most glorious chapter of Afghan rule in Bihar is associated with **Sher Shah Suri (Farid Khan)**.

His father **Hasan Khan** was the Jagirdar of **Sasaram**. Due to conflicts with his father, Farid entered the service of **Sultan Muhammad Shah (Bahar Khan Nuhani)**.

During a hunting expedition, Farid reportedly killed a tiger single-handedly with one sword strike. Impressed by his bravery, Sultan Muhammad Shah granted him the title “**Sher Khan**.”

The Sultan also appointed Sher Khan as the guardian of his son **Jalal Khan**.

Major Battles

Around **1529–1530 CE**, Sher Shah Suri defeated the army of **Nusrat Shah**, the Sultan of Bengal, and strengthened his position in Bihar. After this victory, he adopted the title “**Hazrat-e-Ala**.”

Sher Khan proposed to **Humayun** that if he were allowed to retain Bengal, he would surrender Bihar and pay an annual tribute of **10 lakh dinars**.

Sher Shah defeated the Bengal army in the **Battle of Surajgarh**, greatly enhancing his power and prestige.

Sher Shah defeated Mughal emperor **Humayun** near **Buxar** in the **Battle of Chausa (1539)**.

The decisive battle between **Sher Shah Suri** and **Humayun** was fought at **Bilgram (Kannauj)** on **17 May 1540**.

Humayun suffered a crushing defeat and was forced to flee India. As a result, the **Sur Empire** was established in North India.

Sher Shah later conquered: Raisen in 1543 CE and Marwar in 1544 CE.

Administrative Reforms

Sher Shah's administration is famous for its efficient and systematic governance. He introduced extensive reforms in: Communication system, Postal system, Military administration and Revenue administration.

He introduced administrative reforms by standardizing currency and brought into circulation the **pure silver rupee** and the **copper dam**. He also repaired the **Grand Trunk Road** (also known as **Sadak-e-Azam** or **Badshahi Road**) and introduced a new system of land measurement.

In **1541 CE**, Sher Shah founded the modern city of **Patna** and constructed a fort there. He shifted the capital of Bihar from **Bihar Sharif** to **Patna**. This is mentioned in **Abdullah's Tarikh-i-Daudi**. Sher Shah divided his empire into **47 Sarkars (administrative units)**.

He also constructed the famous **Rohtas Fort** in Bihar.

During the Afghan period, a new style of architecture known as the **Indo-Afghan Style** developed in Bihar.

Decline of the Sur Dynasty

Sher Shah Suri died on **22 May 1545 CE** due to an accidental gunpowder explosion during the siege of the **Kalinjar Fort** in Bundelkhand.

Sher Shah's tomb is located in the middle of a lake at **Sasaram (Bihar)**. Designed by architect **Mir Muhammad Aliwal Khan**, this octagonal mausoleum made of red sandstone stands at the center of an artificial lake.

After Sher Shah's death, his son **Jalal Khan** ascended the throne with the title "**Islam Shah**."

Later, the Sur Empire fragmented into three parts. In **1555 CE**, Humayun defeated **Sikandar Suri** in the battles of **Machhiwara** and **Sirhind**, leading to the end of the Sur Dynasty.

End of Afghan Rule

Daud Khan Karrani was the last significant Afghan ruler of Bihar.

Between **1574–1576 CE**, Mughal emperor **Akbar** personally campaigned in Bihar and defeated Daud Khan in the **Battle of Rajmahal (1576 CE)**.

After this victory, Bihar became a **Suba (province)** of the Mughal Empire, marking the end of Afghan rule in Bihar.

Exam-Oriented Facts

Major Features of Sher Shah's Land Revenue System

Zabti System: It was a systematic method of land measurement and revenue assessment, later adopted by Akbar as well.

Patta and Qabuliyat

- **Patta:** A legal document given to peasants mentioning land rights and tax rates.
- **Qabuliyat:** An agreement signed by peasants accepting the revenue terms.

Gaz-i-Sikandari: A standard measuring rod of **32 inches** used for accurate land measurement.

Rai: A standard schedule called "**Rai**" was used to determine land revenue rates based on agricultural productivity.

Rate of Tax: Generally, **one-third of the total produce** was collected as land revenue.

Sher Shah Suri established a highly efficient postal and intelligence network known as the **Dak Chauki System**. This system ensured rapid communication throughout his vast empire by connecting distant provinces with the center. It is regarded as the first officially recorded horse-mounted postal system in India.

Mughal Period in Bihar

After the decline of the **Sur Dynasty** and the re-establishment of Mughal rule in Delhi under **Humayun**, an Afghan state was once again formed in Bihar under the leadership of **Taj Khan Karrani**.

Akbar's Reign: Bihar as a Mughal Subah

Understanding the strategic importance of Bihar, **Emperor Akbar** decided to capture it from the Afghans (led by **Daud Khan Karrani**).

Akbar personally attacked **Patna** in **1574 CE** and successfully expelled the Afghan forces.

Later, in **1580 CE**, Akbar formally declared Bihar a separate "**Subah**" (**province**) of the Mughal Empire. Under his administrative system, the **Subah of Bihar** was divided into **7 Sarkars (districts)** and **199 Parganas (sub-districts/talukas)**.

Important Governors (Subedars) of Bihar during Akbar's Rule

Munim Khan: After defeating **Daud Khan Karrani** in **1574**, Akbar appointed **Munim Khan** as the governor of **Bihar and Bengal**.

Mirza Aziz Koka: In **1580**, when Akbar formally declared Bihar as a separate **Subah**, **Mirza Aziz Koka** was appointed as the **first official Subedar of Bihar**.

Raja Man Singh: In **1587**, Akbar appointed his trusted general **Raja Man Singh** as the governor of Bihar. His tenure (**1587–1594**), considered the most important phase of Mughal consolidation in Bihar. He significantly strengthened Mughal authority in the region. He made **Rohtas** his administrative capital.

Asaf Khan (Later Phase): He served as the governor of Bihar in the later period of Akbar's reign.

Exam-Oriented Facts

- **Mirza Aziz Koka** is considered the **first official Mughal Subedar of Bihar (1580)**.
- **Raja Man Singh** was a prominent Mughal noble and one of Akbar's Navaratnas. He held a high mansab rank of 5000, reflecting his importance in Mughal administration.

Reign of Jahangir and Shah Jahan

During the reign of Emperor Jahangir, **Baz Bahadur** was appointed as the Subedar of Bihar. He constructed a mosque in Darbhanga and a **sarai named "Nur Sarai."** This sarai was built for **Nur Jahan** during her journey from Delhi to Bengal as a resting place.

Later, during Jahangir's rule, **Prince Parvez** became the **first Mughal royal prince to serve as Subedar of Bihar**.

During the reign of Shah Jahan, **Shaista Khan** was appointed as the Subedar of Bihar. He successfully conducted military campaigns against the Chero rulers of Palamu.

Aurangzeb and Prince Azim

During the reign of Aurangzeb, his grandson **Prince Azim** was appointed as the Subedar of Bihar in **1702 CE**. Prince Azim renamed Patna as **"Azimabad"** and spent nearly 1 crore rupees for its grand development.

During this period, **Guru Gobind Singh Ji** was born in **Patna (1666 CE)**, which further enhanced the religious importance of Bihar.

Later Mughal Period and Bihar

Farrukhsiyar was the first Mughal emperor to be crowned in Bihar. His coronation took place in **Patna in 1713 CE**. Later, the formal coronation of **Shah Alam II** was also held in **Patna in 1761 CE**.

During the later Mughal period, the weakening of central authority led to the rise of **Nawabs in Bengal and Bihar**.

Mughal Architecture in Bihar

- The **Tomb of Makhdoom Daulat** located at **Maner Sharif**, also known as the **"Chhoti Dargah,"** is considered one of the finest examples of Mughal architecture in Bihar. It was constructed during Jahangir's reign by **Ibrahim Khan**.
- **Rohtasgarh Fort** in Bihar was renovated and expanded under **Raja Man Singh**.
- The **Shahi Masjid of Patna**, popularly known as the **Pathar ki Masjid (Stone Mosque)**, is another important Mughal-era monument.

Economy and Trade in Bihar during the Mughal Period

During the Mughal period, Bihar was an important **commercial and trade center**.

- Saltpeter (Shora) from Bihar was world-famous and widely used in the manufacture of gunpowder. European traders such as the Dutch and the English frequently visited Patna for this commodity.
- Patna was a major center for the cotton textile trade, making it an important hub in the regional and international trade network.

Sikhism in Bihar

Bihar has a very deep and sacred connection with Sikhism. This state is proud to be blessed by the footsteps of the three most important Sikh Gurus—**Guru Nanak Dev Ji, Guru Tegh Bahadur Ji, and Guru Gobind Singh Ji**. In particular, **Patna**, the capital of Bihar, is considered one of the holiest places for Sikhs in the world.

Guru Nanak Dev Ji's Visit to Bihar

The founder of Sikhism, **Guru Nanak Dev Ji**, visited Bihar during his first **'Udasi' (religious journey)** in the early 16th century.

He visited **Gaya, Rajgir, Patna, Munger, and Bhagalpur**.

In Patna, he stayed at the house of a devotee named **Jait Mal**, which is now known as **'Gurdwara Pehli Patshahi (Gai Ghat)'**.

Arrival of Guru Tegh Bahadur Ji

The ninth Guru, **Guru Tegh Bahadur Ji**, came to Bihar in 1666 CE. He travelled via Sasaram and Gaya and reached Patna.

He left his wife, **Mata Gujri Devi**, in Patna.

Because of his stay, the Sikh community in Patna became more organized and established.

Birth of Guru Gobind Singh Ji (Most Important Event)

The tenth and last Sikh Guru, **Guru Gobind Singh Ji**, was born on **22 December 1666 in Patna**.

Guru Gobind Singh Ji's father was **Guru Tegh Bahadur (ninth Guru)** and his mother was **Mata Gujri**. He was born in **Patna Sahib** and was the only son of Guru Tegh Bahadur Ji. His childhood name was **Gobind Rai**.

Guru Gobind Singh Ji is the only Sikh Guru born outside Punjab, which is why **Patna Sahib is considered the second most important centre of Sikhism**.

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Major Gurudwaras of Bihar (Religious Sites)

- **Takht Sri Harimandir Ji Patna Sahib:** This is the birthplace of Guru Gobind Singh Ji. It is one of the **five Takhts (centres of Sikh authority)**. The present grand structure was built by Maharaja Ranjit Singh.
- **Gurdwara Bal Leela:** This is the place where young Gobind Rai used to play. The queen used to serve him '**poori and chhole**', which is still offered as prasad here.
- **Gurdwara Guru Ka Bagh:** This is the place where Guru Tegh Bahadur Ji stayed after returning from Assam. It is said that a dry garden became green again after his arrival. The garden was under Nawab Rahim Bakhsh and Karim Bakhsh.
- **Gurdwara Handi Sahib (Danapur):** When Guru Gobind Singh Ji was travelling from Bihar to Punjab, he ate **khichdi cooked in a handi (earthen pot)** here.

Cultural Importance: Prakash Parv

Every year, the Bihar government and the Sikh community jointly celebrate 'Prakash Parv' (birth anniversary of Guru Gobind Singh Ji) on a grand scale in Patna. In 2017, the 350th Prakash Parv was celebrated at an international level, which further strengthened Bihar's image as a major destination of global religious tourism.

Medieval Bihar: Capitals Overview

Period / Dynasty	Major Ruler	Capital
Early Turkish Period	● Bakhtiyar Khalji	● Odantapuri (Bihar Sharif)
After Bengal Conquest	● Bakhtiyar Khalji	● Lakhnauti (after defeating Lakshman Sen)
Tughlaq Period	● Ghiyasuddin / Firoz Shah Tughlaq	● Bihar Sharif
Karnat Dynasty	● Nanyadeva / Harisingh Dev	● Simraon Garh
Oiniwar Dynasty	● Kameshwar Thakur / Shivsingh	● Oini (early), later Sugouna
Afghan Period (Sur Dynasty)	● Sher Shah Suri	● Patna (shifted from Bihar Sharif in 1541 CE)
Mughal Period (Akbar's time)	● Raja Man Singh (Governor)	● Rohtas
Mughal Period (General)	● Other Mughal Subedars	● Patna (Azimabad)

Major Governors (Subedars) of Medieval Bihar

Period / Rule	Major Subedar (Governor)	Key Details
Ilutmish Period	● Malik Alauddin Jani	● First representative of Delhi Sultanate in Bihar
Muhammad bin Tughlaq	● Majd-ul-Mulk	● Managed the Tirhut (Tughlaqpur) region
Tughlaq Administration	● Malik Ibrahim (Malik Baya)	● A renowned administrator; tomb in Bihar Sharif
Lodi Period	● Darya Khan Nuhani	● Appointed by Sikandar Lodi
Nuhani Rule	● Bahar Khan Nuhani	● Son of Darya Khan; assumed title "Sultan Muhammad Shah"
Akbar's Rule (1574)	● Munim Khan	● First governor after defeat of Daud Khan Karrani
Akbar's Rule (1580)	● Mirza Aziz Koka	● First official Subedar after Bihar became a formal Suba
Akbar's Rule (1587–1594)	● Raja Man Singh	● Made Rohtas his capital
Jahangir's Rule	● Prince Parvez	● First Mughal prince to serve as Subedar of Bihar
Shah Jahan's Rule	● Shaista Khan	● Led successful campaigns against Cheros of Palamu
Aurangzeb's Rule	● Prince Azim	● Renamed Patna as "Azimabad" and developed it extensively

Medieval Bihar: Major Writers and Their Works

Author	Major Works	Period / Associated Ruler	Language
Minhaj-us-Siraj	● <i>Tabaqat-i-Nasiri</i>	● Tughlaq Period (first mention of the name "Bihar")	Persian
Jyotirishwar Thakur	● <i>Varn Ratnakar</i>	● Karnat Dynasty (first prose work in Maithili)	Maithili

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Vidyapati	• <i>Padavali</i>	• Oiniwar Dynasty (court poet of King Shivsingh)	Maithili
Vidyapati	• <i>Kirtilata, Kirtipataka</i>	• Oiniwar Dynasty (describes the valor of Kirti Singh)	Avahatta
Vidyapati	• <i>Purusha Pariksha, Likhnavali</i>	• Oiniwar Dynasty	Sanskrit
Chandeshwar Thakur	• <i>Rajniti Ratnakar</i>	• Karnat Dynasty (minister of King Harisingh Dev)	Sanskrit
Abdullah	• <i>Tarikh-i-Daudi</i>	• Afghan Period (describes reconstruction of Patna)	Persian

Medieval Bihar: Important Events and Battles

Year / Period	Event / Battle	Key Personalities	Result / Significance
1198 CE	Conquest of Odantapuri	Bakhtiyar Khalji	• Establishment of Turkish rule in Bihar
1097 CE	Foundation of Karnat Dynasty	Nanyadeva	• Beginning of the "Golden Age of Mithila"
1225 CE	Bihar Campaign	Iltutmish	• Defeated Giyasuddin Aibaq; established Delhi authority
1324–25 CE	Tirhut Campaign	Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq	• Defeat of last Karnat ruler Harisingh Dev
1495–96 CE	Battle of Bihar Sharif	Sikandar Lodi	• Defeat of Hussain Shah Sharqi; "Barh" became boundary between Bengal and Delhi
1534 CE	Battle of Surajgarh	Sher Shah Suri	• Defeated Bengal army; rise of Sher Shah's power; adopted title "Hazrat-e-Ala"
1539 CE	Battle of Chausa	Sher Shah vs Humayun	• Sher Shah's victory; he assumed the title "Sher Shah"
1540 CE	Battle of Bilgram (Kannauj)	Sher Shah vs Humayun	• Humayun fled India; establishment of the Sur Empire
1541 CE	Reorganization of Patna	Sher Shah Suri	• Capital shifted from Bihar Sharif to Patna
1574 CE	Attack on Patna	Akbar	• Defeat of Afghan ruler Daud Khan Karrani
1580 CE	Declaration of Suba (Province)	Akbar	• Bihar officially made a Mughal Suba
1666 CE	Birth of Guru Gobind Singh	10th Sikh Guru	• Patna Sahib became the second holiest Sikh site
1713 CE	Coronation in Patna	Farrukhsiyar	• First Mughal emperor crowned in Patna

Medieval Bihar: Major Foreign Travellers

Name of Traveller	Period / Time	Major Details
Dharmaswami	1234–1236 CE	• A Tibetan monk who visited Bihar during the reign of the Karnat ruler Narasimha Dev. He gave an eyewitness account of the poor condition of Nalanda University after the Turkish invasions.
Mulla Taqia	Akbar's reign (16th century)	• Studied the history of Bihar during his journey from Jaunpur to Bengal.
Ralph Fitch	1585–1587 CE (Akbar's reign)	• First English traveller to visit Bihar; described the flourishing trade of Patna.
Abdul Latif	Early 17th century	• Travelled from Agra to Rajmahal via the Ganga; described the geographical and regional features of Bihar.
Peter Mundy	1632 CE (Shah Jahan's reign)	• Mentioned Patna's commercial activities and urban life in detail.
Tavernier	17th century (Aurangzeb's reign)	• Famous French jeweller who described Patna as a major trading centre.
Bernier	17th century (Aurangzeb's reign)	• French traveller who visited Patna during the period of Jan Nisar Khan and described its socio-economic conditions.
John Marshall	1670–1672 CE (Aurangzeb's reign)	• British physician who described the structure, layout, and lifestyle of Patna.

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Muhammad Sadiq	1691 CE	Recorded detailed observations of his travel in Bihar.
Mulla Bahbahani	Early 18th century	Iranian traveller who visited Patna, Munger, Bhagalpur, and Sasaram and described them in detail.

Modern History of Bihar

- ✓ Arrival of European Companies in Bihar
- ✓ Battle of Plassey and Battle of Buxar in the context of Bengal and Bihar
- ✓ Tribal Uprisings in Bihar
- ✓ Major Movements and Revolts in Bihar before 1857
- ✓ Revolt of 1857
- ✓ Establishment of the Indian National Congress and Bihar
- ✓ Bihar in Various National Movements
- ✓ Revolutionary Movement in Bihar
- ✓ Peasant Movements in Bihar
- ✓ Other National Movements in Bihar
- ✓ Mahatma Gandhi and Bihar

Arrival of European Companies in Bihar

European Companies in Bihar: At a Glance

Company	Arrival / Factory Establishment	Main Centre (Patna)	Major Trade Goods	Special Remarks
Portuguese	Early 17th century	River routes (Hugli to Patna)	Spices, ceramics, cotton textiles	First Europeans to come to Bihar
English (British)	First attempt at Alamganj (Patna); 1651 CE (permanent success)	Gulzarbagh, Patna	Saltpetre, opium, indigo, cotton textiles	Job Charnock was appointed head of Patna factory in 1664
Dutch (Holland/Netherlands)	1632 CE	Present-day Patna College area	Saltpetre, grains, cotton textiles	Held monopoly over saltpetre trade
French	1734 CE	Patna	Saltpetre	Competed with Dutch and British companies
Danish	1774 CE	Near Nepali Kothi area, Patna City	Export goods	Had limited influence of Danish traders in India

Portuguese (First Europeans to Arrive)

- The Portuguese were the first Europeans to arrive in Bihar in the early 17th century. They reached Patna via river routes from Hugli (Bengal).
- In **1579–80**, Emperor Akbar granted permission to a Portuguese captain, **Pedro Tavares**, to open a trading factory at Hugli.
- In **1599**, the Portuguese built a church and convent at Bandel, now known as the **Bandel Church**, considered the first Christian church of Bengal.
- They mainly imported **spices and ceramics** and exported **cotton textiles** from Bihar.

Dutch (First to Establish a Trading Factory)

- The Dutch East India Company established its first factory in Patna in **1632 CE**.
- The site of present-day **Patna College** was the location of the Dutch factory.
- Their primary interest was **saltpetre**, used in the manufacture of gunpowder.
- The Dutch held significant control over the saltpetre trade in Bihar.

English (British)

- The English East India Company made several attempts to establish a foothold in Bihar.
- In **1620 CE**, they attempted to open a factory at Alamganj, Patna, but it closed in **1621 CE**.
- The English traveller **Peter Mundy** visited Bihar in 1632 CE and highlighted its commercial importance.
- The British East India Company re-established its factory in Patna in **1651 CE**.
- The factory site later became the present **Gulzarbagh area**, now used as a Government Printing Press and Survey Office.

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- **Job Charnock** was appointed head of the Patna factory in **1664 CE**.
- The English exported large quantities of **saltpetre, opium, and indigo** from Bihar.

French

- By **1734 CE**, the French East India Company had established its presence in Patna. By 1735, they were actively engaged in trade.

Danish

- The Danish East India Company established a factory in **1774 CE** near the Nepali Kothi area of Patna City.

Plassey and Buxar Wars in the Context of Bengal and Bihar

The rise of the **Nawabs in Bengal** was a highly significant development of the 18th century. After the death of Aurangzeb in 1707 CE, the Mughal Empire began to weaken, and the provincial governors of Bengal gradually started asserting their independence.

Rise of Nawabs in Bengal and Major Rulers**Murshid Quli Khan (1717–1727 CE)**

- Murshid Quli Khan laid the foundation of independent Nawabi rule in Bengal.
- He was initially appointed as **Diwan of Bengal by Aurangzeb**.
- In **1717 CE**, Mughal Emperor Farrukhsiyar appointed him as the **Subedar of Bengal**, and in **1719 CE**, he was also given the subedari of Odisha.
- He shifted his capital from **Dhaka to Murshidabad (earlier Maksudabad)**.
- He introduced reforms in the **zamindari system** and started "**taccavi loans**" (advance agricultural loans) to increase agricultural production.
- Murshid Quli Khan was cautious of growing British power. When Farrukhsiyar granted the English the "**Magna Carta**" (**trade privileges**) in **1717**, he opposed it, as it threatened the revenue system of Bengal and Bihar.

Shuja-ud-Din and Sarfaraz Khan (1727–1740 CE)

After Murshid Quli Khan, his son-in-law **Shuja-ud-Din** became the Nawab of Bengal in 1727.

- During his reign, **Bihar was officially brought under Bengal administration in 1733 CE**.
- In 1733, he appointed **Alivardi Khan as Deputy Subedar (Sub-governor) of Bihar**.
- After Shuja-ud-Din, his son **Sarfaraz Khan** ascended the throne, but he proved to be an inefficient ruler.

Alivardi Khan (1740–1756 CE)

In 1740 CE, Alivardi Khan overthrew Sarfaraz Khan in the **Battle of Giria** and seized power.

- He paid **2 crore rupees to the Mughal Emperor** to secure official recognition of his position.
- After this, he stopped paying revenue to the Mughal court, effectively becoming independent.
- He appointed **Raja Ram Narayan** as Deputy Governor of Bihar.

Siraj-ud-Daula (Battle of Plassey) (1756–1757 CE)

After the death of Alivardi Khan, his grandson **Siraj-ud-Daula** became the Nawab. He was the son of Alivardi Khan's youngest daughter. On Siraj-ud-Daula's accession, his relatives, such as **Ghaseti Begum (his aunt in Dhaka)** and **Shaukat Jung (Subahdar of Purnia)**, became dissatisfied with him. Immediately after becoming Nawab, Siraj-ud-Daula ordered both the English and French to **stop fortifying their settlements in his territory**. The French accepted this order, but the English continued their fortification work. This led to the beginning of conflict between **Siraj-ud-Daula and the British**.

Chronological Events of the Battle of Plassey

4 June 1756: First conflict between Siraj-ud-Daula and the East India Company took place at **Cossimbazar**.

16 June 1756: Siraj-ud-Daula captured **Calcutta**. English officer **Roger Drake** fled from Calcutta. The Nawab renamed Calcutta as "**Alinagar**". During the occupation of Calcutta, the infamous "**Black Hole Incident**" occurred. After taking control, Siraj-ud-Daula appointed **Manikchand** as the administrator of Calcutta.

20 June 1756: During the capture of **Fort William**, the famous "**Black Hole**" incident took place. According to Holwell, **146 English prisoners** were confined in a small room, out of which **123 died and only 23 survived**.

9 February 1757: After the Black Hole incident, **Robert Clive** recaptured Calcutta and forced Siraj-ud-Daula to sign the **Treaty of Alinagar (9 February 1757)**.

23 June 1757: Battle of Plassey

To take revenge for the Black Hole incident, Robert Clive formed a major conspiracy with Siraj-ud-Daula's own officials.

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In this conspiracy, the following of the Nawab's associates joined Clive: **Mir Jafar (Commander-in-Chief)**, **Rai Durlabh (Diwan)**, **Manikchand (Officer-in-charge)**, **Aminchand (Merchant)** and **Jagat Seth (Banker)**

Robert Clive then accused the Nawab of violating the Treaty of Alinagar.

As a result, on **23 June 1757**, the **Battle of Plassey** was fought between the English and Siraj-ud-Daula on the banks of the **Bhagirathi River (a tributary of the Ganga)**.

In the battle, the Nawab's traitorous allies supported the English. On the Nawab's side, only loyal commanders such as **Mir Madan and Mohan Lal** fought bravely.

Due to betrayal, Siraj-ud-Daula was defeated. On the orders of **Miran (son of Mir Jafar)**, Siraj-ud-Daula was assassinated on **2 July 1757** by **Muhammad Ali Beg**.

After the battle, the English installed **Mir Jafar as a "puppet Nawab" of Bengal**.

Mir Qasim: Battle of Buxar (1760–1763 CE)

Mir Qasim, the son-in-law of Mir Jafar, was made Nawab in **1760 CE** when the English became dissatisfied with Mir Jafar. At that time, **Holwell** was the Governor of Bengal, who succeeded Robert Clive.

Mir Qasim was an efficient and capable ruler. To avoid English interference, he shifted his capital from **Murshidabad to Munger (Bihar)**. In Munger, he established a modern factory for the production of **cannons and firearms**.

He also modernized his army by adopting the European military system, especially with the help of French and German instructors. For this purpose, he appointed an Armenian officer named **Gurgin Khan**.

After this, Mir Qasim ordered the execution of Bihar's Deputy Subedar **Raja Ram Narayan**, as he refused to submit accounts of Bihar's revenue and expenditure.

Due to Mir Qasim's increasingly independent actions, on **24 June 1763**, the English agent **Ellis captured Patna**, but Mir Qasim defeated and killed him.

Causes of Conflict between Mir Qasim and the English

The main cause of dispute between the Nawab and the English was the misuse of **"Dastak" (trade privilege/exemption)** by the English.

English officials were using these trade concessions for their **personal trade as well**, which caused heavy losses to the state treasury.

To remove this discrimination, Mir Qasim abolished all **internal trade** taxes, which angered the English.

As the conflict intensified, the English removed Mir Qasim and reappointed **Mir Jafar** as Nawab. After this, Mir Qasim left Bengal and went to Awadh.

He formed a **joint alliance** with the Nawab of Awadh, **Shuja-ud-Daula**, and the Mughal Emperor **Shah Alam II**, against the English.

On 22 October 1764, the historic Battle of Buxar was fought between this alliance and the English, in which the English emerged victorious. The English (East India Company) army was led by **Major Hector Munro**.

After defeat in the Battle of Buxar, Mir Qasim fled and ultimately died near Delhi in **1777 CE**. This battle ensured complete English control over Bihar and Bengal.

The Battle of Buxar was far more decisive than the Battle of Plassey. The Battle of Plassey gave the Company **political entry into Bengal**, while the Battle of Buxar made them the **legal rulers of Eastern India**. It allowed them to collect revenue, maintain a standing army, and function as an Indian political power rather than just a foreign trading company.

Treaty of Allahabad (12 August 1765)

This treaty was signed between the Mughal Emperor **Shah Alam II** and the **East India Company (Robert Clive)**. As a result of this treaty, the **Diwani rights (revenue collection rights)** of Bihar, Bengal, and Odisha were granted to the East India Company. In return, the Company agreed to pay the Emperor an annual pension of **26 lakh rupees**.

Robert Clive established the system of **Dual Government in Bengal**. Under this system; revenue collection (Diwani) was taken by the English and administration and law and order were left in the hands of the Nawab.

Under this system, for revenue administration; **Mohammad Reza Khan** was appointed Diwan of Bengal, and **Raja Shitab Rai** was appointed Diwan of Bihar. Later, his son **Kalyan Singh** became the Diwan of Bihar.

Note: *John Carnac, along with Clive, played an important role in negotiations (1765) with Shuja-ud-Daula (Nawab of Awadh) and Mughal Emperor Shah Alam II.*

In 1766, Robert Clive held a meeting at **Chhapra**, attended by; the Emperor's envoy, Nawab of Awadh (Shuja-ud-Daula), Jat rulers and Rohilla chiefs. In this meeting, an agreement was made for mutual defense against the Marathas.

Due to the Dual Government system, Bengal's treasury became empty, and a severe famine struck Bengal in **1770 CE**. The famine severely affected **Darbhanga, Purnia, Bhagalpur, and Patna** also.

As a result, in **1772 CE**, Warren Hastings abolished the Dual Government system and also ended the position of Nawab of Bengal. The last Nawab of Bengal was **Mubarak-ud-Daula**.

After the famine of 1783, on the recommendation of inquiry officer **John Shore**, the **Golghar of Patna** was constructed in **1784 CE** by British engineer **John Garstin**.

Exam-Oriented Facts

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The British East India Company established the **"Revenue Council of Patna" (1770 CE)**.

Its main objective was to supervise land revenue collection in the Bihar region and to streamline administration.

After the **Battle of Buxar (1764)**, when the English received the Diwani rights of Bengal, Bihar, and Odisha, this institution (Revenue Council of Patna) was laid down during the time of **Warren Hastings** to reform the revenue system.

This council was abolished in **1781 CE**.

In the same year (1781), the post of **"Revenue Chief of Bihar"** was created in place of the Revenue Council. Its powers were transferred to the Revenue Committee at Calcutta.

Nawabs of Bengal

Nawab	Period of Rule	Key Exam Points
Murshid Quli Khan	1717–1727	• Founder of independent rule. • Established Murshidabad as the capital. • Introduced Takavi loans for agriculture.
Shujauddin	1727–1739	• In 1733, Bihar came under his authority. • Appointed Alivardi Khan as Deputy Subedar of Bihar.
Sarfaraz Khan	1739–1740	• Killed in the Battle of Giria.
Alivardi Khan	1740–1756	• Stopped paying tribute to the Mughals. • Compared the English to "bees."
Siraj-ud-Daula	1756–1757	• Battle of Plassey (1757). • Black Hole incident. • Treaty of Alinagar.
Mir Jafar	1757–1760	• First "puppet" Nawab of the English.
Mir Qasim	1760–1763	• Shifted capital to Munger. • Battle of Buxar (1764).
Mubarak-ud-Daula (Last Nawab)	1770–1775	• Post abolished by Warren Hastings.

Tribal Uprisings in the Context of Bihar

In the tribal regions of Bihar, several uprisings took place due to the increasing interference of the British. The major causes of these uprisings were **political intervention, economic exploitation, and religious interference** in tribal areas.

Major Uprisings in Bihar and Jharkhand

Name of Uprising	Time Period	Regions	Key Leaders
Dhal Uprising	1767	Singhbhum	Jagannath Dhal
Chuar Uprising	1766	Jungle Mahal of Bengal (Midnapore, Bankura, Manbhum)	Jagannath Singh Patar (Ghatsila), Durjan Singh
Pahariya Uprising	1778	Rajmahal	Raja Jagannath, Rani Sarveshwari (Queen of Maheshpur)
Tilka Manjhi Uprising	1778–1785	Bhagalpur	Tilka Manjhi
Tamar Uprising	1789–1794	Chotanagpur	Bholanath Sahay
Chero Uprising	1800–1802	Palamu	Bhushan Singh
Ho Uprising	1820–1821	Singhbhum	King of Porhat
Kol Uprising	1831–1832	Chotanagpur	Buddho Bhagat
Bhumij Uprising	1832–1833	Midnapore	Ganga Narayan Singh
Santhal Uprising	1855–1856	Santhal Pargana	Sidhu, Kanhu, Chand, and Bhairav
Sardari Movement	1858–1895	Chotanagpur	Led by Munda Sardars
Saphahod Movement	1870	Chotanagpur	Lal Hembram (Lal Baba)
Kharwar Movement	1874	Jharkhand	Bhagirath Manjhi
Munda Uprising (Ulgulan)	1895–1900	Chotanagpur	Birsa Munda
Tana Bhagat Movement	1914	Gumla	Jatra Bhagat

Sanyasi Revolt (1763–1800)

The British imposed restrictions on the pilgrimage of **Sanyasis and Fakirs**, which created deep resentment among them.

The **Sanyasi Revolt** mainly took place in Bengal and Bihar (especially Purnia, Saran, and Vaishali). It is considered one of the **first major civil uprisings** against British rule in India.

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It involved **Naga Sadhus and Sanyasis (followers of Shankaracharya)** along with displaced peasants and local soldiers, who attacked British warehouses and treasuries.

Warren Hastings later suppressed the revolt after a prolonged military campaign.

The famous novel "**Anandamath**" by **Bankim Chandra Chatterjee** is based on this revolt, from which the national song "**Vande Mataram**" is derived.

Devi Chaudharani was a prominent woman leader of this movement, who led armed resistance against the British in Bengal and Bihar (especially Purnia region).

Other major leaders included **Bhavani Pathak, Majnu Shah (Majmuna Shah), Musa Shah, Chirag Ali Shah, Ganesh Giri, Dwij Narayan, and Ken Sarkar**.

Noniya Revolt (1770–1800)

The Noniya Revolt mainly occurred in saltpetre (*Shora*) producing regions of Bihar such as **Tirhut, Saran, Purnia, and Hajipur**.

The **Noniya community** prepared saltpetre from soil, which was used in gunpowder production. The British East India Company exploited them economically and paid very low prices.

When the Noniya community began secretly selling saltpetre to traders, the British responded with brutal repression, which led to an armed rebellion by the Noniyas.

Santhal Revolt (1855–1856)

This revolt occurred just before the Revolt of 1857 and is also known as the **Hul Movement or Santhal Hul**.

It spread from **Bhagalpur to Rajmahal**, an area known as "**Daman-i-Koh**".

It was the **first strong tribal uprising against exploitation**.

The formal beginning of the Santhal Hul took place on **30 June 1855**, when thousands of Santhals gathered at **Bhognadih village (present Sahibganj district, Jharkhand)**. **Sidhu Murmu and Kanhu Murmu**, along with their brothers **Chand and Bhairav**, declared war against the British and their collaborators.

The uprising was driven by exploitation by "**dikus**" (**outsiders**) and interference in traditional systems like the **Manjhi system and Parha Panchayat system**.

About **6,000 Santhals** were organized during the revolt. Women leaders **Phulo Murmu and Jhano Murmu** (sisters of Sidhu and Kanhu) also actively participated.

The Santhals used specially folded **sal leaves (known as Dharwak)** to communicate plans across villages.

British officer **Major Burro** was killed during the revolt. Later, the rebellion was suppressed by British forces under **Captain Alexander and Lieutenant Thomson**.

By early 1856, the revolt was largely suppressed, though scattered resistance continued.

As result of the revolt **Santhal Pargana Tenancy Act (1876)** was enacted.

In addition, in **1856**, the British created a separate administrative district named **Santhal Pargana** to regulate tribal affairs and prevent future rebellions. **Mr. Ashley Eden** was appointed as the first Deputy Commissioner of the new district, whose responsibility was to maintain peace and understand tribal customs.

The traditional '**Majhi system**' of the Santhals was given legal recognition by the British administration.

Munda Revolt (Ulgulan) (1895–1900)

This revolt took place in the **Chotanagpur region (present-day Jharkhand)** and is considered the **most powerful tribal uprising**. It is also known as the "**Ulgulan**" (**Great Tumult**).

The main cause was the destruction of the traditional **Khuntkatti system (collective land ownership)** by the British and the introduction of the **zamindari system**. Economic exploitation by outsiders (*dikus*) and landlords also fueled the revolt.

Followers of **Birsa Munda** such as **Donka Munda, Soma Munda, and Gaya Munda** also participated in the movement.

Birsa Munda

- The great freedom fighter and popular tribal leader **Birsa Munda** was born on **15 November 1875** in **Ulihatu village, Khunti district**.
- He led the famous tribal movement known as the **Munda Uprising (Ulgulan)**.
- Birsa Munda received initiation into **Vaishnavism** from **Anand Pande**.
- He is also respectfully known as "**Dharti Aaba**" (**Father of the Earth**).
- Birsa Munda declared himself to be an incarnation of "**Singhbonga**" (**God**).
- He preached **moral purity, self-reform, and monotheism** (worship of one God) among the people.

The movement initially began as a **social and religious reform movement**, which later transformed under Birsa Munda's leadership into a **political resistance against the British**.

The most effective phase of the uprising was seen in **1899**, when the **Munda tribals successfully defeated the British at several places**.

During the British suppression campaign, **Birsa Munda was arrested on 3 February 1900**.

Later, he died in jail on **9 June 1900 due to cholera**, after which the movement gradually came to an end.

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As a result of the rebellion, the British reintroduced the **Khuntkatti system**.

The British also enacted the **Chotanagpur Tenancy Act (1908)** and organized **Khunti and Gumla** as sub-divisions.

Note: The Birsa Movement is often considered an extension of the earlier Sardari Movement.

Birsa Munda – Recent Developments

150th Birth Anniversary Celebration (2024–2025): The Government of India observed the period from **15 November 2024** to **15 November 2025** as the “**Tribal Pride Year**”. This was officially announced by Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** from **Jamui district, Bihar**.

Commemorative Coin and Postal Stamp: On the occasion of Birsa Munda’s 150th birth anniversary, the Prime Minister released a **commemorative coin and a postal stamp** in his honour.

Unveiling of Statue in New Delhi: On **15 November 2024**, Union Home Minister **Amit Shah** unveiled a **20-foot tall statue of Birsa Munda** at the entrance of “**Bansera**” Park on Ring Road, New Delhi.

Development Projects: On this occasion, the Prime Minister also inaugurated and laid the foundation stone of various **tribal welfare development projects worth more than ₹6,640 crore**.

Janjatiya Gaurav Diwas (Tribal Pride Day): Like every year, **15 November 2025** was observed as “**Tribal Pride Day**”. The theme for 2025 was: “**150 Years of Bhagwan Birsa Munda – 11 Years of Tribal Empowerment**”.

Birsa Munda Janjatiya Gaurav Upvan: To promote environmental conservation, it has been announced that special “**Birsa Munda Tribal Pride Groves**” will be developed in tribal-dominated districts across the country in his name.

Movements and Revolts in Bihar before 1857

Wahabi Movement (1828–1868)

This was an important movement/revolt in Bihar before the Revolt of 1857.

Its original aim was **religious reform within the Muslim society**, but later it transformed into an **anti-British movement**.

The **primary centre** of this movement in the North-West Frontier Province was **Sittana**, which also functioned as a military base.

In Bihar, **Patna emerged as the second most important centre**, where volunteers and funds were sent regularly to Sittana.

The movement in India was mainly led by **Syed Ahmad Bareilvi**. During his stay at Patna, the movement became highly active in Bihar.

In Bihar (Patna), key leaders such as **Wilayat Ali, Inayat Ali, Farhat Ali, and Muhammad Hussain** played a significant role in strengthening the movement.

British authorities launched military operations to suppress the movement; **Ambala campaign (1863)** and **Patna campaign (1865)**.

Note: The **Faraizi Movement of Bengal** was inspired by the Wahabi Movement.

Lota Revolt (1856)

This revolt took place in the prison of **Muzaffarpur district, Bihar**.

Initially, prisoners were provided **brass (metal) lotas**, but later the government decided to replace them with **earthen (clay) lotas**.

The prisoners considered this change as an attack on their **religious sentiments and dignity**, and they strongly protested against it.

Due to the pressure of the revolt, the government withdrew its decision and again restored **brass lotas** for the prisoners.

Revolt of 1857

The **Revolt of 1857**, also known as the “**First War of Indian Independence**”, was a watershed event in Indian history.

The main causes of this revolt were British interference in **social, religious, economic spheres** and changes in **political and administrative systems**, along with widespread **military discontent**.

The immediate cause of the revolt was the introduction of **greased cartridges**, which offended Indian soldiers. In protest, the first open revolt was initiated at **Barrackpore Cantonment** by **Mangal Pandey**, a soldier of the **34th Native Infantry**, on **29 March 1857**.

Mangal Pandey seriously injured **Sergeant Hewson** and **Lieutenant Baugh** with gunfire and sword attacks. As a result, he was **executed on 8 April 1857**.

The actual beginning of the Revolt of 1857 is considered to be **10 May 1857 at Meerut**, when the soldiers of the Meerut cantonment marched towards Delhi. In Delhi, the rebels declared the Mughal Emperor **Bahadur Shah Zafar** as their leader and formally initiated the uprising.

The revolt in Delhi was led by **Bakht Khan**, who was the **chief commander of Emperor Bahadur Shah Zafar**.

Centres of the Revolt of 1857

Revolt Centre	Leader	Suppressing Officer	Main Events
Bihar	Babu Kunwar Singh	William Taylor	- Leading warrior of the Bihar uprising. - Provided leadership to the soldiers of Danapur.
Delhi	Bahadur Shah Zafar / Bakht Khan	Nicholson, Hudson	John Nicholson died during the uprising.
Kanpur	Nana Saheb	Campbell	Havelock died during the revolt.

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			- Nana Saheb's real name was Dhondhu Pant. He was the adopted son of the Maratha Peshwa Baji Rao II. - Nana Saheb's most loyal and great commander Tatya Tope took charge of military strategy and actual warfare on behalf of Nana Saheb in this uprising.
Lucknow	Begum Hazrat Mahal	Campbell	- Begum Hazrat Mahal led the revolt by declaring her minor son Birjis Qadr as the Nawab of Awadh. - During this revolt, Sir Henry Lawrence was killed.
Jhansi	Rani Lakshmi Bai	Hugh Rose	- General Hugh Rose praised her bravery, saying: <i>"Here lies the woman who was the only man among the rebels."</i> - She attained martyrdom on 18 June 1858 at Kotah-ki-Serai near Gwalior.(MP)
Allahabad	Liaquat Ali	Neill	Led a major uprising on 7 June 1857 at Khusro Bagh (Allahabad).
Bareilly	Khan Bahadur Khan	Vincent Eyre	Established a parallel government on 31 May 1857 and issued coins.
Faizabad	Maulvi Ahmadullah	Reynold	- Known as the <i>"Light of the Rebellion"</i>. - He declared jihad against the British and issued a fatwa. - The British announced a reward of ₹50,000 on him.

Events of the Revolt of 1857 in Bihar

Date	Place	Event / Description
12 June 1857	Rohini village (Deoghar district)	Beginning of the revolt by soldiers of the 32nd Infantry Regiment. During the uprising, three soldiers of the 5th Irregular Cavalry rebelled and attacked British officers. Major Norman Leslie and Dr. Grant were killed.
		- The three revolutionaries—Amanat Ali, Salamat Ali, and Sheikh Haroon—were arrested and executed on 16 June 1857 after a swift court-martial. - Major MacDonald played a key role in suppressing the Rohini uprising.
3 July 1857	Patna	- The revolt in Patna was led by book-seller Pir Ali. - During the uprising, Opium Agent Dr. R.O. Loyall was killed. - Commissioner Taylor suppressed the revolt. - Pir Ali and 14 others were executed on 7 July 1857.
25 July 1857	Muzaffarpur	Dissatisfied soldiers killed several British officers.
	Danapur	Soldiers of the 7th, 8th, and 40th Native Infantry regiments revolted.
	Shahabad district	Rebel soldiers from Danapur moved toward Shahabad and joined Babu Kunwar Singh of Jagdishpur, intensifying the revolt.
30 July 1857	Saran, Tirhut, Champaran, Patna	The government imposed martial law in these districts.
	Bhagalpur and Gaya	- Rebel soldiers freed around 400 prisoners from jails. - Rebels also attacked Tikari Raj and looted ₹10,000.
Note: During 1857, a Chugain Revolt also took place near Buxar , where villagers and tribal groups attacked the British revenue office. The rebels looted the treasury and challenged colonial administration authority.		

Babu Kunwar Singh

Babu Kunwar Singh was born in **1777** at Jagdishpur, Shahabad district (present-day Bhojpur, Bihar), in the **Ujjainiya Rajput dynasty**. His father was **Raja Shahbazada Singh**, the zamindar of Jagdishpur.

Known as the **"Old Lion of Bihar"**, Babu Kunwar Singh was one of the most prominent leaders of the **Revolt of 1857**. When he took command of the struggle, he was around **80 years old**, yet his energy, courage, and military strategy severely challenged the British forces.

He received strong support from his family and local allies during the uprising. His brothers **Amar Singh and Reet Narayan Singh**, and his nephews **Nishan Singh and Jaikishan Singh**, actively participated in the rebellion as his key associates.

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In addition, influential zamindars of Shahabad region such as **Narhar Singh, Johan Singh, Thakur Dayal Singh, and Visheshwar Singh** further strengthened his movement.

The then Commissioner of Patna, **William Taylor**, suspected Kunwar Singh's activities and tried to trap him by inviting him for a meeting at Patna, but Kunwar Singh refused to meet him.

After this, he joined the rebels of **Danapur Cantonment** and raised an army of nearly **4,000 soldiers**. Demonstrating strategic foresight, he also established a local **arms and gunpowder manufacturing unit at Jagdishpur**.

Siege of Arrah (27 July – 3 August 1857): The **Siege of Arrah** was a major event of the Revolt of 1857 in Bihar. On **27 July 1857**, Kunwar Singh captured Arrah town and displayed remarkable bravery.

When **Captain Dunbar** attempted to recapture Arrah, he was defeated and killed in the battle. However, due to pressure from a larger British force led by **Major Eyre**, Kunwar Singh had to retreat. This battle is also known as the "**Battle of Bibiganj (3 August 1857)**".

After this, Kunwar Singh expanded his operations and moved through **Rewa and Banda**, eventually reaching **Lucknow**. The Nawab of Awadh, impressed by his bravery, entrusted him with the command of **Azamgarh**. He was also honored with a certificate of appreciation and **₹12,000 in cash**.

In **December 1857**, he joined **Nana Sahib** in the famous battle of Kanpur and also defeated British forces in Azamgarh.

When returning to Jagdishpur, at **Shivrajpur Ghat**, he was attacked by British commander **Douglas**, while he was crossing the river Ganga. A bullet struck his left arm. To prevent the spread of infection, this **80-year-old warrior cut off his own arm with his sword and offered it to the Ganga**, saying:

"O Mother Ganga, accept this humble offering of your beloved."

Despite severe injuries, he recaptured Jagdishpur on **23 April 1858**, and drove out the British once again, defeating **Captain Le Grand's forces** decisively. He died shortly on **26 April 1858** due to his injuries. **23 April** is now observed as **Veer Kunwar Singh Day**, marking his final victory at Jagdishpur.

After him, his brother **Amar Singh** continued the struggle, using the **Kaimur hills** as a base and continuing guerrilla warfare. However, by **November 1858**, the British had regained control over most regions.

Even after Queen Victoria's proclamation of pardon, many revolutionaries including Amar Singh faced continued British repression.

Examination-Oriented Facts

- During the 1857 Revolt, **Police Jamadar Hasan Ali Khan of Tirhut** was executed.
- In Champaran, rebels killed a British officer named **Major Holmes**.
- The work "**Udwant Prakash**" is attributed to **Mauli Kavi**, written in **1747** under Raja Udwant Singh of Jagdishpur. It is a historical epic describing the **Ujjainiya Rajputs of Jagdishpur**. He is also credited with works like "**Bagh Singh**" and "**Udwant Vinod**."
- Several rulers and estates such as **Maharaja of Darbhanga, Bettiah Raj, Hathua Raj, Dumraon Maharaja, Tekari Raja, Banaili Raja**, and many zamindars supported the British in suppressing the Revolt of 1857.

Other Revolutionaries during 1857

In **Palamu**, the revolt was led by **Pitambar Shahi and Nilambar Shahi** of the **Bhogta tribe**, who received strong support from **Chero chiefs**.

In this uprising, important leaders such as **Tikait Umrao Singh of Palamu** and his **Diwan Sheikh Bhikhari** were captured and executed by the British.

In the regions of **Gaya and Ranchi**, the rebellion was led by **Bishwanath Shahi and Pandey Ganpat Rai**.

Haider Ali at Rajgir, and **Jawahir Rajwar, Atwa Rajwar** at Nawada emerged as significant rural rebel leaders. In **Wazirganj (Gaya)**, **Khushhal Singh** also played an important role as a prominent local leader during the uprising.

Indian National Congress and Bihar

The **Indian National Congress (INC)** was founded on **28 December 1885** in **Bombay (present-day Mumbai)** by **A. O. Hume**. The first session of the Congress was also held in Bombay and was presided over by **Womesh Chandra Bonnerjee**.

A total of **72 delegates** attended this first session. Although there was **no official representative from Bihar** in the first session, newspapers from Bihar, especially "**The Bihar Herald**", strongly supported its formation.

In the **second session held in Calcutta (1886)**, **31 delegates from Bihar** participated, marking Bihar's active entry into national politics. This session was presided over by **Dadabhai Naoroji**.

Key Facts (Indian National Congress)

Topic	Details
Date of Foundation	• 28 December 1885
Place of Foundation	• Gokuldas Tejpal Sanskrit College, Bombay (Mumbai)
Founder	• A. O. Hume
First President	• Womesh Chandra Bonnerjee
First Secretary	• A. O. Hume
Delegates in First Session	• 72 members

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Highest Participation	Maximum participation from Bombay Presidency (38 delegates) during 1st session.
Name of Organization	Suggested by Dadabhai Naoroji (earlier: Indian National Union)
Prominent Leaders	Ferozeshah Mehta, Dadabhai Naoroji, Kashinath Telang, Dinshaw Wacha
Viceroy of India at that time	Lord Dufferin

Important Congress Sessions in Bihar

Bihar hosted **three important annual sessions of the Indian National Congress**:

Year	Place	President	Key Points
1912	Bankipore (Patna)	R. N. Mudholkar	- First Congress session held in Bihar. - The reception committee was headed by Maulana Mazharul Haq. A. O. Hume was officially declared the "Father of Congress". - Maulana Mazharul Haq strongly emphasized Hindu-Muslim unity in his welcome address. Jawaharlal Nehru attended the session for the first time.
1922	Gaya	C. R. Das (Chittaranjan Das)	- Foundation of the Swaraj Party idea took shape here. - Reception committee was chaired by Brajkishore Prasad. - Due to ideological differences over entry into legislative councils, Swaraj Party was formally formed on 1 January 1923 by Chittaranjan Das and Motilal Nehru.
1940	Ramgarh (now in Jharkhand)	Abul Kalam Azad	- Important session held just before the Quit India Movement. - Maulana Azad continued as Congress President till 1946. - At the 1923 Delhi special session, he became the youngest Congress President at the age of 35 years. - Parallel to this session, Subhas Chandra Bose organized a separate meeting known as the "Anti-Compromise Conference." - Leaders like Swami Sahajanand Saraswati and Sheel Bhadra Yajee supported Bose during this conference.

Examination-Oriented Facts**Infrastructure Development by British in Bihar**

In **1913**, the British government appointed **Joseph Fergus Munnings (J. F. Munnings)** as a consulting architect to develop the **"New Capital Area" in Patna**.

He was a **New Zealand-born architect**, assigned to plan and design the new administrative city (New Patna) west of old Bankipore, after the formation of the **Bihar and Orissa Province (1912)**.

He designed several major **colonial buildings**, including; Government House (now Lok Bhavan), Patna Secretariat (Old Secretariat) and Patna High Court

Construction of these buildings began around **1913** and were completed mostly by **1916–1917**.

Movements/Organizations in Bihar after the Formation of Congress (20th Century)

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Various National Movements in Bihar	Revolutionary Movements / Organizations in Bihar	Peasant Movements in Bihar	National Movements in Bihar	Mahatma Gandhi and Bihar
• Partition of Bengal / Swadeshi Movement • Home Rule Movement • Khilafat Movement	• Muzaffarpur Bomb Case (1908) • Bihar Branch of Anushilan Samiti (1913) • Hindu Boys Association (1913) • Patna Yuvak Sangh (1927) • Bihar Yuvak Sangh (1928) • Pataliputra Yuvak Sangh (1929)	• Darbhanga Peasant Movement (1919–20) • Bakhasat Peasant Movement (1934–38) • Bihar Kisan Sabha	• Swaraj Party • Simon Commission Opposition • Bihar Socialist Party • Bihar Legislative Assembly Election (1937)	• Champaran Satyagraha (1917) • Non-Cooperation Movement (1920) • Civil Disobedience Movement • Quit India Movement

National Movements in Bihar

Partition of Bengal / Swadeshi Movement

The **Partition of Bengal** was announced on **20 July 1905** by the then Viceroy **Lord Curzon**.

Although officially justified on **administrative grounds**, its real objective was to **weaken the rising nationalist movement in Bengal**.

The partition came into effect on **16 October 1905**, and the entire region, including Bihar, observed it as a **day of mourning**.

In **Darbhanga**, under the inspiration of headmaster **Satish Chandra Chakravarty**, the **"Raksha Bandhan Day"** was observed as a symbol of unity.

As a protest against partition, people took baths in the Ganga and, inspired by the ideas of **Rabindranath Tagore**, tied **rakhi on each other's wrists**, pledging eternal unity.

Spread of Swadeshi and Boycott Movement

In **Patna**, a **"Swadeshi Committee"** was formed to promote indigenous goods.

Public meetings were organized in various districts of Bihar such as **Muzaffarpur, Gaya, Bhagalpur, and Purnia**, where people took pledges to **boycott foreign cloth and adopt Khadi**.

To spread the message of Swadeshi to villages, the **"magic lantern"** was used. **Indranath Nandi**, with the help of **Punit Lal**, used this medium for nationalist propaganda.

In **1906**, a speech by **Surendranath Banerjee** in **Munger** inspired students like **Shri Krishna Sinha** and **Tejeshwar Prasad** to join the national movement.

Institutions and Student Movement during Swadeshi Movement

Due to the impact of the Swadeshi Movement, the **"Bihari Students Conference"** was established in **1906**, which awakened political consciousness among Bihar's youth. It was founded by **Dr. Rajendra Prasad**.

Emphasis was also laid on **Indian value-based education** as an alternative to British education.

Baba Thakur Das established the **Ramakrishna Mission Society in Patna (1906–07)** and promoted revolutionary ideas.

Leaders like **Sachchidanand Sinha** and **Hasan Imam** not only supported Swadeshi but also strengthened the demand for a **separate province of Bihar**.

A Marathi intellectual from Deoghar, **Sakharam Ganesh Deoskar**, played an important cultural role. His book **"Deshar Katha" (1904)** exposed British economic exploitation and inspired many young revolutionaries.

Partition of Bengal / Swadeshi Movement	Important Congress Sessions related to Swadeshi Movement
- The Swadeshi Movement (1905) was not led by a single individual. It was a mass movement led by different leaders across various regions of India. Major Leaders (Lal–Bal–Pal Triumvirate): The main pillars of the movement were: Lala Lajpat Rai, Bal Gangadhar Tilak and Bipin Chandra Pal Regional Leadership Bengal: Aurobindo Ghosh, Surendranath Banerjee, Rabindranath Tagore Bombay and Pune: Bal Gangadhar Tilak Punjab: Lala Lajpat Rai, Ajit Singh Delhi: Syed Haider Raza Madras Presidency: V. O. Chidambaram Pillai	Banaras Session (1905) - It was presided over by Gopal Krishna Gokhale. - In this session, the Partition of Bengal was strongly criticised and a resolution was passed supporting the Swadeshi and Boycott Movement. Calcutta Session (1906) - It was presided over by Dadabhai Naoroji, known as the ‘Grand Old Man of India’. - In this session, the Congress for the first time officially declared ‘Swaraj’ as its main goal. - Important resolutions related to Swadeshi, Boycott, and National Education were also passed.

Bihar Provincial Congress Committee: Establishment and Sessions

The Bihar Provincial Congress Committee (BPCC) is the Bihar state unit of the Indian National Congress. It was established in **1908**, with its headquarters at **Sadakat Ashram, Patna**. During the freedom struggle, it played a major role as a key political organization in Bihar. The first session of BPCC was held in Patna under the presidency of **Sir Ali Imam**.

Its other prominent founding members included; Maulana Mazharul Haq, Sachchidanand Sinha, Hasan Imam and Deo Narayan Singh.

Home Rule Movement

In **April 1916**, inspired by the Irish Home Rule League, **Bal Gangadhar Tilak** established the **Home Rule League at Belgaum (Pune)**. Its president was **Joseph Baptista** and its secretary was **N. C. Kelkar**.

In **September 1916**, **Annie Besant** founded another Home Rule League at **Adyar (Madras)**. The secretary of the **All India Home Rule League** at Adyar was **Arundale**.

The main objective of the Home Rule League was to demand **self-government for India within the framework of the British Commonwealth**.

On **16 December 1916**, the **Home Rule League was established in Bihar** under the leadership of **Maulana Mazharul Haq**, and **Vaidyanath Narayan Singh** was appointed its secretary.

In **June 1917**, Annie Besant along with **B. P. Wadia and George Arundale** was arrested. Following this, **Sir S. Subramania Iyer** renounced his knighthood in protest.

To strengthen the movement, Annie Besant visited **Patna twice (18 April and 25 July 1918)**, where she received a grand welcome and emphasized the importance of self-government.

In **Muzaffarpur**, the Home Rule League was established under the leadership of **Janakdhari Prasad**.

During the movement, **Balmukund Bajpai** wrote a Hindi pamphlet titled “**Swaraj Katha**”, which was banned in several provinces due to its strong nationalist message.

Important Notes

- Leaders like **Bajrang Sahay (Hazaribagh)** and **Tarini Prasad Sinha (Gaya)** were active participants in the Home Rule Movement. In **Champaran**, Gandhi’s supporters remained non-violent and silent on his advice, considering silence itself a form of protest.
- Symbolic acts such as **worship of “Bharat Mata”** during Vijaydashami, initiated by **Rai Puran Chand** and later continued by his sons, helped unite people across religious lines.

Khilafat Movement (1919–1924)

The **Khilafat Movement (1919–1924)** was a major political and religious movement launched by Indian Muslims after the First World War to protect the position of the **Caliph (Khalifa)** of the Ottoman Empire in Turkey and to oppose British policies.

It was led by the **Ali Brothers (Maulana Mohammad Ali and Shaukat Ali)** and received support from **Mahatma Gandhi**, who saw it as an opportunity to strengthen Hindu–Muslim unity.

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Other important leaders who supported the movement included **Maulana Abul Kalam Azad**, **Hakim Ajmal Khan**, and **Hasrat Mohani**.

To organize the movement effectively, a "**Khilafat Committee**" was formed in Bombay in March 1919, with **Mahatma Gandhi** as its President. In **Bihar**, the movement was strongly led by **Maulana Mazharul Haq**, who played a key role in mobilizing public support.

In **November 1919**, a major meeting was held in Patna under the presidency of **Hasan Imam**, where a boycott of peace celebrations was called. On **19 March 1920**, Muslims across Bihar observed a statewide strike in support of the movement.

The movement weakened after the withdrawal of the **Non-Cooperation Movement in 1922**, and finally ended in **1924**, when **Mustafa Kamaal Pasha** abolished the Caliphate in Turkey.

Important Notes

- **Muhammad Ali Jinnah**: He initially opposed the Khilafat Movement, criticizing the mixing of religion and politics together and also criticized Gandhi's method of non-cooperation.
- **Mutha system** : In Bihar, funds for the movement were collected through the "**Mutha system**", under which both Hindu and Muslim families donated a handful of grain daily.

Bihar and Orissa Primary Education Act, 1919

The **Bihar and Orissa Primary Education Act, 1919 (Act I of 1919)** was an important legislative measure aimed at expanding primary education in the province. Its main objective was to empower local authorities to make education compulsory for children aged **6 to 10 years**, thereby strengthening the foundation of mass education in the region.

Revolutionary Movement in Bihar**Muzaffarpur Bomb Case (1908)**

The **Presidency Magistrate Kingsford of Calcutta** had earned a notorious reputation for handing out extremely harsh punishments to revolutionaries. A plan was made to assassinate him, and **Khudiram Bose** and **Prafulla Chaki** were assigned this task and were sent to Muzaffarpur.

On the night of **30 April 1908**, they mistakenly threw a bomb at a carriage believing it to be Kingsford's. However, the carriage belonged to **Mrs. Kennedy and her daughter**, who were killed in the explosion.

After the incident, both revolutionaries escaped via the railway line towards **Samastipur**.

When surrounded by police near **Mokama Ghat station**, **Prafulla Chaki** shot himself to avoid arrest.

Khudiram Bose was arrested near **Pusa Road Station (now Khudiram Bose Pusa Station)**.

On **11 August 1908**, at the age of just **18 years**, Khudiram Bose was executed in Muzaffarpur Jail. He is remembered as one of the youngest martyrs of India's freedom struggle.

Exam-Oriented Facts

- Khudiram Bose's legal defense was handled by the famous lawyer of Muzaffarpur, **Kalidas Basu**.
- After this incident, the British government enacted the **Explosive Substances Act, 1908**.
- Both Khudiram Bose and Prafulla Chaki were associated with the **Anushilan Samiti**.
- During the **Alipore Conspiracy Case (1908)**, **Chittaranjan Das** described **Aurobindo Ghosh** as the "**Prophet of Indian Nationalism**." Aurobindo's journal "**Vande Mataram**" became a powerful voice of radical young nationalists demanding complete independence.

Anushilan Samiti (Bihar Branch, 1913)

The **Anushilan Samiti** was a secret revolutionary organization. It provided not only ideological training but also physical training in **lathi fighting and use of weapons**.

The Bihar branch was established in **Patna** by **Sachindra Nath Sanyal**.

He used Patna as a strategic centre to connect revolutionaries from **Benaras and Bengal**, creating an important revolutionary network.

Its activities later spread to **Muzaffarpur, Bhagalpur, and Deoghar (then part of Bihar)**.

In the **1924 Sedition Case**, editor **Pandit Paras Nath Tripathi** and printer **Mahavir Ram** were imprisoned under **Section 124A of the IPC** for publishing nationalist writings such as "**Vijay-ka-Sadhan**" and "**Mata-ki-Pukar**". Their imprisonment later became a symbol of the struggle for **press freedom in colonial India**.

Important Conspiracies against the British by Revolutionaries

Deoghar Conspiracy Case (1926–1929): In the Deoghar Conspiracy Case, around 20 people were arrested for possessing weapons and banned revolutionary literature such as Aurobindo's essays and the prohibited Bengali book "**Biplab Darpan**" (Mirror of Revolution). Out of them, 12 individuals were convicted and sentenced.

Dalsingh Sarai Dacoity (November 1928): On 9 November 1928, a major political dacoity took place at Dalsingh Sarai in Darbhanga. A group of armed revolutionaries, wearing khaki and Sola hats, looted approximately ₹25,000 from a moneylender. During the incident, one person was killed and another was injured. Swami Shankaranand of Bardwan was suspected of assisting in the operation, but no arrests were made. The British authorities described it as a "**Political Dacoity**", meaning it was carried out not for personal gain but to fund revolutionary activities.

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Maulania Dacoity: On 7 June 1929, a political dacoity took place at Maulania (Champaran). Later, in May 1930, two more dacoities occurred in Champaran and Darbhanga, all aimed at raising funds for revolutionary organizations. In the Maulania case, Phanindra Nath Ghosh and another associate were arrested. One of them reportedly confessed that the act was committed for revolutionary purposes.

Tirhut Conspiracy Case (1931): In the Tirhut Conspiracy Case (1931), revolutionary leader Yogendra Shukla was tried and sentenced to 10 years of rigorous imprisonment.

Exam-Oriented Facts

- The **Dhaka Anushilan Samiti** had a branch in **Bhagalpur**, which was established by **Revati Nag**.
- **Shanti Kumar Bakshi** propagated the ideology of **"Yugantar"** in Patna.
- **Jadunath Sarkar** intellectually inspired young people in Bihar towards nationalism through his historical writings.
- **Sachindra Nath Sanyal's** famous book **"Bandi Jeevan"** was considered a **"textbook of revolutionaries."** Revolutionaries in Bihar were often found carrying this book along with pamphlets such as **"Bhavani Mandir."**

Major Branches of the Anushilan Samiti

Branch Name	Headquarters / Centre	Main Leaders	Year of Establishment	Key Features
Calcutta Anushilan Samiti	Calcutta (now Kolkata)	Pramathanath Mitra, Jatindranath Banerjee	1902	The first and central branch of the movement. Published revolutionary literature such as "Bhavani Mandir" (revolutionary ideology) and "Vartaman Ran-niti (Present Strategy)."
Dhaka Anushilan Samiti	Dhaka (now Bangladesh)	Pulin Behari Das	1905	The most disciplined and largest branch with more than 500 sub-branches . Revati Nag was associated with this branch.
Yugantar (Inner Branch of Calcutta Samiti)	Calcutta (Maniktala)	Barindra Kumar Ghosh, Bhupendranath Dutta	1906	Published the revolutionary Bengali weekly journal "Yugantar."
Outer Branch (Banaras)	Varanasi (Uttar Pradesh)	Sachindra Nath Sanyal	1908–09	Major centre for spreading revolutionary ideology in North India outside Bengal.
Patna Anushilan Samiti	Patna	Sachindra Nath Sanyal	1913	Bankim Chandra Mitra was assigned leadership responsibility of the organization.

Youth Club

On 3 March 1899, the **Boy's Association**, also known as the **Youth Club**, was established at Rajmaidan (Darbhanga) by Afak Khan, who was also served its president. The association was originally founded by Suryadev Narayan Sharma, while Kamaleshwar Charan Sinha acted as its secretary.

Saraswati Academy (1901)

In 1901, a school named Saraswati Academy was established. Teachers such as Kamaleshwari Charan Sinha, Brajkishore Prasad, and Ramnihar Singh spread nationalist ideas through this institution, even though it functioned from a small hut.

Hindu Boys Association (1913)

Established in Bankipore (Patna) by **Bankim Chandra Mitra**, who was a student of B.N. College, Patna.

In the famous **Banaras Conspiracy Case** (1915), the name of Bankim Chandra Mitra appeared, after which he was arrested.

Patna Youth Association (1927)

It was founded by **Manindra Narayan Roy**.

He was also the sub-editor of the newspaper **"The Searchlight"**, started by **Sachchidanand Sinha**.

Bihar Youth Association (1928)

Established at **Motihari**.

Exam-Oriented Facts

- **Yogendra Shukla**: Active member of the **Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA)**.
- On **11 June 1930**, during the **Maulania dacoity case**, he was arrested by the **Saran police** after a violent encounter, exposing several underground revolutionary networks in Bihar.
- **Baikunth Shukla**: Known for the assassination of **revolutionary-turned-informer Phanindra Nath Ghosh**. On **9 November 1932**, Baikunth Shukla and **Chandrama Singh** killed him in **Bettiah (Bihar)** as revenge for the betrayal of Ghosh, that led to the execution of **Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, and Rajguru**.
- **Shil Bhadra Yajji**: Contributed to the formation of the **All India Forward Bloc** along with **Subhas Chandra Bose**.
- **Phanindra Nath Ghosh**: A revolutionary from Bihar who participated in the **HSRA meeting (September 1928)**.

Peasant Movements in Bihar**Darbhanga Peasant Movement (1919–1920)**

Details	Information
Time Period	○ 1919–1920 (main phase)
Main Leader	○ Swami Vidyanand (real name: Vishubharn Prasad)
Region	○ Madhubani and Darbhanga
Main Opponent	○ Against the exploitative policies of Darbhanga Raj (Maharaja Rameshwar Singh)
Outcome	○ Rise of peasant consciousness; later became the foundation of the 'Bihar Provincial Kisan Sabha'.

Bakhasat Peasant Movement (1937–1938)

Details	Facts
Time Period	1937 – 1938
Main Leadership	Swami Sahajanand Saraswati
Other Leadership	The movement was led by Yadunandan Sharma in Gaya, Yamuna Karjee in Darbhanga and Saran, Karyanand Sharma in Munger, and Rahul Sankrityayan in Annavari.
Main Centres	Barahiya/Badhahiya (Munger), Gaya, Annavari (Saran)
Main Causes of the Movement	Bihar peasants launched the Bakhasat Peasant Movement against the zamindari system.
Main Slogans	"Return Bakhasat land", "Long live my stick (Danda Mera Zindabad)"
Result	Passage of the ' Bihar Restoration of Bakhasat Lands and Reduction of Arrears of Rent Act, 1938 '.

Kisan Sabha in Bihar (Peasant Association in Bihar)

The first attempt to form a **Kisan Sabha** in Bihar was made in **1922–1923 at Munger**, under the chairmanship of **Shah Mohammad Zubair**. Its Vice-President was **Sri Krishna Singh**, and the secretaries were **Siddheshwari Chaudhary** and **Nand Kishore**.

- The formal **Kisan Sabha** was established in **1928 at Bihta (Patna)**, Bihar by **Swami Sahajanand Saraswati**.
- The **Bihar Provincial Kisan Sabha** was formally established on **17 November 1929** at the **Sonepur Fair** under the presidency of **Swami Sahajanand Saraswati**.
Its secretary was **Sri Krishna Singh**.

Bihar Provincial Kisan Conferences

Serial	Year	Place	President
1st	1929	Sonepur	Swami Sahajanand Saraswati
2nd	1934	Gaya	Purushottam Das Tandon
3rd	1935	Hajipur	Swami Sahajanand Saraswati

The success of the Bihar Kisan Sabha laid the foundation for a national-level organization. On **11 April 1936**, at **Lucknow**, the **All India Kisan Sabha** was formed under the presidency of **Swami Sahajanand Saraswati**, and **N.G. Ranga** became its secretary.

In November 1936, under the leadership of **Karyanand Sharma**, the Bihar Provincial Kisan Sabha led a major struggle against zamindari oppression at Barahiya Tal (Munger).

Important Peasant Leaders and Regions

Leader	Area of Activity
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Yamuna Karjee	Darbhanga, Saran
Yadunandan Sharma	Gaya
Karyanand Sharma	Munger (Barahiya Tal)
Rahul Sankrityayan	Anwari / Ambari (Siwan)

Special Facts

- **Swami Sahajanand Saraswati** famously said: “Rights are achieved only by those who struggle.”
- The main objective of the **Kisan Sabha** was to bring the problems of farmers to the **national level** and work for their resolution.

National Movements in Bihar

Swaraj Party and Bihar

After the **Chauri-Chaura incident (1922)**, Mahatma Gandhi withdrew the Non-Cooperation Movement. This created dissatisfaction within the Indian National Congress, leading to its division into two groups:

- **Pro-Changers:** Favoured entry into legislative councils to obstruct British administration (C. R. Das, Motilal Nehru).
- **No-Changers:** Believed in Gandhian constructive programmes (Rajendra Prasad, Vallabhbhai Patel).

In December 1922, the **37th Congress Annual Session** was held at **Gaya (Bihar)** under the presidency of **Chittaranjan Das**. When the proposal for council entry was rejected, C. R. Das and Motilal Nehru resigned and formed the ‘**Congress-Khilafat Swaraj Party**’ on **1 January 1923**.

Swaraj Party in Bihar

- In February 1923, a branch of the Swaraj Party was organised in Bihar.
- **Shri Krishna Singh** was selected as a leading figure of the party in Bihar.
- First President of Bihar Swaraj Party; **Narayan Prasad** and Secretary was **Professor Abdul Bari**.
- In the **local elections of October 1923**, the Swaraj Party achieved major success in Bihar.
- In the **Patna Municipality**, Dr. Rajendra Prasad became Chairman and Dr. Anugrah Narayan Sinha became Vice-Chairman.
- In the **Central Assembly elections (1923)**, Swarajists won **8 out of 12 seats from Bihar**, showing strong political performance.
- To reduce growing differences between Swarajists and No-Changers, **Mahatma Gandhi, C. R. Das, and Motilal Nehru** signed the **Calcutta Pact (6 November 1924)**. It allowed Swarajists to enter legislatures and strengthened Congress commitments towards khadi, Hindu-Muslim unity, and social reforms.

Simon Commission

The British Government formed the **Indian Statutory Commission (1927)** two years earlier than scheduled, under **Sir John Simon**. Its main objective was to review the working of the **Government of India Act, 1919**, and assess whether India was ready for further constitutional reforms.

The Commission had **7 members**, all of whom were British (white). No Indian was included, leading to nationwide protests.

On **3 February 1928**, when the Commission arrived in Bombay (Mumbai), protests erupted across India with black flags and slogans of “**Simon Go Back**”.

Protest against Simon Commission in Bihar

- In 1928, a **multi-party meeting** was held in Patna under **Sir Ali Imam**, where the boycott of the Commission was decided.
- On **12 December 1928**, when the Commission reached Patna, thousands protested at the railway station with black flags. The movement in Bihar was mainly led by **Anugrah Narayan Sinha**.

Note

- **Lord Birkenhead**, the Secretary of State for India, challenged Indians to draft a constitution acceptable to all parties if they opposed the Commission.
- In response, the **Nehru Report (1928)** was prepared under the chairmanship of **Motilal Nehru**.

Exam-Oriented Facts

Simon Commission: Important Events (1927–1930)

Date	Event	Details
8 November 1927	Announcement of Commission	● The Conservative Government of Britain announced the formation of the Statutory Commission (Simon Commission) two years before the scheduled time.
December 1927	Madras Session	● At the Congress session in Madras (President: M. A. Ansari), a decision was taken for a complete boycott of the Simon Commission.

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3 February 1928	Arrival in India (Mumbai)	Members of the Commission landed at Bombay (Mumbai) port. The entire city observed a strike and raised slogans of “Simon Go Back”.
30 October 1928	Lahore Protest	A massive procession was led by Lala Lajpat Rai in Lahore. During a police lathi-charge ordered by officer J. A. Scott, he was severely injured.
17 November 1928	Death of Lala Lajpat Rai	He died due to injuries sustained in the lathi-charge. This caused intense anger among revolutionaries, including Bhagat Singh.
12 December 1928	Arrival in Patna (Bihar)	The Commission reached Patna. Under the leadership of Anugrah Narayan Sinha, thousands protested at the railway station with black flags.
24 December 1928	Arrival in Ranchi	After Patna, the Commission reached Ranchi, where the Tana Bhagat movement and local tribal groups strongly opposed it.
1928–1929	2nd Visit to India	The Commission visited India in two phases (Feb–Mar 1928 and Oct 1928–Apr 1929) to collect evidence.
27 May 1930	Publication of Report	The Simon Commission published its detailed two-volume report.

Bihar Socialist Party

- **1931 (Informal Formation):** The Bihar Socialist Party was initially conceptualised by **Ganga Sharan Sinha, Rambriksh Benipuri, and Ramanand Mishra**. The early objective was to spread socialist consciousness among the youth and intellectuals of Bihar. The foundation of the party is also associated with Jayaprakash Narayan and Phoolena Prasad Verma.
- **1934 (Formal Establishment):** The Bihar Socialist Party was formally established at **Anjuman Islamia Hall, Patna**. From here, it moved towards becoming part of a broader national identity as a component of the Congress Socialist Party. Prominent members included Abdul Bari, Yogendra Shukla, Rambriksh Benipuri, Ganga Sharan Sinha, etc.
- National-level leaders associated were Jayaprakash Narayan (General Secretary), Acharya Narendra Dev (President), Ram Manohar Lohia, Yusuf Meherally and Achyut Patwardhan.

Bihar Legislative Assembly Election (1937)

The **1937 Bihar Assembly Election** was a major turning point in Indian political history. It was conducted under the **Government of India Act, 1935**, which introduced limited provincial autonomy.

- Total seats in Bihar Legislative Assembly were **152**. Seats were divided into categories such as general, Muslim, Scheduled Castes, and others.
- The Indian National Congress registered a massive victory in this election. The results were as follows:

Party	Seats Won
Indian National Congress	98
Muslim Independent Party	20
Others/Independents	Remaining seats

- Initially, the Congress refused to form the government due to opposition to the Governor’s discretionary powers.
- During this period, the Governor invited **Mohd. Yunus** of the **Muslim Independent Party**, who became the **first Premier (Chief Minister)** of Bihar in **March 1937**. He was the first Muslim Premier/Chief Minister of Bihar.
- Later, after assurances from the Governor, Congress agreed to form the government. **Shri Krishna Singh (Sri Babu)** became the first Congress Chief Minister of Bihar on **20 July 1937**.
- In **1938**, the first Congress government of Bihar led by **Sri Krishna Singh** resigned collectively over the issue of the **release of political prisoners**. Chief Minister (then called Prime Minister) Sri Krishna Singh demanded the unconditional release of revolutionaries returned from the Andamans and other political prisoners, which was rejected by the then Governor. This resignation created a major constitutional crisis and became a subject of nationwide discussion. Eventually, the British administration had to yield, and the government withdrew its resignation only after the demand for the release of prisoners was accepted.
- On **29 October 1939**, the elected Bihar government led by **Sri Krishna Singh** resigned collectively in protest against the **Second World War**. The main reason was that the British government had unilaterally involved India in the war without the consent of the Indian people and their representatives. According to the decision of the Congress Working Committee, Congress governments of **all eight provinces**, including Bihar, resigned in protest against this colonial dictatorship. After this resignation, **Governor’s Rule** was imposed in Bihar, and Sri Krishna Singh later played an active role in the **Individual Satyagraha** and subsequently in the **Quit India Movement of 1942**.

Mahatma Gandhi and Bihar

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Champaran Satyagraha (1917 AD)**Indigo Cultivation System**

Indigo plantation owners used the following systems for indigo cultivation:

- **Zerai System:** In this system, plantation owners directly used factory labourers for cultivation.
- **Asamiwar System:** Under this system, farmers were forced to grow indigo on their own land.
- In addition, indigo plantation owners imposed several **abwabs (illegal taxes)** on the peasants of Bihar, such as **Aamhi Kathi** (tax on fruit-bearing trees), **Hathiyahi** (tax for keeping elephants), and **Ghorahi** (tax for keeping horses) — even when the villagers did not possess any horses.

Apart from the above practices, farmers in Champaran were forced to follow the **Tinkathia System**.

Under this system, farmers had to cultivate indigo on **3 kathas out of every 20 kathas** of their land. This system was economically exploitative and made the land infertile.

The issue against this system was raised in the **Lucknow Congress Session (1916)**, where **Rajkumar Shukla** from **Murlibharhawa village** met Mahatma Gandhi and invited him to visit Champaran to understand the problems of farmers. A resolution in this regard was moved by **Brajkishore Prasad**.

Note

- The Lucknow Congress Session (1916) was presided over by **Ambika Charan Majumdar**.
- The suggestion for Rajkumar Shukla to meet Gandhi and bring him to Champaran was given by **Ganesh Shankar Vidyarthi** during the same session.
- Gandhi ji reached **Patna on 10 April 1917** from Calcutta. In Patna, he first went to the residence of Rajendra Prasad, but Rajendra Babu was out of the city at that time. Later, Mazharul Haq, his close friend and nationalist leader, welcomed Gandhi ji at his residence "**Sikandar Mahal**." In the evening, Gandhi ji and Rajkumar Shukla went to Muzaffarpur, where they were warmly welcomed by students along with **Prof. J. B. Kripalani** of G.B.B. College (now L.S. College). The students even performed an *arti* in his honour.
- On **15 April 1917**, Gandhi ji reached **Champaran (Motihari)**. He requested **J. M. Wilson**, Secretary of the Planters' Association, to cooperate in the investigation.
- During this period, the manager of an indigo plantation named **Irwin** was disturbed by Gandhiji's activities. He invited Gandhi ji for a meal, during which **Batak Mian**, the cook, allegedly saved Gandhi ji's life by informing him of poisonous meal.
- The District Magistrate of Champaran, **W. B. Heycock**, issued an order on **16 April 1917** directing Gandhi ji to leave Champaran. Gandhi ji was arrested under **Section 144** for violating the order. Due to intervention by the Lieutenant Governor, Gandhi ji was released on **18 April 1917**.
- During his visit to Champaran, **Mahatma Gandhi** stayed at the house of **Sant Raut** in **Amolwa village**. During his first visit to **Bettiah village** on **22 April 1917**, he stayed at the **Hazarimal Dharamshala**.
- In **June 1917**, the "**Champaran Agrarian Committee**" was formed to investigate the condition of peasants. Its chairman was **F.G. Sly**, the Commissioner of Central Provinces (present-day Madhya Pradesh).
- Other members of this inquiry committee included **Mahatma Gandhi**, **L.C. Adami**, **Raja Harihar Prasad Narayan Singh**, **D.J. Reid**, **G. Rainey**, and **W.A. Maude**. Due to poor health, **Raja Harihar Prasad Narayan Singh** resigned, and **Raja Kirtianand Singh** was appointed at his place.
- As a result, the committee recommended the **abolition of the Tinkathia system** and ordered that **25%** of the illegal collections be refunded to the peasants.
- Several prominent leaders joined Gandhi Ji in this Satyagraha, including **Dr. Rajendra Prasad**, **Brajkishore Prasad**, **Anugrah Narayan Singh**, **Dharanidhar**, **Mazharul Haq**, **Rajkumar Shukla**, **Ramnavami Prasad**, and **Shambhu Sharan**.

Notes

- Champaran Satyagraha was Gandhi's first successful satyagraha in India.
- During the Champaran movement (November 1917), Gandhi ji established schools at Barharwa LakhanSen and Bhitiharwa.

Champaran Satyagraha – Other Important Facts

Pir Mohammad Munis	Ganesh Shankar Vidyarthi
● Pir Mohammad Munis was born in a small village near Bettiah (West Champaran). ● He turned his pen into a powerful weapon for the freedom of Champaran's peasants. ● He is often called "Sher of Champaran" (Lion of Champaran) or "Soldier of the Pen." ● He worked as a correspondent for the famous Hindi newspaper 'Pratap' (edited by Ganesh Shankar Vidyarthi) published from Kanpur.	● In 1913, he started the Hindi weekly newspaper 'Pratap' from Kanpur. ● He provided financial and moral support to members of the Hindustan Republican Association (HRA). ● His journalism played a major role in the success of the Champaran Satyagraha (1917).

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ● He wrote under pseudonyms such as “Dukhi,” “Dukhi Atma,” and “Dukhi Hriday”, exposing the miserable condition of Champaran peasants to the entire country. ● Pir Mohammad Munis and Rajkumar Shukla were the ones who met Gandhi ji at the Lucknow Congress Session (1916) and persuaded him to visit Champaran. ● He wrote powerful articles against indigo planters’ oppression, including “Champaran mein Andher”. ● Munis is regarded as a pioneer of fearless anti-colonial Hindi journalism in Bihar. ● After the Champaran Satyagraha, he started the “Rayati Sabha”, for which he was also imprisoned. | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> ● He played an important role in social and economic transformation in Bihar, especially in the land reform movement. |
|---|---|

Non-Cooperation Movement (1920 AD)

- The Rowlatt Act (1919)—often described as a “no *Vakil* (lawyer), no appeal” black law—followed by the Jallianwala Bagh massacre (13 April 1919), rising inflation after the First World War, and heavy taxation on Indians, created widespread resentment. In response to these conditions, Mahatma Gandhi launched the Non-Cooperation Movement.
- In **September 1920**, at a special session of the Indian National Congress in Calcutta (now Kolkata), presided over by **Lala Lajpat Rai**, Gandhi ji first introduced the proposal of the **Non-Cooperation Movement** before the Congress. The **Ali brothers (Shaukat Ali and Muhammad Ali)** and the **Muslim League** fully supported Gandhi’s proposal.
- In the **December 1920 Nagpur Session**, the Non-Cooperation resolution was moved by **C. R. Das** and was unanimously accepted under the presidency of **C. Vijayaraghavachari**.

Impact of Non-Cooperation Movement in Bihar

- The main leadership of the movement in Bihar was provided by **Dr. Rajendra Prasad**, who gave up his legal practice and fully joined the movement.
- His brother, **Rai Sahib Mahendra Prasad**, returned his title and resigned from the post of magistrate.
- Several leaders including **Rajendra Prasad, Mazharul Haq, Brajkishore Prasad, and Muhammad Shafi Daudi** withdrew their nominations from legislative elections in support of the movement.
- At the **12th Bihar Provincial Conference (Bhagalpur)**, presided over by **Rajendra Prasad**, strong emphasis was laid on the Non-Cooperation Movement.
- To provide alternative education, a **National College** was established, with **Rajendra Prasad** as its **Principal**.
- On **6 February 1921**, Mahatma Gandhi inaugurated the **Bihar Vidyapeeth** at Patna in the premises of the **National College**, so that students could boycott government educational institutions. **Mazharul Haq** became its **Chancellor**, while **Brajkishore Prasad** became the **Vice-Chancellor**.
- During the Non-Cooperation Movement, **Mazharul Haq** established the **Sadakat Ashram** near Digha on land donated by his friend **Khairu Mian**.
- On **30 September 1921**, Mazharul Haq started publishing the newspaper “**The Motherland**” from Sadakat Ashram, which played a significant role in spreading nationalist consciousness.

Note

- In the 1920s, a **Swadeshi printing press** operated at Sadakat Ashram, Patna. Important publications from this press included: **The Motherland**, **Sheristan** (Urdu daily newspaper), **Toofan-e-Nooh** (nationalist literature) and **Khilafat and England** (a book discussing contemporary political issues).
- On **22 December 1921**, on the occasion of the visit of the **Prince of Wales** to Patna, a **city-wide strike (hartal)** was organized in protest.
- After the **Chauri-Chaura incident (4 February 1922)**, Mahatma Gandhi announced the **suspension of the Non-Cooperation Movement on 12 February 1922**.
- To promote non-cooperation against British rule, **Maulana Sajjad** established the organisation **Imarat-e-Sharia** at **Phulwari**.

Other Facts Related to the Non-Cooperation Movement in Bihar

- On 10 October 1920, at the 15th session of the Bihar Students Conference held at **Daltonganj**, presided over by **C. F. Andrews**, students passed a resolution to wear only Swadeshi clothing.
- On 9 January 1921, at a special session of the conference in Patna led by Abdul Bari, students were urged to completely boycott colonial schools and colleges.

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- The British government restricted Congress leaders from meeting under-trial prisoners and declared patriotic slogans as seditious activities. In protest, **Rai Sahib Mahendra Prasad** resigned from his honorary positions.
- **The nationalist newspaper "The Motherland" was banned. Other publications such as "Kishan Samachar," "Angrez ki Kukdookoo,"** and several pamphlets were also prohibited. In Darbhanga, Tarapada Banerjee was prosecuted for publishing "**Bedesia**."
- On 14 February 1921, at the Hardi Fair, a British planter named **Muns** and his wife became angered by nationalist slogans. The police arrested several people and raided the house of **Babu Krishna Prasad Narayan Singh** with 50 armed Gurkhas. Singh resigned from all government posts and became a symbol of peaceful protest.
- Bihar contributed more than ₹11 lakh to the Tilak Swaraj Fund and distributed more than 2 lakh charkhas.

Prohibition Movement (Nasha-Bandi): During the Non-Cooperation Movement, **picketing of liquor and toddy shops** became a highly effective programme in Bihar, especially in rural areas, forming an important part of mass mobilisation.

Civil Disobedience Movement

- At the **Lahore Session of the Indian National Congress (1929 AD)**, along with the demand for **Purna Swaraj (Complete Independence)**, it was decided to launch the **Civil Disobedience Movement**.
- According to this decision, **26 January 1930** was celebrated across the country, including Bihar, as **Independence Day (Swadhinata Diwas)** with great enthusiasm.
- Mahatma Gandhi began his march from the **Sabarmati Ashram on 12 March 1930** towards **Dandi**, and on **6 April 1930**, he reached Dandi and broke the **Salt Law**, launching the Salt Satyagraha.
- On **15 April 1930**, the Salt Satyagraha was launched in **Champaran and Saran districts** by producing salt from naturally salty soil.
- On **16 April 1930**, "**Nakhas Pind**" (**Patna**) was selected as a centre for Salt Satyagraha. **Ambika Kant Singh** and **Ramvriksh Benipuri** played a leading role here.
- During the movement, there were widespread protests in Bihar against **foreign cloth and liquor shops**.
- In **May 1930**, the **Swadeshi League** was formed, with **Sir Ali Imam** as its president.
- Prisoners in **Chapra Jail** started a unique protest called the "**Nangi Hartal**" (**naked strike**) by renouncing foreign clothes.
- In Bihar, women actively participated in staging sit-ins and protests at liquor shops and in the boycott of foreign clothes. Prominent among them were **Mrs. Saraswati Devi** and **Mrs. Sadhana Devi**.
- In several districts of Bihar such as **Saran, Champaran, Shahabad, Purnea, Munger, and Patna**, movements were launched against the **chowkidari tax**, and in many areas this tax was successfully stopped.
- In **Begusarai**, the Salt Satyagraha and anti-chowkidar tax movement became particularly intense.
- On **30 June 1930**, the Congress was declared an **illegal organisation**. On **5 July 1930**, **Dr. Rajendra Prasad** was arrested and sentenced to six months' imprisonment. After his arrest, Rajendra Prasad nominated **Deep Narayan Singh of Bhagalpur** as his successor.
- After the **Gandhi-Irwin Pact (1931)**, the movement was temporarily suspended. However, it was resumed again in **1932**.

Notes

- The **Aman Sabha ("Peace Council")** was an association created by the British administration in India around 1930–1931 as a counter-propaganda mechanism to counter the growing popularity of the Civil Disobedience Movement.
- In 1931, at Gaya (Bihar), the British government attempted to organize a Provincial Aman Sabha (Peace Committee) to gain support from loyalists during the Civil Disobedience Movement. This initiative faced strong opposition from the local people, who observed a complete strike across the city and confronted the leaders with black flags, resulting in the boycott of the event.

Examination-Oriented Facts**Lahore Session of Congress (1929 AD)**

- The Lahore Session (December 1929) of the Indian National Congress declared "**Purna Swaraj**" (Complete Independence) as its main objective.
- Jawaharlal Nehru was elected President of this session, as he played a major role in popularising the idea of complete independence.
- According to this resolution, 26 January 1930 was celebrated across India, including Bihar, with great enthusiasm as Independence Day (Swadhinata Diwas).

Note

- On 12 March 1930, Mahatma Gandhi started the historic Dandi March (Salt Satyagraha) from Sabarmati Ashram with 78 trusted volunteers. This was a 240-mile (approximately 385 km) long march completed in 24 days.
- **Girivardhari Chaudhary from Bihar** also participated in this march.

Civil Disobedience Movement in Bihar (1930–1932): Key Events

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Date / Period	Event	Leader / Place	Important Details
26 January 1930	First Independence Day	Entire Bihar	Celebrated with great enthusiasm across the state along with the rest of India.
15 April 1930	Start of Salt Satyagraha	Champaran and Saran	Movement began in Bihar by preparing salt from saline soil.
16 April 1930	Nakhas Pind (Patna)	Ambika Kant Singh, Ramvriksh Benipuri	Selected as a centre for breaking the Salt Law in Patna.
May 1930	Formation of Swadeshi League	Sir Ali Imam	Formed to promote Swadeshi goods and boycott foreign products.
May–June 1930	Nangi Hartal (Chapra Jail)	Prisoners	Prisoners protested by refusing to wear foreign clothes.
June–July 1930	Anti-Chowkidari Tax Movement	Saran, Champaran, Munger, Begusarai	Villagers refused to pay the colonial Chowkidari tax.
5 July 1930	Arrest of Dr. Rajendra Prasad	Chapra / Patna	After arrest, he nominated Deep Narayan Singh as his successor.

Examination-Oriented Facts

Tarapur Massacre (15 February 1932) – “Jallianwala Bagh of Bihar”

- The Tarapur incident (Munger district) on 15 February 1932 is considered one of the most tragic and heroic chapters of India's freedom struggle. It is often regarded as the **second major massacre after Jallianwala Bagh under British rule**.
- In protest against the arrest of Mahatma Gandhi and the declaration of the Congress as illegal, revolutionaries planned to hoist the Tricolour flag at Tarapur police station. Despite heavy police presence and lathi-charge, a brave youth named **Gopal Singh** successfully hoisted the flag. In retaliation, the British police opened fire on an unarmed crowd. Officially, 34 patriots were martyred, though the actual number is believed to be much higher.

Bihar Earthquake (1934)

- On **15 January 1934**, Bihar was struck by a devastating earthquake of **8.1 magnitude**, one of the worst disasters in modern Indian history. The epicentre was in eastern Nepal.
- Cities like **Munger and Muzaffarpur** were completely destroyed, with severe ground fissures, water and sand eruptions. Thousands of people died and lakhs were rendered homeless.
- Dr. Rajendra Prasad** formed the “**Bihar Central Relief Committee**” to coordinate relief work. Mahatma Gandhi described the earthquake as a “**divine punishment for social evils.**”
- After this disaster, scientific study and classification of **seismic zones in India** began.

Individual Satyagraha in Bihar (1940)

The **Individual Satyagraha** in Bihar began on **28 November 1940**, in which **Sri Krishna Singh** was the first satyagrahi and **Anugrah Narayan Singh** was the second.

Started on the call of Mahatma Gandhi, the main objective of this movement was to oppose the inclusion of Indians in the Second World War without their consent and to offer arrest by delivering anti-war speeches.

During this movement in Bihar, more than 600 satyagrahis were arrested, including prominent leaders such as **Gauri Shankar Singh (Gaya)** and **Shyam Narayan Singh (Shilao)**. This movement generated tremendous political awareness among the people of Bihar, which later prepared a strong foundation for the Quit India Movement of 1942.

Quit India Movement (1942) – “August Revolution”

The **Quit India Movement**, also known as the “**August Revolution**”, was the final and most powerful mass struggle of India's freedom movement. It clearly signaled that British rule in India could no longer survive for long.

- The **failure of the Cripps Mission**, rising inflation due to the Second World War, and fear of a possible Japanese invasion of India created widespread unrest.
- On **8 August 1942**, at the **Gowalia Tank Maidan (now August Kranti Maidan)**, **Mumbai**, the Congress Working Committee passed the historic “**Quit India**” resolution.
- On this occasion, Mahatma Gandhi gave the famous slogan: “**Do or Die**” (**Karo ya Maro**).
- On the morning of **9 August 1942**, the British government launched “**Operation Zero Hour**”.
- All top Congress leaders, including Mahatma Gandhi, Jawaharlal Nehru, Sardar Patel, and Maulana Azad, were arrested.

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- Gandhi ji was imprisoned at the **Aga Khan Palace (Pune)**, Nehru at **Ahmednagar Fort**, and **Dr. Rajendra Prasad at Bankipur Jail**. The Congress was declared an **illegal organisation**.
- **Baldev Sahay** resigned from the post of Advocate General in protest against these arrests.

Leaderless Mass Movement

After the arrest of major leaders, the movement came into the hands of the people and became spontaneous in nature. Following the arrest of the top leaders, the leadership of the movement was taken over by youths and local leaders:

- **Aruna Asaf Ali**: She accelerated the movement by hoisting the tricolour at the **Gowalia Tank Maidan** on **9 August 1942** (she is known as the "Rani of 1942").
- **Underground Activities**: **Jayaprakash Narayan**, **Dr. Ram Manohar Lohia**, and **Achyut Patwardhan** secretly carried forward the movement.
- **Congress Radio**: **Usha Mehta** operated a secret radio station through which news and messages related to the movement were broadcast.

Establishment of Parallel Governments

Several regions in India established **parallel governments** in defiance of British rule:

- **Ballia (Uttar Pradesh)**: The first parallel government was established under the leadership of **Chittu Pandey**.
- **Tamluk (Bengal)**: A '**Jatiya Government**' was formed, in which **73-year-old Matangini Hazra** ("Old Gandhi") attained martyrdom.
- **Satara (Maharashtra)**: The longest-running parallel government was formed under the leadership of **Y.B. Chavan** and **Nana Patil**.
- **Odisha**: In Talcher, Odisha, an important parallel government known as "Chasi-Mulia Raj" (Peasant-Worker Rule) was established.

Patna Secretariat Firing (11 August 1942)

This is considered one of the most significant and emotionally moving events in the history of Bihar.

- On **11 August 1942**, seven students of Patna attempted to hoist the tricolour at the eastern gate of the **Secretariat Building**.
- As a result, on the orders of the then District Magistrate of Patna, **W.G. Archer**, the police opened fire, in which all seven students were martyred.
- **Importance**: In memory of these martyrs, the **Shaheed Smarak (Martyrs' Memorial)** was built in front of the Patna Secretariat. The foundation of the memorial was laid on **15 August 1947** by the Governor of Bihar, **Shri Jairam Das Daulatram**. Sculptor **Devi Prasad Roy Choudhury** created the bronze statue of the seven students carrying the national flag. These statues were cast in **Italy** and later installed here.

The Seven Martyrs of the Patna Secretariat Firing

Name of Martyr	School/College	District (Bihar)
Umakant Prasad Singh	Ram Mohan Roy Seminary, Patna	Saran (Narendrapur)
Ramanand Singh	Ram Mohan Roy Seminary, Patna	Patna (Sahadat Nagar)
Satish Prasad Jha	Patna Collegiate School	Bhagalpur (Kharhara)
Jagatpati Kumar	Patna College	Aurangabad (Kharanti)
Devipad Chaudhary	Miller High School, Patna	Sylhet (now in Bangladesh; then linked with Bihar)
Rajendra Singh	Patna High School	Saran (Banwari Chak)
Ramgovind Singh	Punpun High School	Patna (Dashrath)

Note

- These students were led by **Devipad Chaudhary**, who was the youngest among them.

Jayaprakash Narayan and the 'Azad Dasta'

Loknayak Jayaprakash Narayan (JP) was born on **11 October 1902** in **Sitabdiara, Bihar**.

During his higher education in the United States, he was influenced by **Marxist ideology**, but after returning to India, in **1929**, he entered Indian politics by joining the **Indian National Congress** under the influence of **Jawaharlal Nehru**. He later founded the '**Congress Socialist Party**' in **1934**. He also played an active role in the **Quit India Movement**. When all major leaders were arrested during the movement, **JP** took over the leadership and direction of the movement.

Escape from Hazaribagh Jail: On **9 November 1942 (Diwali night)**, JP escaped from Hazaribagh Jail by jumping over the prison wall along with his five companions; **Yogendra Shukla**, **Suraj Narayan Singh**, **Gulabi Sonar**, **Ramanand Mishra** and **Shaligram Singh**.

Azad Dasta: After the escape, he formed the '**Azad Dasta**' in the Terai region of Nepal (Bakri ka tapu).

It was a guerrilla organization, whose objective was to paralyse the British government through sabotage and disruptive activities.

However, by May 1943, JP along with **Shyam Nandan Singh**, **Dr. Lohia**, **Kartik Prasad Singh**, and others were arrested in Nepal and lodged in **Hanuman Nagar Jail**. Later, a group of **35–50 armed revolutionaries**, led by **Suraj Narayan Singh** and **Sardar Nityanand Singh**, attacked Hanuman Nagar Jail and successfully **rescued JP and six others**.

Eventually, JP was again arrested on 18 December 1943 near Mughalpura, Amritsar.

Radio Broadcast Activity: During this period, **Dr. Ram Manohar Lohia** used a **secret radio transmission** to spread enthusiasm and mobilize the people.

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Establishment of Local / Parallel Governments and Other Activities

In several parts of Bihar, people established **parallel governments in opposition to British rule**:

- **Siwan**: Here, **Phoolena Prasad Verma** sacrificed his life while attempting to hoist the national flag at a police station.
- **Saran**: It was declared an '**Aparadhi District**' (**Criminal District**) because people uprooted railway tracks and disrupted communication systems.
- **Munger and Bhagalpur**: Parallel governments were also established here.

Role of Women in the Movement

Women of Bihar actively participated in the movement:

- **Shanti Devi**: Led a massive procession in **Chapra**.
- **Rajkumari Devi**: Played an important role in organizing the movement.
- **Tara Rani Srivastava**: In **1942**, inspired by Mahatma Gandhi's call of '**Do or Die**', she and her husband **Phulendu Babu** pledged to hoist the tricolour at Siwan police station. Her husband was martyred, yet she continued the struggle.

Mahila Charkha Samiti: This committee was established in **1940** at **Kadamkuan, Patna** by **Prabhavati Devi** (wife of Jayaprakash Narayan) with the objective of making women self-reliant and independent.

The main aim of this committee was to encourage women, in accordance with **Gandhian ideology**, towards **spinning the charkha, weaving, and promoting khadi**, so that they could become economically empowered. During the freedom movement, this committee emerged as a major centre of women's political and social awakening, where women were inspired not only towards literacy but also towards patriotism.

'Swaraj Train'

During the Quit India Movement, students of Bihar captured a train and ran it as the '**Swaraj Train**'.

Formation of Various Groups in Bihar

During the **1942 'Quit India Movement'**, several underground revolutionary groups were formed in Bihar to challenge British authority, among which the **Siyaram Dal** was the most influential.

This group, established in Bhagalpur by **Siyaram Singh**, adopted a **guerrilla warfare policy** and caused heavy damage to government property and communication systems.

In the same sequence, the **Dhruv Dal in Katihar** (formed after the martyrdom of Dhruv Kundu) and the **Parashuram Dal in the Munger-Khagaria region** became active. These groups attempted to run **parallel governments** and capture police stations.

These local groups, using force, crippled the government machinery and kept the flame of the freedom movement alive in rural areas.

Bihar in the Constituent Assembly (1946)

A total of **36 members from the Bihar province** were elected to the Constituent Assembly. Some prominent leaders who represented Bihar in the Constituent Assembly of India (1946–1950) were:

Sarojini Naidu, born in Hyderabad, was the first Indian woman to preside over the 40th session of the Indian National Congress held in Kanpur in 1925. She was nominated to the Constituent Assembly from Bihar. She spoke about the importance of adopting the **National Flag** in the Assembly. Among the 15 women members of the Constituent Assembly, Sarojini Naidu was the only one who represented Bihar.

Jaipal Singh was born into a Munda tribal family in Ranchi district. In 1946, he was elected to the Constituent Assembly from Bihar. He also captained the Indian hockey team at the Amsterdam Olympics and won India's first Olympic gold medal in 1928.

K.T. Shah was elected to the Constituent Assembly from Bihar on a Congress ticket. He was also a candidate in India's first presidential election, where his main opponent was his Constituent Assembly colleague **Rajendra Prasad**.

Krishna Ballabh Sahay represented the Bihar province in the Constituent Assembly. He was popularly known as the "**Iron Man of Bihar**." He also served as the Chief Minister of Bihar.

Sachchidanand Sinha was elected to the Constituent Assembly from Bihar on a Congress ticket. Before Rajendra Prasad was formally appointed President, he served as the **interim President of the Assembly**.

Modern Bihar: Major Books, Authors and Year of Publication

Book / Magazine Name	Author / Editor	Year of Publication (Approx.)	Special Facts / Subject Matter
Deshar Katha	Sakharam Ganesh Deuskar	1904	● Banned by the British government due to its revolutionary ideas.
Searchlight	Murali Manohar Prasad (Editor)	1918	● A major English newspaper of Bihar; supportive of the freedom movement.
Bandi Jeevan	Sachindranath Sanyal	1922	● Known as the "Bible" of revolutionaries.

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Hunkar (Magazine)	Swami Sahajanand Saraswati	1939	Main voice of the peasant movement; a weekly magazine.
India Divided	Dr. Rajendra Prasad	1946	- Analysis of partition politics and communalism. - In this book, Dr. Rajendra Prasad referred to Lord Minto as the "father" of Pakistan.
Satyagraha in Champaran	Dr. Rajendra Prasad	1922	Official and historical account of the Champaran movement.
Bapu Ke Kadmon Mein	Dr. Rajendra Prasad	1954	Gandhian philosophy and personal memoirs.
Mera Jeevan Sangharsh	Swami Sahajanand Saraswati	1940	Autobiography of Swami ji and history of peasant movements.
Maila Aanchal	Phanishwar Nath 'Renu'	1954	First regional (anchalik) novel based on village 'Meriganj' of Purnia.
Sanskriti Ke Chaar Adhyay	Ramdhari Singh 'Dinkar'	1956	Cultural analysis of Indian history; awarded Sahitya Akademi Award.
Rashmirathi	Ramdhari Singh 'Dinkar'	1952	Great epic poem based on the character of Karna; heroic style literature.
Kurukshetra	Ramdhari Singh 'Dinkar'	1946	Famous work based on the philosophy of war and peace.

Important Facts

Bihar Herald (1875): The first English newspaper of Bihar, started by Guru Prasad Sen.

The Bihar Times (1894): Started by Sachchidanand Sinha and Mahesh Narayan, it played an important role in raising the demand for a separate Bihar province.

'Urvashi' by Dinkar (1961): For this literary work, Ramdhari Singh 'Dinkar' was awarded the Jnanpith Award in 1972. He belonged to Simaria, Begusarai (Bihar).

Sarvhitashi (1874): The first Hindi daily newspaper published in Bihar.

Phanishwar Nath 'Renu': He wrote important works such as '**Julus**' and '**Parati Parikatha**', which provide a vivid portrayal of rural life in Bihar.

Sir John Houlton: He wrote the book 'Bihar: The Heart of India'.

Bihar and India's Great Leaders: Comparative Table

Details	Swami Vidyand	Swami Sahajanand Saraswati	Swami Shraddhanand	Dr. Sachchidanand Sinha
Main Identity	Peasant leader of North Bihar	'Kisan Pran' and revolutionary leader	Arya Samaj leader and educationist	Architect of modern Bihar
Childhood Name	Vishubharan Prasad	Naurang Rai	Munshi Ram	Sachchidanand Sinha
Area of Work	Darbhangha and Madhubani (Bihar)	Bihta (Patna) and all India	Delhi, Punjab and Haridwar	Patna (Bihar) and London
Major Contribution	1919 peasant movement against Darbhanga Raj	Founded All India Kisan Sabha (1936)	Established Gurukul Kangri and led Shuddhi movement	Key architect of Separate Bihar (1912)
Historical Event	Organized peasants during the Non-Cooperation Movement	Led anti-zamindari and Bakhasat movement	Only Hindu sanyasi to deliver speech from Jama Masjid in 1919	First (interim) President of Constituent Assembly (1946)
Famous Slogan / Idea	Rights for tenants (peasants)	"One who grows food should make the laws."	"Self-rule, own language and own religion."	"Bihar for Biharis."
Main Centre / Institution	Madhubani (North Bihar)	Bihta Ashram (Patna)	Gurukul Kangri (Haridwar)	Sinha Library and Patna University

Note: Dr. Sachchidanand Sinha and Hasan Imam went to England together in **1889** for higher studies (Bar-at-Law / legal education).

Bihar Provincial Conference (Bihar Provincial Congress Conference)

Session	Year	Place	President	Main Outcome / Feature
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SPRINT 72 Notes

First Session	1908	Patna	Sir Ali Imam	In this conference, for the first time, an official proposal was passed to separate Bihar from Bengal and make it an independent province.
Second Session	1909	Bhagalpur	Sachchidanand Sinha	The demand for a separate Bihar was further strengthened and pressure was built on the government.
Third Session	1910	Muzaffarpur	Mazharul Haq	Emphasis was laid on mobilizing public support at the local level and involving youth.
Fourth Session	1911	Munger	Chandreshwar Prasad Singh	In the same year, during the Delhi Durbar, a historic announcement was made regarding the creation of a separate Bihar province.
Special Session	1918	Patna	Hasan Imam	This special session was convened to discuss the Montagu–Chelmsford Reforms.
12th Session	1920	Bhagalpur	Dr. Rajendra Prasad	It was decided to give official support to the Non-Cooperation Movement in Bihar. (28–29 August 1920)
28th Session	1929	Munger	Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel	Discussions were held on peasant issues and rent refusal movement.

Bihar Students' Conference

Session	Year	Place	President	Main Points / Importance
First Session	1906	Patna	Sharufuddin	It was established through the efforts of Dr. Rajendra Prasad. It was the first student organization of its kind in the country.
9th Session	1914	Munger	Laxmidhar Sharma	Emphasis was laid on awakening nationalist consciousness among students.
15th Session	1920	Daltonganj	C.F. Andrews	Bihar formally accepted the resolution of the Non-Cooperation Movement and pledged the boycott of foreign goods. A decision was also taken to establish a 'National School' in Daltonganj.
16th Session	1921	Hazaribagh	Sarala Devi	This session was highly significant during the Non-Cooperation Movement. Students were called upon to boycott government educational institutions.
19th Session	1924	Motihari	Brajkishore Prasad	Discussions were held on promotion of khadi and social reforms.
21st Session	1928	Motihari	Prof. Gyan Saha	During this time, the 'Bihar Yuvak Sangh' was established and the outline of protest against the Simon Commission was prepared.

Major Educational Institutions (Bihar)

Patna College – It is the oldest institution of higher education in Bihar (established on **9 January 1863**) and is affiliated to Patna University. Located on Ashok Rajpath, it is known for its historic buildings and academic heritage, and is often called the "**Oxford of the East**."

Patna University – It was established on **1 October 1917** during the British rule. It is the first university of Bihar and the seventh oldest university of the Indian subcontinent.

Prince of Wales Medical College – The present-day Patna Medical College and Hospital (PMCH) was originally established on **25 February 1925** as the Prince of Wales Medical College, which evolved from the **Temple Medical School (1874)**. Located on the banks of the Ganga River, it is a major government institution and is still sometimes referred to by its old name.

Bihar Vidyapeeth – It was established by Mahatma Gandhi on **6 February 1921** in Patna during the Non-Cooperation Movement to provide national education. Maulana Mazharul Haq was its first Chancellor and Braj Kishore Prasad its first Vice-Chancellor.

Bihar School of Engineering – It was established in 1900, developed from the earlier Patna Survey School. By 1908, it became an independent institution. In **1932**, it was renamed **Bihar College of Engineering**, and finally in 2004 it was upgraded to National Institute of Technology (NIT), Patna.

Patna Women's College – It was established in **1940** by Bishop B.J. Sullivan S.J. and Mother M. Josephine S.C. It was the first higher education institution dedicated to women's education in Bihar. In 1952, it became a constituent college of Patna University.

Bihar Veterinary College – Following the recommendations of the **Ganesh Dutt Committee**, Bihar veterinary college was established on **April 2, 1927**. Sir Syed Mohammad Fakhruddin (1868–1933), an important education reformer and Education Minister of Bihar and Orissa (1921–1933), played an important role in establishing this veterinary college at Patna. He also actively recruited qualified teachers from outside to improve educational standards.

Dr. Rajendra Prasad Central Agricultural University (Pusa) – Located at Pusa in Samastipur, it was formally established as a central university on 7 October 2016. However, its roots trace back to the Rajendra Agricultural University (1970) and the original **Imperial Agricultural Research Institute, Pusa (1905)**.

Other Facts Related to Modern Bihar

Personality / Topic	Details and Important Facts
Muhammad Ali Jinnah	After the 1937 elections, he worked to strengthen the Muslim League base in Bihar and to separate Muslim voters from the Congress.
Abdul Qayyum Ansari	- Opposed the Muslim League's Two-Nation Theory and connected the backward Muslim (Momin) community with the Congress and the national movement. - In 1938, he founded the Momin Congress.
Theodore Surin & Jaipal Singh Munda	The Adivasi Mahasabha was formed in 1938, with Theodore Surin as its president.
Asha Sahay	- Joined the Indian National Army (INA) in 1943. - After returning to India in 1946, she trained women in self-defense and weapons handling.
Jiriyavati Devi	- Resident of Govindpur (Nawada) and wife of Shri Narasimha Gopi. - During the 1942 movement, she showed exceptional courage and reportedly shot 16 British soldiers.
Dr. Rajendra Prasad	Major works: 'Champaran Mein Mahatma Gandhi', 'Bapu ke Kadam Mein', 'India Divided'.
Jagannath Prasad Chaturvedi	Major works: 'Bharat ki Vartaman Dasha' and 'Swadeshi Andolan'.
Raja Sahib (Radhikaraman)	Famous work: 'Gandhi Topi'.
Sri Krishna Singh (Sri Babu)	- First Chief Minister of Bihar. - Elected from Munger in the 1937 elections and led the Congress government. - Major works include opening temples like Deoghar for Dalits and laying the foundation for the abolition of the zamindari system. - Known as 'Bihar Kesari'.
Dr. Anugrah Narayan Singh	- First Deputy Chief Minister and Finance Minister of Bihar. - In the 1937 government, he handled Education and Local Self-Government departments. - Associated with Gandhi since the Champaran Satyagraha and played a key role in modern Bihar's development planning. - Known as 'Bihar Vibhuti'.
Loknayak Jayaprakash Narayan	- Founded the Congress Socialist Party in 1934. - Gained national fame after escaping from Hazaribagh Jail during the Quit India Movement (1942) and forming the 'Azad Dasta'. - After independence, he supported Vinoba Bhave's Bhoodan Movement. - In 1974, he led the 'Total Revolution (Sampoorna Kranti)' movement against corruption, which led to the formation of India's first non-Congress government in 1977. - Awarded the Bharat Ratna (posthumously, 1999).
Jagjivan Ram	- Born on 5 April 1908 in Chandwa village, Bhojpur district. - Began political career in 1937 as a member of the Bihar Legislative Council.

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| | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Active in the Quit India Movement and jailed for participation. Became the youngest minister in the Interim Government (1946) as Labour Minister and remained in the central cabinet for 31 years. • As Defence Minister during the 1971 India-Pakistan War, he played a key role in the creation of Bangladesh. • Founded the Congress for Democracy (1977) and became Deputy Prime Minister in the Janata Party government. • Dedicated his life to the upliftment of Dalits, backward classes, and workers. • Played an important role in demanding voting rights for Dalits before the Hammond Commission (1935). • Founded the All India Ravidas Mahasabha (1934) and later the All India Depressed Classes League. • His birth anniversary on 5 April is observed as Samata Diwas. |
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